paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Languages Common
Skills Athletics +13, Nature +12, Survival +11
Str +4, **Dex** +2, **Con** +4, **Int** +1, **Wis** +0, **Cha** +1
Items blowgun (10 darts), graveroot (4 doses), hide armor, sickle, *+1 whip*

AC 21; **Fort** +15, **Ref** +11, **Will** +9; +2 status to all saves vs. mental effects
HP 80; **Resistances** mental 5

Speed 25 feet; trackless step
Melee ❖ *whip* +14 (disarm, finesse, nonlethal, reach, trip), **Damage** 1d4+7 slashing
Melee ❖ sickle +13 (agile, finesse, trip), **Damage** 1d4+7 slashing
Ranged ❖ blowgun +13 (agile, nonlethal), **Damage** 1 piercing plus graveroot
Focus Hatred ❖ (emotion, mental) The hateful hermit unleashes a vexing stream of profanities and threats at a single foe he can see within 30 feet. The hermit gains a +1 circumstance bonus on all attack rolls made against that target until he chooses a different target to Focus Hatred on. The target must attempt a DC 22 Will save, with the below effects. The hateful hermit cannot Focus Hatred again for 1d4 rounds.
- **Critical Success** The target is unaffected and is temporarily immune to Focus Hatred for 24 hours.
- **Success** The target is distracted by the hatred and is flat-footed against the hermit's next attack.
- **Failure** The hermit's words unnerve the target and distract them; the target is flat-footed until the end of the hateful hermit's next turn.
- **Critical Failure** As failure, but the target is flat-footed for 1 minute.

Sneak Attack The hateful hermit deals 2d6 extra precision damage to flat-footed creatures.
Trackless Step The hateful hermit always gains the benefits of Cover Tracks in natural surroundings, even when moving at full speed.

Treasure: The hollow oak tree contains next to nothing of value: a few pieces of crude furniture, a wooden bowl and spoon, and a pile of dried leaves for a bed. The hateful hermit keeps his few treasures in a chest tucked into in a hole under his bed of leaves, which can be discovered by succeeding at a DC 15 Perception check. The chest contains a *lesser healing potion*, an *invisibility potion*, 64 cp, and a tarnished silver locket holding a faded portrait of a young woman (worth 5 gp) wrapped in a piece of cloth. This locket depicts the hermit and Bokken's long-dead mother—Bokken will pay up to 10 gp (or 100 gp in potions) for its return. The cloth itself is a faded map of the region that might just point the way toward a great treasure (see the Tomb Treasure sidebar).

TOMB TREASURE

30 XP

The PCs gain an intriguing treasure map. A few minutes spent deciphering the scrawls and faded shapes on this map are enough to recognize that the map seems to point the way to a hidden burial cairn somewhere between the Gudrin and Shrike rivers, due east of the northern shores of the Tuskwater. A magic flaming weapon is said to be hidden within this tomb, although the map vaguely warns of traps and an undead guardian who stole out of the tomb once before to reclaim the magic weapon. Following this map leads the PCs directly to the Lonely Barrow (area **TW5**).

Source: Treasure map found in the hateful hermit's den (area **TW6**); alternately, you can allow the PCs to find the treasure map as part of any treasure stash in Kingmaker

Completion: The PCs find the Lonely Barrow, defeat its guardian, and claim its treasure.

Reward: Adjust the type of weapon this treasure map promises to match the favored weapon of one of the PCs who doesn't currently have a magic weapon—the reward for this quest is that weapon's recovery (see page 135).

TW7. THE OLD BELDAME — SEVERE 3

RESOURCE STANDARD

A dilapidated mud hut squats atop a small hummock in the middle of a fetid marsh, a thin tendril of bluish smoke trickling through a gaping hole in its moss-covered roof. A wooden fence surrounding the perimeter of the mound is festooned with crude fetishes crafted out of sticks, feathers, and animal bones. A lone crow caws noisily from the top of a nearby cypress tree.

Creature: A small swamp on the west bank of the Tuskwater is the domain of a mysterious woman named **Elga Verniex**, known to travelers as the Old Beldame. As the PCs' nation grows, many of their subjects begin to trade tales about her. Rumors spread that the old woman is a hag, and locals begin calling her the Swamp Witch, claiming (falsely) that she sold her soul to a demon or devil for malign powers. In reality, Elga Verniex isn't a witch at all, just a bitter old woman who likes her privacy, though her magical powers are legitimate.

Elga doesn't take kindly to visitors, and to help ensure her privacy, she has animated a pumpkin-headed scarecrow to guard her hut and drive away unwanted guests. Those who regularly come to her for assistance have long since learned to announce their presence before opening her gate.

The Old Beldame's hut is a simple, one-room affair; it's about 20 feet in diameter with a dirt floor and a thatched roof. The rafters are hung with dried herbs and swamp weeds, and a bubbling cauldron (containing

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

nothing more sinister than a weak vegetable broth) hangs over a firepit in the center of the room. The region around the hut is an 80-foot-diameter area of solid ground, thick with bog grass and dotted with small, cattail-clogged pools. This area is surrounded by a waist-high wooden fence, in which a single gate hangs askew. A fist-sized, rusted iron bell hangs from a hairy length of rope tied to a crooked post next to the gate.

The scarecrow appears to be propped up midway between the gate and the door to the hut—it lurches to life and swiftly moves to attack anyone crossing the line of the fence. The Old Beldame does not emerge from her hut, even if the PCs fight the scarecrow outside. She is somewhat hard of hearing anyway and trusts the scarecrow to take care of any troublesome intruders. She attacks only if the PCs make it past the scarecrow and enter her hut uninvited. She is initially unfriendly to PCs, but she is not evil-hearted, so successful Diplomacy checks to Make an Impression may be able to defuse the situation before it turns violent.

The Old Beldame is human, although fey blood runs in her veins—over the years, her magical heritage has given her skin a strange greenish cast and lengthened her ears to points, further fuel for the locals' rumormongering. Should the PCs wish to talk to Elga instead of fighting her, they'd do well to announce themselves by striking the bell on the pole next to the gate before they annoy the scarecrow. The Old Beldame peers out of a window of her hut and angrily demands to know who the PCs are. Initial diplomatic contact must be carried out at this somewhat awkward distance, for if the PCs enter her fenced-in area, she shrieks, ducks into her hut, and lets the scarecrow handle the defense of her domain. If she is made friendly or helpful to the PCs, she invites them into her hut to chat. If she invites the PCs inside, the scarecrow doesn't attack, though it does turn its head to watch them menacingly as they pass by.

During an extended conversation with the Old Beldame, the PCs find her to be knowledgeable, though crotchety and ill-tempered. She can warn them about the dangers of the hateful hermit to the west (area **TW6**), setting foot on Candlemere (area **KL4**), the lizardfolk village just west of Candlemere (area **KL3**), and the Lonely Barrow to the east (area **TW5**). She can be convinced to Craft magical items or provide spellcasting for the PCs at standard prices, and if she's impressed with the PCs, she'll even hire them to do her a favor (detailed in the Black Rattlecaps sidebar).



ELGA VERNIEX

ELGA VERNIEX — CREATURE 6

UNIQUE | N | MEDIUM | HUMANOID | HUMAN

Female fey-touched human sorcerer

Perception +13

Languages Common

Skills Arcana +12, Crafting +14, Medicine +13, Nature +12, Occultism +12, Survival +13

Str +0, **Dex** +2, **Con** +0, **Int** +2, **Wis** +3, **Cha** +5

Items artisan's tools, *lesser healing potions* (2), *+1 staff* with an *owlbear claw* talisman affixed

AC 21; **Fort** +10, **Ref** +14, **Will** +15

HP 90

Moment of Solitude ↷ (fortune) **Trigger** Elga fails or critically fails a saving throw against an effect with the enchantment or linguistics trait; **Effect** Elga rerolls the saving throw and takes the better result.

Speed 20 feet

Melee ❖ *staff* +13 (two-hand d8), **Damage** 1d4+2 bludgeoning

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Occult Spontaneous Spells DC 24, attack +17; **3rd** (4 slots) *clairaudience*, *paralyze*, *phantom pain*, *wanderer's guide*; **2nd** (4 slots) *hideous laughter*, *illusory creature*, *invisibility*, *silence*; **1st** (4 slots) *alarm*, *fear*, *sanctuary*, *sleep*; **Cantrips (3rd)** *daze*, *detect magic*, *ghost sound*, *know direction*, *prestidigitation*

Rituals DC 24; *animate object*, *inveigle*

Steady Spellcasting If another creature's reaction would disrupt Elga's spellcasting action, she attempts a DC 15 flat check. If she succeeds, her action isn't disrupted.

SCARECROW CREATURE 4

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 232

Initiative Perception +11

Treasure: A small metal box hidden under the Old Beldame's bed (DC 15 Perception while Searching to find) contains 21 cp, 31 sp, 38 gp, and 9 pp. Under the layer of coins is a *scroll of scrying* and instructions for a *legend lore* ritual that Elga hopes to one day learn.

Resource: If the PCs ally with the Old Beldame then establish a settlement here, she and her hut grant the settlement a free herbalist structure.

BLACK RATTLECAPS

30 XP

The PCs are tasked with gathering a batch of black rattlecap mushrooms from a dangerous mud pit. The Old Beldame uses the spores from these very rare mushrooms to brew a potent tea. She sends the PCs to the Mud Bowl (area **KL5**) to gather as many of the mushrooms as they can for her.

Source: The Old Beldame (area **TW7**)

Completion: After defeating the hideous guardian of the Mud Bowl, the PCs can harvest several black rattlecaps. The Old Beldame wants as many as the PCs can find for her.

Reward: The Old Beldame promises a payment of 5 gp for each black rattlecap the PCs bring her.

TW8. OLD CRACKJAW'S DEN MODERATE 3

HIDDEN

A 3-mile stretch of land along the edge of the Tuskwater rises high above the water here, presenting a swath of 40-foot-high cliffs and limiting access to the river below. The cliff tops are thick with stinging nettles (see Hazard), but succeeding at a DC 20 Survival check while exploring the hex reveals a hidden trail through the nettles and down to a secluded pool, 50 feet in diameter, at the Tuskwater's shore. If the PCs learn about this trail from Arven the fisherman (as detailed in the That Damn Turtle! sidebar on page 511), they can find the hidden trail automatically when they explore this hex.

Creature: Fishing in this area has traditionally been quite good, but recently an enormous and particularly ill-tempered hookjaw turtle (a more carnivorous and much larger version of the alligator snapping turtle) has moved in. This turtle is something of a legend to fishers and boaters of the Tuskwater: a seemingly indestructible reptile named Old Crackjaw that has supposedly attacked and killed dozens of fishermen and caused no less than five boats to sink. Old Crackjaw has claimed this area as its den, and anyone who enters the water is immediately attacked by the oversized, angry beast.

OLD CRACKJAW CREATURE 5

UNIQUE N MEDIUM ANIMAL

Variant snapping turtle (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 269)

Perception +11, low-light vision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet

Skills Athletics +12, Stealth +11 (+13 in water)

Str +5, **Dex** +2, **Con** +4, **Int** –4, **Wis** +4, **Cha** –2

Deep Breath Old Crackjaw can hold its breath for 30 minutes.

AC 23; **Fort** +15, **Ref** +9, **Will** +13

HP 78

Speed 15 feet, swim 25 feet

Melee jaws +14, **Damage** 2d8+7 piercing

Clench Jaws ❖ **Requirements** Old Crackjaw damaged a creature with a jaws Strike with its previous action; **Effect** Old Crackjaw clenches its jaw and automatically deals an additional 2d8 bludgeoning damage to the creature it just hit.

Gnawing Bite ❖❖ Old Crackjaw makes a jaws Strike against an object. This counts as two attacks when calculating Old Crackjaw's multiple attack penalty. If this Strike hits, Old Crackjaw deals an extra die of weapon damage to the object.

Shell Defense ❖ Old Crackjaw retracts its limbs and head into its shell and ends its turn. This increases its AC to 25, but it can't act except to reemerge, which it can do as a single action.

Hazard: A PC who explores the cliff tops is likely to stumble into a patch of stinging nettles.

STINGING NETTLES HAZARD 1

ENVIRONMENTAL PLANT

Stealth DC 17

Description This bright green plant has long triangular leaves covered with fine hair-like stingers.

Disable DC 17 Survival to carefully navigate the plant and pull aside or cut away the nettles

AC 13; **Fort** +10, **Ref** +4

HP 24; **Immunities** critical hits, object immunities, precision damage

Sting ↷ (poison) **Trigger** A creature touches the stinging nettles or moves through a square containing stinging

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

nettles; **Effect** The triggering creature must attempt a DC 17 Fortitude save if they're walking through the square or a DC 20 Fortitude save if they touched the nettles.

Critical Success The creature avoids being stung by the plant's nettles.

Success The creature is sickened 1 by the pain caused by brief contact with the nettles.

Failure The creature is sickened 1 by the pain caused by contact with the nettles and is also clumsy 1 for 8 hours from the lingering pain.

Critical Failure The creature is sickened 2 by the pain caused by contact with the nettles and is also clumsy 1 for 24 hours from the lingering pain.

Treasure: Lying half-buried in the mud on the southern shore (DC 20 Perception while Searching to locate) is a *+1 striking sickle*—all that remains of an overconfident druid Crackjaw killed and ate.

TW9. GUDRIN RIVER FORD

LANDMARK

Normally quite deep along most of its length, the Gudrin River becomes rather shallow here, creating a navigable ford across its width.

ZONE 4: KAMELANDS

While many refer to the central Stolen Lands as the Kamelands, the heart of these hills lies in this swath, extending into the Narlmarches to the west and up to the foothills of the Tors of Levenies to the east.



STINGING NETTLE

KAMELANDS (KL) — ZONE 4

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 3 table (page 70)	Varies
6–8	6 goblins[B1]	Low 4
9–11	1 troll[B1]	Low 4
12–13	3 twigjacks[B2]	Moderate 4
14–15	1 blodeuwedd[B2]	Moderate 4
16–17	1 will-o'-wisp[B1]	Moderate 4
18–19	1 wyvern[B1]	Moderate 4
20	4 dire wolves[B1]	Severe 4

Goblins An encounter with goblins in the Kamelands consists of four goblin commandos and two goblin pyros; these goblins are a small nomadic group and not part of the larger village at Greengripe (area **SH5**), but know about it and could, in theory, guide the PCs to it if they're defeated but spared.

KL1. TIRESSIA'S GROVE — MODERATE 4

RESOURCE STANDARD

The trees part to reveal a peaceful forest glade dappled with sunlight. A small pond lies placidly at the roots of an enormous oak tree with a scattering of leaves floating upon its surface. Birdsong twitters from the branches high above.

Creatures: This grove is the home of the dryad Tiressia and her satyr consort Falchos. Lately, they've been menaced by a scythe tree to the south that relishes the taste of dryad flesh. These two fey have tried to defeat the malevolent plant by themselves, but the tree has repelled their attempts to destroy or expel it. During their last attempt, Falchos suffered grievous injuries before they could flee back to the grove.

Though Tiressia is more powerful than most dryads, she's still unable to abandon her bonded oak. She has tried rallying the other fey creatures of the area to assist her, but none of them would agree to risk their own lives given what happened to Falchos. Tiressia is desperate to find help, while Falchos wrestles with the choice of abandoning his love or accepting his own inevitable death if he stays to face the scythe tree once it finally locates their home.

The PCs' arrival offers a ray of hope, however, and the fey are determined to enlist their aid by any means necessary. Tiressia would prefer not to use magical compulsion to get the PCs' help, so she acts the part of the damsel in distress, which at this point isn't much of a stretch. As the PCs approach, Tiressia kneels by the water's edge and begins weeping softly, her tears falling into the pool to create tiny ripples in the still water. Falchos hides just inside the tree line, watching the PCs warily and ready to jump out at a moment's notice to defend his lover if needed.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

If asked what's wrong, Tiressia tearfully describes the evil tree and the damage it has wreaked in the forest. Once the scythe tree has depleted the surrounding area of prey, she says, it will certainly come to her grove, kill her tree, and devour her. She begs the PCs to slay the hideous plant, promising to reward them handsomely if they do.

If the PCs do not appear to want to help, Tiressia and Falchos fall back on their fey magic. Falchos uses his pipes to cast *suggestion* (if the PCs seem undecided) or *charm* (if they are completely unwilling to help), while Tiressia uses her own *suggestion* or *charm* spells on anyone out of range of or unaffected by Falchos's music. Falchos follows this with his own spells if necessary. The two fey do not otherwise attack the PCs unless they're attacked first. If forced to defend themselves, Tiressia retreats into her oak if reduced to 30 Hit Points or fewer, praying that her attackers get bored and leave. As long as Tiressia lives, Falchos fights to the death.

If the PCs agree to help, the fey describe the way to the scythe tree's lair—a dark, blighted hollow a few miles to the south (area **KL2**).

FALCHOS CREATURE 4

Male satyr (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 284)
Initiative Stealth +11

TIRESSIA CREATURE 4

Elite female dryad (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 6, 246)
Initiative Perception +10

WRATH OF THE SCYTHE TREE

30 XP | 30 KINGDOM XP

The PCs must defeat the scythe tree that's menacing Tiressia and Falchos–if possible, without causing excessive damage to the surrounding forest.

Source: Tiressia and Falchos (area **KL1**)

Completion: Once the scythe tree is slain, Tiressia quickly learns of the event as the deed is whispered among the branches and roots of the Narlmarches.

Reward: Tiressia gives the PCs a *primeval mistletoe* and five *tree feather tokens* she keeps in her tree as a reward. In addition, if they agreed to aid her without being magically compelled by her or her lover, she also promises to aid the PCs in guarding the Narlmarches and keeps them updated about threats within its borders.

If the PCs Claim this Hex, their alliance with Tiressia allows them to treat this hex as a Refuge as long as they don't build a settlement here; in addition, the fey here provide aid in the form of a +2 circumstance bonus on all checks made to resolve dangerous Hex or Settlement events in this zone. If the PCs build a settlement here, Tiressia and Falchos quietly abandon the region, and the above benefits are lost.

KL2. THE BLIGHTED HOLLOW MODERATE 4

STANDARD

The sickly sweet stench of decay hangs thick in this woodland clearing. Knotted branches of dying trees line the perimeter, creating a thick canopy that blocks most of the sunlight and cloaks the hollow in shadow. Withered vegetation struggles to grow in ragged clumps among the multitude of bones strewn across the forest floor.

The thick canopy overhead casts heavy shadow during the day, so the clearing has dim light. The clearing itself is just over twenty feet in diameter. The bones strewn about the area are a tangled mix of animal and human remains.


TIRESSIA

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Creatures: A hideous, sadistic scythe tree hides along the north side of the clearing, hoping to catch wandering prey (like the PCs) by surprise. The scythe tree is an intelligent plant, but it does little with its intellect other than devise new and cruel methods to torment its food once it has secured meals—dryad flesh is particularly intoxicating to its palate. The monstrous plant looks like a dark brown tree, 20 feet tall, with dark, twisted roots; a few reddish-brown leaves hang on the wickedly curved scythe-like branches that give it its name. What looks like a long scar in the center of the tree's trunk splits open to reveal a toothy mouth when the creature attacks, which it does as soon as any of the PCs come within reach.

SCYTHE TREE CREATURE 6

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 235
Initiative Stealth +12

Treasure: Scattered among the bones are 42 cp, 55 sp, 26 gp, and a silver ring worth 7 gp. The scythe tree keeps other treasures under its roots; a PC who succeeds at a DC 20 Perception check locates a *dancing scarf* wrapped around three pieces of amber worth 10 gp each.

KL3. LAIR OF THE LIZARD KING

LANDMARK RESOURCE

This area is detailed in Part 6 of this chapter (page 136).

Resource: The lizardfolk who dwell here function as a Freehold. If the PCs bring this Freehold into their kingdom, they automatically gain a village settlement that contains the following free structures: Barracks, Houses, Shrine, and Wooden Walls; its four Urban Grid borders are also all Water borders.

KL4. CANDLEMERE ISLAND

LANDMARK RESOURCE

This area is detailed in Part 7 of this chapter (page 142).

Resource: If this hex is claimed and the dangers on the isle (including aboveground and in the basement, but not the lower levels detailed in Chapter 9) are defeated, it functions as a Refuge.

If a settlement is built on the island, all its borders must be Water borders and the settlement gains a free Watchtower. At the GM's discretion, the deeper dangers below may cause additional problems for those who choose to live here—see Chapter 9 for more details.

KL5. THE MUD BOWL SEVERE 6

STANDARD

A wide pool of bubbling mud sits in a defile between the hills here. Large mounds of fungus and mushrooms thrive on the mud bowl's banks, and in the noxious air, several of the fungi grow to heights of ten feet or more.

The mud is heated by geothermal activity, and although it's not hot enough to cause damage, it does count as difficult terrain to those who wade through it. In addition, when a breathing creature enters the mud, they must succeed at a DC 17 Fortitude save to avoid becoming sickened 1, after which they're temporarily immune to the noxious fumes for 24 hours regardless of their level of success on the saving throw. These vapors are an inhaled poison.

Creature: One particularly huge mound of fungus and rank vegetation near the north shore of the mud bowl might be mistaken for a small hillock or moss-covered boulder but is in fact a carnivorous plant known as a tendriculos. The immense monster stands more than 20 feet high when it lurches into action—something it does as soon as it senses the approach of any living prey. The tendriculos attacks with its fibrous, vine-like tentacles or its immense maw, a tendril-rimmed hole capable of distending wide enough to swallow a human whole.

TENDRICULOS CREATURE 7

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 257
Initiative Stealth +14

Treasure: The area immediately around the tendriculos's den supports a total of 18 full-grown black rattlecap mushrooms. These 8-inch-tall mushrooms have hollow caps filled with tiny hard balls of spores that, when shaken, make an unusual rattling sound. Each round of combat with the tendriculos that occurs within 20 feet of its starting point, 1d4–1 of these mushrooms are crushed into useless paste; those that survive can be harvested for the Old Beldame (as detailed in area **TW7**).

KL6. A CRY FOR HELP SEVERE 4

STANDARD

Creatures: A pair of cruel leucrottas roam this craggy section of the Kamelands, scouting an old trail that crosses a narrow creek. The leucrottas are allied with the troll Hargulka (detailed in Chapter 4, page 200) and are looking for territory he can add to his kingdom. If they notice the PCs, the leucrottas use their talent at voice mimicry to sound like a pair of humans in distress. You can use the creek map on the opposite page to run this encounter.

If the PCs defeat one of the leucrottas and reduce the other to 20 Hit Points or fewer, the survivor attempts to surrender. If its life is spared, it admits that they were both looking to earn the favor of "King Hargulka" and warns the PCs that the troll king is going to rule these lands very soon—they'd best do what they can to prepare their own offerings to King Hargulka, so

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

that when he demands their obedience, he won't be annoyed with them. The leucrottas know the troll king and his minions dwell in the woods of the southern Narlmarches, but aren't sure where.

LEUCROTTAS (2) CREATURE 5

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 162
Initiative Stealth +11

KL7. HUNTER'S LODGE

RESOURCE | STANDARD

This cozy hunter's lodge has been abandoned for years, but after the PCs establish their kingdom, a group rebuilds the lodge and, in time, invites the PCs on a dangerous hunt. See Chapter 5 for more details on this location.

Resource: If this hex is Claimed, the lodge functions as a Refuge. If a settlement is founded here, the lodge grants a free Popular Tavern to the settlement.

KL8. HUNTING GROUNDS

STANDARD

This region is particularly infested with dangerous monsters—a perfect place for a hunt! If the PCs explore this hex before Chapter 5 begins, they'll automatically encounter a wandering monster here. Later, additional dangers can be encountered here—see Part 2 of Chapter 5 for more details.

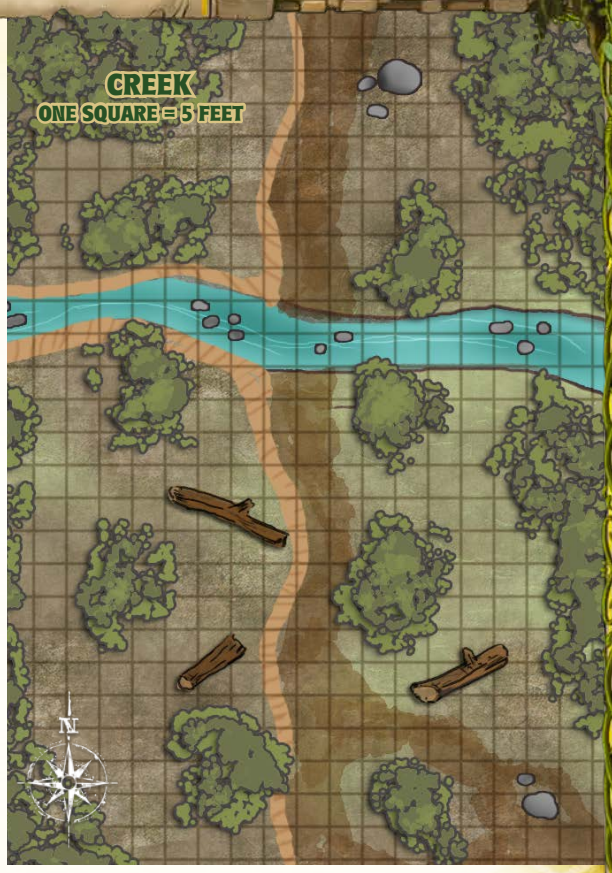
KL9. LAKE SILVERSTEP SEVERE 4

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

Lake Silverstep, so named for a legend that its waters filled the footprint of a great silver dragon many ages ago, is the cleanest and clearest source of water in the Stolen Lands. Its primary source is from the Gudrin River, but countless smaller rills and streams empty down the mountains in dramatic cascades into the lake's eastern shores in between several large mudflats (see area **KL10**). The western banks consist of idyllic swaths of nettles, cattails, reeds, and lilies, and are home to numerous nixies, grigs, and faerie dragons. These fey are incredibly shy, and it's unlikely that any of them will be brave enough to contact the PCs.

The waters of Lake Silverstep host an enormous variety of fish; the most common are small, thick-bodied silver eels—quite delicious and much sought after by gourmet chefs. The wild animals that often hunt along the shores of the lake, combined with the difficulty of catching silver eels (due to their uncanny ability to sense hooks in bait), ensure that demand for the eels remains high.

Creature: Anyone who spends much time in Lake Silverstep's waters or exploring its shores may, at your discretion, encounter one of the freshwater elasmosauruses that dwell within the lake's depths.



ELASMOSAURUS CREATURE 7

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 105
Initiative Perception +16

Resources: Although the lake encompasses numerous hexes, this particular hex is unusually rich in eels. If this hex is Claimed, all Fishing kingdom skill checks gain a +1 circumstance bonus; this increases to a +2 circumstance bonus if a settlement is built here.

MMMMMMM... EELS!

30 XP | 30 KINGDOM XP

Once the PCs reach 6th level, it shouldn't be long before they notice fliers posted around their town that make requests for Lake Silverstep eels. These requests come from a traveling chef named Beven Armaki—Beven's grown tired of plain old river eels but has heard that the eels of Lake Silverstep are particularly delicious!

Source: Beven Armaki (once the PCs reach 6th level)

Completion: The PCs must catch 12 eels; this can be accomplished either by a successful DC 27 Fishing check made as a Downtime activity during a Kingdom turn (which requires Claiming at least one hex that contains part of Lake Silverstep) or by a successful DC 27 Fishing Lore check made to Earn Income (which only requires the downtime to be spent on Lake Silverstep).

Reward: Beven rewards the PCs for their service with a family heirloom—a *+1 buckler*. In addition, if the PCs

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

wish (and have an available lot), Beven volunteers to build a Popular Tavern in one of their settlements. If the PCs agree, this tavern is automatically added at the start of the next Kingdom turn's Activities phase.

KL10. MUDFLATS MODERATE 6

STANDARD

This 3-mile-long, 1,500-foot-wide swath of lakeshore is a stretch of bubbling mud, heated by geothermal activity. The air is thick and muggy. Even though most of the mud lies in a low basin shielded from nearby Lake Silverstep by a small rock ridge, silt from the mud rarely seeps into the clear waters of the lake. The mudflats are difficult terrain.

Creatures: These mudflats are home to a pack of eight mudwretches. These filthy elementals have lurked in the mud here for ages, leftovers from an ancient elven experiment conducted along the shores of the lake involving energies siphoned from the Planes of Earth and Water. The mudwretches simply want to be left alone, but quickly rise to attack any intruders who enter their precious mudflats, fighting to the death.

MUDWRETCHES (8) CREATURE 2

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 176

Initiative Perception +9

Treasure: Hidden within these creatures' mud pool (DC 20 Perception check to discover) is a well-preserved corpse, mummified by the thick mud. It wears the trappings of a Taldan captain-general from two centuries ago and still carries a satchel containing a carefully wrapped platinum idol depicting a grinning skull-like figure, worth 100 gp. Who this mysterious warrior was and what may have brought them and their prize to this distant frontier remains a mystery.

ZONE 5: NARLMARCHES

The western border of the Central Stolen Lands features largely empty grasslands to the north, but to the south lie the densest and most dangerous reaches of the forest known as the Narlmarches.

NARLMARCHES (NM) ZONE 5

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 4 table (page 78)	Varies
6–8	1 hydra [B1]	Low 5
9–11	3 twigjacks[B2]	Low 5
12–13	2 trolls[B1]	Moderate 5
14–15	1 dweomercat[B2]	Moderate 5
16–17	4 trollhounds [B2]	Moderate 5
18–19	2 ogre spiders[B2]	Moderate 5
20	2 verdurous oozes[B2]	Severe 5

Trolls These trolls are not part of Hargulka's army, but they hope to be some day. They try to capture the PCs alive; if they do, they seek to deliver them to the king in hopes of buying their way into his good graces.

NM1. WARRIOR CAIRN

SECRET

Amid an overgrown section of blackberries lies a hidden cairn of stones marking the grave of a long-forgotten warrior. Individuals exploring this hex can notice the overgrown cairn with a successful DC 15 Perception check. The skeleton buried under the mound of stones was once the son of a leader among the Tiger Lords, from a time when that group's territory stretched all the way from Numeria to the Narlmarches—patrols from Rostland forced the Tiger Lords back to the east, and most of their cairns were toppled and the bodies looted—but this one has been forgotten, obscured as it is by brambles.

Treasure: Toppling the stones and exhuming the body takes 30 minutes of work. The corpse still wears tattered remnants of hide armor, and the skull displays a crushed-in wound that spelled this barbarian's doom. Of all the barbarian's gear, only a strange ring made of green wood on one finger seems of interest. The band depicts several tigers chasing each other; it's a *ring of the tiger* (page 589). The ring's unique appearance makes it quite recognizable, and openly displaying this ring could just as easily cause problems when the PCs encounter the Tiger Lords as it could solve them. Succeeding at a DC 20 Society or DC 15 Heraldry Lore check to Recall Knowledge reveals the ring's connection to the Tiger Lords. See Chapter 7, page 327, for more information.

NM2. STATUE OF ERASTIL

RESOURCE STANDARD

A fifteen-foot-tall statue of Erastil stands a silent vigil here, partially overgrown at the base but towering above the surrounding shrubbery.

Once a stony sentinel standing before a hunter's lodge, this statue is all that remains after a fire and centuries of growth obliterated the building itself. Yet despite years of neglect, the site remains sacred to the god of the hunt, for the priest who built it was particularly favored among the Taldan explorers. A worshipper of Erastil feels safe and at peace within 60 feet of this statue, and no wild animals will approach within that range; any wandering monster rolls that would result in a wild animal encounter in this area should be treated as no encounter, making this an excellent site for a camp.

If the statue is cleaned and a worshipper of Erastil prays before it, the god of the hunt takes note and grants that creature a minor boon: whenever that

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

creature critically fails a Survival check to Subsist in the wild, they gets a failure instead. Further cleanings and prayer do not cause a repeat of this one-time blessing.

Resource: If a settlement is built here, the statue grants a free Monument.

NM3. DEAD UNICORN

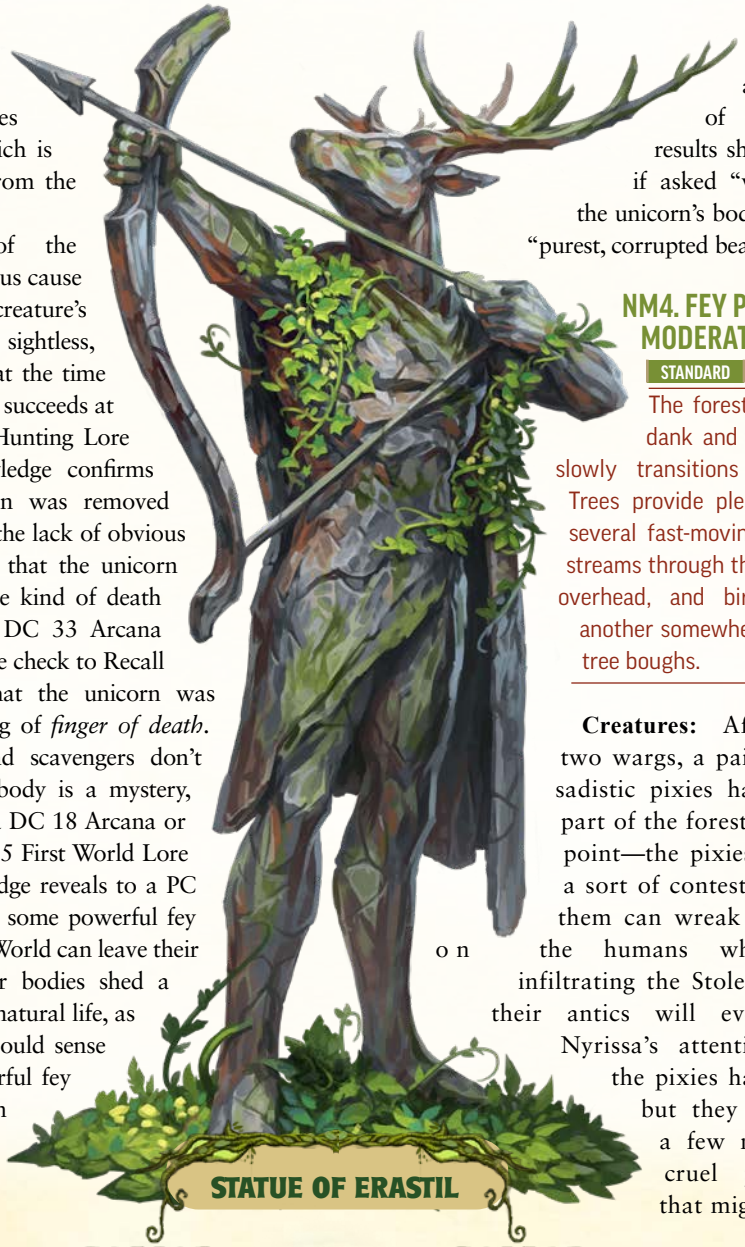
STANDARD

The stink of moldering plants and an ominous silence pervades a sunken clearing in the woods here. At the center of the clearing, the soggy ground pools into a stagnant, insect-infested, swamp-like pond. Sprawled at the pond's southern edge lies what appears to be a dead horse.

A closer look reveals the creature to be a dead unicorn, its horn broken off at the brow and its body strangely untouched by insects or other necrophages. The stink of mold comes not from the body, which is weirdly odorless, but from the pond's fouled water.

An examination of the unicorn reveals no obvious cause of death, although the creature's eyes are milky and sightless, indicating it was blind at the time of its passing. A PC who succeeds at a DC 15 Medicine or Hunting Lore check to Recall Knowledge confirms that the creature's horn was removed after its death, and that the lack of obvious wounds would indicate that the unicorn was likely slain by some kind of death effect. Succeeding at a DC 33 Arcana check or a DC 31 Nature check to Recall Knowledge confirms that the unicorn was slain by a primal casting of *finger of death*. The fact that bugs and scavengers don't seem interested in the body is a mystery, although succeeding at a DC 18 Arcana or Nature check or a DC 15 First World Lore check to Recall Knowledge reveals to a PC tales of how the acts of some powerful fey creatures from the First World can leave their victims "marked"—their bodies shed a strange aura that repels natural life, as if animals and vermin could sense the anger of such powerful fey and know better than to involve themselves with such a victim. Speaking to animals about the dead unicorn reveals only that the body "feels wrong," but nearby animals lack the ability to explain their feelings further.

The unicorn had the unfortunate fate of being in the wrong place at the right time—the nymph Nyrissa, as she prepares to capture the Stolen Land, is gathering "trophies" from certain creatures native to the region as keepsakes from a time before its eventual doom at her hand. She killed the unicorn using *finger of death* and took its horn; the PCs might find the horn along with other trophies in the nymph's lair in the final phases of the Adventure Path. If the PCs arrange to have the unicorn restored to life, it willingly tells them more about its killer, although it remains at a loss as to why a powerful nymph would murder it. *Talking corpse* is certainly a more affordable line of inquiry, although results should be evasive—if asked "who killed you?" the unicorn's body simply answers, "purest, corrupted beauty."



STATUE OF ERASTIL

NM4. FEY PRANKSTERS MODERATE 5

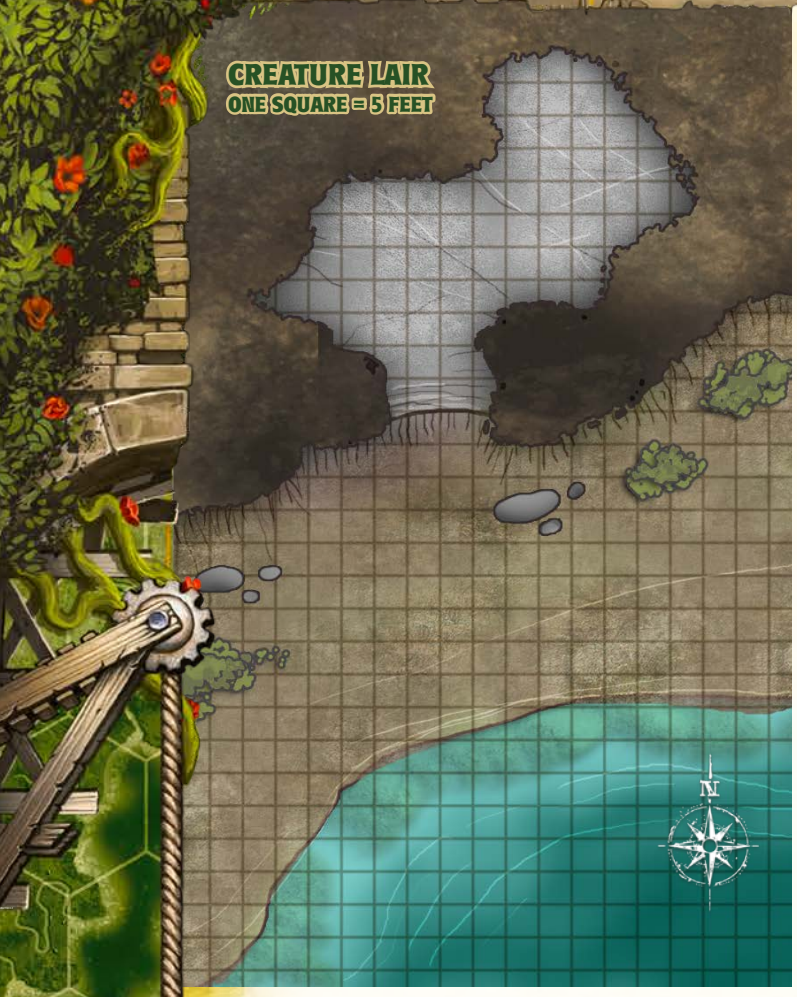
STANDARD

The forest floor grows more dank and wet as the terrain slowly transitions into swampland. Trees provide plentiful shade along several fast-moving creeks. Sunlight streams through the canopy of leaves overhead, and birds chirp to one another somewhere high among the tree boughs.

Creatures: After befriending two wargs, a pair of particularly sadistic pixies have claimed this part of the forest as a rendezvous point—the pixies are engaged in a sort of contest to see which of them can wreak the most havoc on the humans who have been infiltrating the Stolen Lands, hoping their antics will eventually attract Nyrissa's attention. Neither of the pixies have met Nyrissa, but they hope that with a few more months of cruel practical jokes, that might change. Their

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



jokes range from the annoying (spiking milk left on porches with hot pepper juice) to the downright cruel (kidnapping babies and leaving dead mites or shaved bear cubs in the crib). If they notice the PCs, they cast *invisibility* and hunker down on their wargs before ordering their mounts to attack intruders on sight, while they fire arrows or cast spells from their mounts' backs.

PIXIES (2) CREATURE 4

Pathfinder Bestiary 309
Initiative Perception +12

WARGS (2) CREATURE 2

Pathfinder Bestiary 322
Initiative Perception +8

NM5. THE FORGOTTEN KEEP

RESOURCE STANDARD

This site is detailed in Part 8 of this chapter (page 148).

Resource: The forgotten keep is a ruined Castle; if this hex is claimed and a settlement is built here, the ruin reduces the cost of building a Castle in this location by half.

NM6. HODAG DEN MODERATE 5

HIDDEN

Creature: A huge deadfall of trees and brambles lies in a mossy heap here, a mountain in miniature left from a violent windstorm several seasons ago. Numerous cave-like hollows can be found throughout the deadfall—one particularly deep cavern can be discovered with a successful DC 20 Perception check during the hex's exploration. This is the home of a particularly cantankerous hodag. The creature's den is a 30-foot diameter chamber with a tangle of dead trees that forms a natural dome-like ceiling. Dozens of bones and half-eaten carcasses (including those of several loggers and bandits) litter the lair—the hodag is a messy eater. The monster spends most of its time in its den and immediately attacks.

ELITE HODAG CREATURE 7

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 6, 145
Initiative Perception +16

Treasure: Within the hodag's filthy lair are three battleaxes, one greataxe, a suit of *+1 studded leather armor*, and a *+1 striking spear* that was lodged in the hodag's back after an encounter with a frightened lumberjack—the monster eventually managed to dislodge the spear by rubbing its back against the lair's walls.

NM7. HARGULKA'S STRONGHOLD

HIDDEN RESOURCE

This ancient dwarven ruin is now the home to a dangerous clan of trolls—see Chapter 4.

Resource: If this hex is cleared of danger and then Claimed, the stronghold functions as a Refuge.

ZONE 6: SELLEN HILLS

The rolling hills through which the Little Sellen River flows are strewn with boulders and copses of trees, with miles of green ridges stretching between them. Yet it would be a mistake to view this idyllic landscape as safe, for dangerous creatures dwell in the shaded vales here.

SELLEN HILLS (SH) ZONE 6

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll 1d12+8 on zone 5 table (page 82)	Varies
6–8	2 trolls[B1]	Low 6
9–11	3 megaloceroses (page 608)	Low 6
12–13	2 manticores[B1]	Moderate 6
14–15	2 wyverns[B1]	Moderate 6
16–17	6 cultists	Moderate 6
18–19	1 bulette[B1]	Moderate 6
20	1 aurumvorax[B2]	Severe 6

Cultists These cultists are worshippers of Lamashtu who are indirectly affiliated with the Cult of the Bloom. If this encounter occurs before Chapter 5 has begun, the cultists aren't yet full members of the cult and know

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

only that they've been lured to the region by visions. The cultists consist of five ruffians (*Gamemastery Guide* 209) led by an antipaladin (*Gamemastery Guide* 247).

WANTED: MANTICORE

30 XP

The local (and quite eccentric) poet Iosis Vemarelian wants to write a complex epic using only pens crafted from manticore spikes. He wants a healthy collection of them at hand to see him through this strange epic, and puts up wanted posters once the PCs reach 6th level.

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Spikes can be harvested from a dead manticore with a successful DC 24 Survival check; a successful harvest from two manticores is enough to meet Iosis's needs.

Reward: In exchange for delivery of the manticore spikes, Iosis promises payment in the form of a rare book of halfling poetry worth 200 gp.

SH1. DRAKE NEST — MODERATE 6

STANDARD

Creatures: A lone flame drake dwells in a small cave deep in these woods, having fled here several years ago after it was driven from its nest by its nestmates. Its time in the woods has treated it well, and it has grown much larger than a typical specimen of its kind. While not as intelligent as a true dragon, the flame drake possesses great cunning. It might ambush a small group of travelers or stalk a party until it can pick off a lone straggler or two. The flame drake's lair is impossible to miss once the PCs explore this hex, for the shore of a nearby pool is littered with burnt and rotten meat, cracked and scorched bones, and scattered items of gnawed-on equipment. You can use the Creature Lair map to run this encounter.

ENORMOUS FLAME DRAKE — CREATURE 8

UNIQUE | CE | LARGE | DRAGON | FIRE

Variant flame drake (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 131)

Perception +16; darkvision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet, smoke vision

Languages Draconic

Skills Acrobatics +14, Athletics +18, Stealth +14, Survival +16

Str +6, **Dex** +2, **Con**+4, **Int** –1, **Wis** +4, **Cha** +0

Smoke Vision Smoke doesn't impair a flame drake's vision; it ignores concealment from smoke.

AC 27; **Fort** +18, **Ref** +16, **Will** +16

HP 140; **Immunities** fire, paralyzed, unconscious; **Weaknesses** cold 10

Attack of Opportunity ↷ fangs only.

Melee ❖ fangs +20, **Damage** 2d8+8 piercing plus 1d8 fire

Melee ❖ tail +20 (reach 10 feet), **Damage** 2d6+8 bludgeoning

Draconic Frenzy ❖❖ The flame drake Strikes twice with its fangs and once with its tail in any order.

Fireball Breath ❖❖ (arcane, evocation, fire) The flame drake expels a ball of flame to a range of 180 feet that explodes in a 20-foot burst. Creatures in the burst take 9d6 fire damage (DC 26 basic Reflex save). The flame drake can't use Fireball Breath again for 1d6 rounds.

Speed Surge ❖ (move) **Frequency** three times per day; **Effect** The flame drake Strides or Flies up to twice its Speed.

Treasure: Strewn about the underbrush are the discarded possessions of the flame drake's most recent victim, an unfortunate elf scout. Most of the gear is ruined, but the following items can still be salvaged: a *+1 chain shirt*, a *+1 composite longbow*, and a bloodstained *cloak of elvenkind*.

WANTED: FLAME DRAKE

30 XP

The flame drake in area **SH1** is responsible for the rumors of a "dragon" haunting the Sellen Hills, and once the PCs reach 6th level, they'll start seeing wanted posters for this creature.

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Slay the enormous flame drake.

Reward: A bounty of 400 gp is offered by a consortium of concerned lumberjacks.

SH2. THE WANDERING GIANT — LOW 6

STANDARD

Creatures: Depressed after being rebuffed by the trolls in area **NM7** when he tried to join their gang, a dull-witted hill giant named Munguk has been trying to forget his troubles by looking for blue wolfberries to make moonshine, hunting game, and seeking a mate (in that order). Unfortunately for Munguk, blue wolfberries are not in season, his loud singing has scared away the game, and there are no suitable hill giant mates within miles. Munguk has been on the hunt for 4 days now with nothing to show for it but a rapidly diminishing jug of wolfberry moonshine, and he's in a particularly foul mood, lashing out at boulders, trees, and the PCs if he even notices them—he is currently taking a –2 circumstance penalty on Perception checks due to his depression and drunkenness. PCs who come upon the giant without his noticing their approach find him squatting on a rock, trying to drink the last drops of moonshine out of a broken jug.

If the PCs offer Munguk at least 3 gallons of something alcoholic to drink, they gain a +2 circumstance bonus on Diplomacy checks to Make an Impression on the giant (he is initially unfriendly to the PCs). If made at least friendly, Munguk can tell them about the Forgotten Keep (area **NM5**), the lizardfolk village (area **KL3**), and the troll lair (area **NM7**). If

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

made helpful, he'll also give them his map (detailed in the Treasure section below).

If combat breaks out, Munguk drunkenly throws a rock at an enemy then charges in to fight with his greatclub. In his state, he starts combat with the sickened 1 condition (which he cannot remove during this fight). He fights until reduced to 30 Hit Points or fewer. At that point, he drops to the ground, crying and blubbering, apologizing profusely in slurred Jotun while begging for mercy.

MUNGUK **CREATURE 7**

Male hill giant (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 170)

Initiative Perception +12



Treasure: In addition to his hide armor, Munguk carries a crude hide sack containing his worldly possessions. Inside are five throwing rocks, a wooden bowl and spoon, an empty clay moonshine jug, a few strips of dried dwarf jerky, a glass jar containing a partially eaten pickled sheep's head, a bent grappling hook attached to 5 feet of frayed rope, and 6 gp. Also in the bag is a crude map, sketched on the back of a piece of smelly, uncured hide. Although the map is labeled in Jotun, Munguk is far from literate, and a DC 20 Society check is needed to Decipher it. The map highlights the location of Hargulka's lair (area **NM7**) with the legend "mean ugly troll-bully" scrawled in blue wolfberry juice.

Reward: If the PCs manage to negotiate their encounter with Munguk peacefully, grant them XP as if they had defeated him in combat.

SH3. ABANDONED FERRY STATION

LANDMARK RESOURCE

Half-collapsed, rotting wooden buildings stand on each bank where the Shrike River branches off the Little Sellen River. The buildings have been used as lairs by kobolds, mites, and even a few groups of bandits in the past, but currently they're unoccupied.

Resource: If the PCs build a settlement here, the buildings are mostly a lost cause, but several wooden docks remain fully functional, granting the settlement a free pier structure.

SH4. BEAST'S LAIR

HIDDEN RESOURCE

This location is the den of a particularly enormous owlbear. See Chapter 4 for details on this site.

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex and defeat its dangers, the Beast's lair serves as a Refuge.

SH5. GREENGRIPE

LANDMARK

A steep-sided but flat-topped hill looms here, atop which sprawls the goblin village of Greengripe. This location is detailed in Chapter 5.

Resource: Greengripe is a Freehold. If the PCs bring Greengripe into their kingdom, they automatically gain a village settlement that contains the following free structures: Alchemy Lab, Shrine, Stables, Tenements, and Wooden Walls; its four Urban Grid borders are all Land borders.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

SH6. WHISPERING GROTTO

RESOURCE | SECRET

Succeeding at a DC 12 Perception check made while Reconnoitering this hex allows the PCs to notice a strange and somewhat unsettling sound, almost as if the whispering of a group of hidden conspirators were carried on the wind that blows through an otherwise unremarkable dale between two hills. A PC who rolls a critical success notices numerous small holes in the ground and hillside; as the wind blows over these narrow fissures, it generates the unsettling noise.

Anyone who peers into these small fissures is greeted by a wondrous sight—a glittering collection of crystals. The narrow caverns that riddle this area contain a sizable deposit of gemstones, providing an excellent economic resource for a kingdom that claims this hex as its own.

Resource: This gemstone deposit allows for a specialized mine to be built in this hex. If the PCs Claim this hex and then Establish a mine Work Site here, the mine generates 1 Luxury Commodity each turn rather than Ore.

SH7. DRAGONLEAF GULCH MODERATE 6

STANDARD

The Little Sellen River narrows as it passes through a gully between two rocky hillsides here, flowing around an oblong island thick with vegetation. This narrow island is 10 feet wide and 75 feet long; the river narrows to a width of 10 feet on either side of the island. The cliff walls of the gully are 40 feet high and can be Climbed with a DC 20 Athletics check.

Creatures: Lurking amid the thick reeds, nettles, and blackberries that grow on the island are six snapping flytraps. The carnivorous plants scramble to attack anyone Small or larger who approaches the banks of their island; the confines of the surrounding gully allow the plants to snap and grab at targets on either side of the island, including those that cling to the cliff walls within 10 feet of the river surface.

SNAPPING FLYTRAPS (6) CREATURE 3

Pathfinder Bestiary 160
Initiative Stealth +13

Treasure: A PC who Searches the island and succeeds at a DC 25 Perception check finds a large number of bones—evidence of several flytrap victims. Most of the bones are from goblins or humans. Scattered among them is some treasure: 320 cp, 345 sp, 13 gp, a bastard sword in an elegant darkwood scabbard worth 15 gp, a *wand of continuation* (2nd), and a tattered leather-bound journal whose pages are illegible, save for a section where the formula for a *heartbond* ritual (*Advanced Player's Guide* 242) may be salvaged.

SH8. CRADLE OF LAMASHTU

RESOURCE | SECRET

A hidden cave entrance lies on the steep, southern face of these ragged low tors. A successful DC 30 Perception check is required for a character to spot the cave entrance while Reconnoitering the hex, but if the PCs explore the cavern before beginning Chapter 5, feel free to place any other creatures of your choosing here. Once the Season of Bloom begins, this cavern becomes the headquarters for the sinister Cult of the Bloom—see Chapter 5 for full details.

Resource: Once the dangers of this cavern have been dealt with and the cult is defeated, it functions as a Refuge if the hex is Claimed.

ZONE 7: DUNSWARD

The plains and hills south of Rostland are quite dangerous, and not only due to the presence of centaur clans who dwell here, but also a violent band of spriggans who won't take kindly to any attempts to settle lands they view as theirs.

DUNSWARD (DS) ZONE 7

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	6 centaurs[B1]	Low 7
6–8	3 ogre spiders[B2]	Low 7
9–11	1 bulette[B1]	Low 7
12–15	4 spriggans[B2]	Low 7
16–17	4 cyclopes[B1]	Moderate 7
18–19	1 roc[B1]	Moderate 7
20	1 peluda[B2]	Severe 7

Centaurs These centaurs are suspicious of any intrusions into Dunsward, but they don't initiate attacks–rather, they observe the PCs from a few hundred feet away and let them make the first move. If they encounter violence, they attack at once, fleeing as soon as half their number are slain, but otherwise the PCs might be able to chat with them. These are members of the Nomen centaur clan–more details on them can be found in Chapter 6.

Spriggans A group of four spriggan bullies led by a spriggan warlord make up this encounter. They are not part of the band the PCs are set to encounter in Varnhold after that settlements' citizens vanish.

WANTED: SPIDERSILK

30 XP

Local weaver Chamaie Lerian heard that the ogre spiders that dwell in the eastern Stolen Lands spin the softest silk in the area. She asks for a delivery of several dozen square yards of good silk harvested from ogre spider dens (including those of trapdoor ogre spiders).

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Harvesting silk from a dead ogre spider requires a successful DC 25 Nature check; five successes is enough to gather the amount of silk Chamaie desires.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Reward: Chamaie promises a set of silk *slippers of spider climbing* as a reward for whoever can supply her silk needs.

DS1. NOMEN BURIAL MOUNDS — SEVERE 7

RESOURCE | STANDARD

An elaborate grouping of eight-foot-high stone mounds can be seen here. Each is made of loose stones and connected to adjacent mounds by a three-foot-high stone wall. The entire collection of twenty-nine mounds forms an asymmetric spiral pattern, slightly overgrown and covered with lichen.

A PC who succeeds at a DC 25 Society or Religion check confirms that these are centaur burial mounds. On a critical failure, the PC misinterprets the spiral as symbols of either Pharasma or Yog-Sothoth, perhaps something associated with summoning rituals to call in psychopomps or eldritch monstrosities.

Creatures: Recently, a group of four of manticores has claimed this area as their territory. If the manticores spot the party early, they take to the air and swoop down to attack at once with their tail spikes, landing to fight in melee only once they've used up that day's dozen spikes. If three of the manticores are killed, the final one flees and does not return.

MANTICORES (4) — CREATURE 6

Pathfinder Bestiary 232
Initiative Perception +14

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex, the Nomen centaur clan takes extreme offense—their Negotiation DC (found on page 519) increases by 4 until the PCs Abandon the hex.

DS2. WEB LURKER LAIR — MODERATE 7

STANDARD

A massive bridge made of thick spider webs hangs suspended between two crags on the mountainside here. The web bridge is thirty feet wide and hangs above a fifty-foot-deep chasm, the walls of which are riddled with shallow caves. The far side of the web bridge is a single ledge that goes nowhere, but upon it lays what appears to be a long-dead dwarf clutching a glowing warhammer.

The gorge sides can be Climbed with a DC 20 Athletics check.

Creatures: This whole area is a relatively obvious ambush created by a group of hardy web lurkers. They lurk not in their webs but in the shallow caves below, watching and waiting for food to be lured out onto the web bridge. Unfortunately for the web lurkers, the out-of-the-way location of their lair means that few travelers come out this far, and of those who do, even fewer are willing to be lured out onto what is obviously a giant spider web. The web lurkers are patient, though, and have managed to avoid becoming frustrated, even though the bridge they think is a great trap hasn't secured them more food. The web lurkers are accompanied by their pet—an equally patient pale-brown ogre spider with sparkling blue eyes and ivory-colored markings on its abdomen that almost resemble a stylized goat skull.

If the PCs fall victim to the web trap, the ogre spider and web lurkers clamber down to attack anyone who fell. If none of the PCs fall victim to the trap, the web lurkers immediately engage in a bitter, bickering fight among themselves over who is to blame for the trap's failure. They spend 1d3 rounds arguing (or until the PCs attack one of them directly) before they realize that the real enemy (and dinner) is above. A web lurker can automatically use Crafting to disable the web trap, after which they and the ogre spider can safely cross the bridge to attack PCs who stay on the far side.

OGRE SPIDER — CREATURE 5

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 249
Initiative Perception +13

ELITE WEB LURKERS (4) — CREATURE 4

Pathfinder Bestiary 6, 325
Initiative Stealth +13

Hazard: The web bridge has been rigged to collapse.

DROPPING WEB TRAP — HAZARD 2

MECHANICAL | TRAP

Stealth DC 21 (expert)
Description A 30-foot-wide rope bridge spans a 30-foot-deep chasm between two crags on the mountainside.
Disable DC 15 Crafting or DC 18 Thievery to secure the bridge in place.
Collapse ↻ **Trigger** One Large, two Medium, or three Small creatures move onto the rope bridge; **Effect** The bridge collapses and creatures on the bridge fall 30 feet, taking 15 points of bludgeoning damage. The triggering creatures can attempt a DC 18 Reflex save to Grab an Edge to avoid falling.
Reset 1 hour.

Treasure: Amid the clutter of bones and dried husks in the caves is a web-shrouded chest holding 435 sp and 108 cp. The dead dwarf on the far ledge still clutches his softly glowing *+1 striking warhammer*. The breastplate the dwarf wears is rusted and ruined, but a *grim trophy talisman* that looks like a claw remains affixed to the broken armor.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

DS3. KIRAVOY BRIDGE

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

This simple wooden bridge is a new addition to the landscape, recently built by the settlers of Varnhold. As such, if the PCs visit this area before they defeat the Stag Lord, they'll find the bridge still under construction. The bridge itself is sturdy and well built, but it doesn't show much evidence of use—it was finished only recently.

Resources: This hex has already been developed by Varnhold. If the PCs Claim this hex before Varnhold vanishes (as detailed in Chapter 6), the aggressive act immediately severs any diplomatic relations the PCs may have with Varnhold and increases all future Negotiation DCs with Varnhold to DC 30.

After Varnhold vanishes, though, the PCs can Claim this hex without issue. Once Claimed, the work that Varnhold already put in here means that any attempt to Establish Farmland in this hex not only gains a +2 circumstance bonus to the Agriculture check, but the result of the check is improved by one degree of success.

DS4. SPIDER FIELDS SEVERE 7

STANDARD

Creatures: In exploring the Greenbelt, the PCs may have encountered giant trapdoor spiders, but those creatures are tiny compared to the much larger ogre spider variants that dwell in the Dunsward. These elephant-sized, hairy, black-and-red monsters are truly horrifying, and this region of the Dunsward is particularly infested with their hidden lairs. The fields here appear strangely barren and are covered with numerous low hummocks of grassy mounds—several of which are in fact the doors to spider lairs.

In all, there are six trapdoor ogre spiders in this area. A giant trapdoor spider has greater cover within its pit-shaped trap.

TRAPDOOR OGRE SPIDER CREATURE 5

UNCOMMON | N | HUGE | ANIMAL

Variant ogre spider (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 249)

Perception +13; darkvision

Skills Acrobatics +13, Athletics +13 Stealth +13

Str +6, **Dex** +4, **Con** +4, **Int** –5, **Wis** +2, **Cha** –4

AC 23; **Fort** +15, **Ref** +13, **Will** +9

HP 70

Trapdoor Lunge ↷ **Trigger** A creature comes within 25 feet of the spider's lair while the spider is positioned just under the ajar trapdoor and the spider notices the creature; **Requirements** Initiative has not yet been rolled; **Effect** The spider Strides or Climbs before it rolls initiative.

Speed 30 feet, climb 30 feet

Melee ❖ fangs +15 (reach 10 feet), **Damage** 2d8+8 piercing plus ogre spider venom

Eerie Flexibility A trapdoor ogre spider can fit through tight spaces as if it were a Large creature. While Squeezing, it can move at full speed.

Ogre Spider Venom (poison); **Saving Throw** Fortitude DC 22; **Maximum Duration** 6 rounds; **Stage 1** 1d6 poison damage (1 round); **Stage 2** 1d6 poison damage, clumsy 1, and flat-footed (1 round); **Stage 3** 2d6 poison damage, clumsy 1, and flat-footed (1 round); **Stage 4** 2d6 poison and paralyzed (1 round).

Treasure: Each of the spider's pits has a scattering of coins, gems, and jewelry worth 20 gp. One pit also contains a partially eaten human still wearing *+1 striking handwraps of mighty blows* and *boots of elvenkind*.



TRAPDOOR OGRE SPIDER

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

DS5. VARNHOLD

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

Before the PCs defeat the Stag Lord, Maegar Varn and his followers are still building their own village here. See Chapter 6 for full details on Varnhold.

Resource: Varnhold is a Freehold town, and the PCs' Kingdom must be at least 3rd level before integrating it. Varnhold is a town that has 1 Water border and 3 Land borders. It occupies four blocks on the Urban Grid, and all 16 of its lots have structures built. These consist of the following: Brewery, Houses (4), Inn, Shrine, Smithy, Stable, Tannery, Town Hall, Trade Shop (gemcutter), Trade Shop (potter), Trade Shop (tailor), and Trade Shop (weaver).

DS6. BLOOD FURROWS — MODERATE 7

STANDARD

A number of strange furrows scar the grass in this area, disrupted here and there by sinkhole-like depressions and mounds of earth and soil.

Creature: This region is the territory of a single, cantankerous bulette that the centaur clan has named Kankerata ("world chewer" or "earth eater"). Kankerata has dominated this region for decades, contrary to the typical behavior pattern of bulettes (normally, these beasts move on to find new territories once they've exhausted their supply of prey). By now, the creature and its diggings have become a part of the Dunsward's landscape: the centaurs are fond of daring each other to race through Kankerata's network of drifts and nests—they view this feat as a test of bravery and often use it to settle disputes.

Kankerata is an enormous bulette and has become a clever hunter in its old age. The beast is observant and swift, and quickly moves to attack anyone who loiters in the region.

KANKERATA — CREATURE 9

Elite bulette (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 6, 48)

Initiative Perception +18

ZONE 8: NOMEN HEIGHTS

The Nomen Heights were once on the fringe of an ancient cyclops empire, but today they're claimed by a clan of centaurs self-named after the region. These rugged hills offer plenty of narrow vales to hide in.

NOMEN HEIGHTS (NH) — ZONE 8

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 7 table (page 87)	Varies
6–8	6 centaurs[B1]	Trivial 8
9–11	4 cyclopes[B1]	Low 8
12–13	2 chimeras[B1]	Moderate 8
14–15	1 peluda[B1]	Moderate 8
16–17	4 zombie hulks[B1]	Moderate 8
18–19	4 wyverns[B1]	Moderate 8
20	2 mastodons[B2]	Severe 8

Centaurs These centaurs are suspicious of any intrusions into the Nomen Heights, but don't initiate attacks—rather, they observe the PCs from a few hundred feet away and let them make the first move. If they encounter violence, they attack at once, fleeing as soon as half their number are slain, but otherwise the PCs might be able to chat with them. These members belong to the Nomen centaur clan—more details on this clan can be found in Chapter 6.

Zombie Hulks These undead cyclopes have grown increasingly more common in Nomen Heights now that the lich Vordakai is active once again. The hunks of meat they use are often torn from the bodies of defeated centaurs.

THE NOMEN PROBLEM

30 XP

Once the PCs reach 8th level, an envoy from Restov contacts them with a request from the government to deal with the so-called "Nomen problem." The centaurs have long caused trouble with their neighbors to the northeast, and Restov has grown tired of it. They ask the PCs to either drive off the Nomen centaur clan or to forge an alliance with them.

Source: Restov envoy (once PCs reach 8th level)

Completion: The PCs must either establish diplomatic relations with the Nomen centaurs or drive them out of the region through warfare.

Reward: The swordlords of Restov pay a 500 gp reward to the PCs for solving this problem, be it via diplomacy or violence.

NH1. NOMEN CAMPSITE

STANDARD

The Nomen clan dwells here—see Chapter 6.

NH2. THE LINNORM'S GRAVE — SEVERE 8

LANDMARK

The massive bones of a long-dead serpentine dragon of incredible size lie upon a hilltop here. Bleached white ribs protrude up into the air like strange trees, and the moss-draped skull provides nesting grounds for dozens of families of shrikes.

Succeeding at a DC 36 Arcana check or DC 31 Dragon Lore check to Recall Knowledge allows a PC to identify these remains as those of a crag linnorm. The local centaurs revere this site, often making trips to the bones to leave offerings of meat and wine before the immense skull, holding the belief that keeping the linnorm's spirit happy prevents its ghost from returning to this world.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Creatures: Small herds of mastodons graze in the hills and valleys of Nomen Heights, but in this area, the numbers of mastodons increase. Currently, a herd of 15 wanders this area, but most of these are relatively nonaggressive. Each time the PCs attempt any hexploration activities in this hex, one PC must attempt a DC 26 Nature check to keep the group from angering the herd. On a failure, two mastodons charge the PCs while the remaining beasts stampede off in the other direction.

MASTODONS (2) CREATURE 9

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 116
Initiative Perception +17

Reward: The first time the PCs manage to perform a hexploration activity here without angering the mastodons, grant them 80 XP.

ZONE 9: TORS OF LEVENIES

The Tors of Levenies are the largest (but not the tallest) of the mountain ranges within the Stolen Lands. Travel through these trackless and ragged mountains is hampered by difficult terrain, though encounter areas here typically have enough normal terrain (in the form of ledges or valley floors) for creatures to move around easily.

TORS OF LEVENIES (LV) ZONE 9

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 8 table (page 90)	Varies
6–8	4 zombie hulks[B1]	Low 9
9–11	2 chimeras[B1]	Low 9
12–13	2 leukodaemons[B1]	Moderate 9
14–15	1 meladaemon[B2]	Moderate 9
16–17	1 thunderbird [B2]	Moderate 9
18–19	6 wyverns[B1]	Moderate 9
20	One great cyclops[B1]	Severe 9

Daemons Any daemons encountered in the Tors of Levenies are creatures that have been drawn to this plane by Vordakai and set loose to work their evils as they see fit. At your discretion, a captured daemon who is forced to speak to the PCs could lead them to the location of Vordakai's Tomb—or could just as easily lead them somewhere else entirely before abandoning them in the wild or turning on them and attacking again.

LV1. VARNHOLD PASS

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

The rugged Tors of Levenies dip low here, creating a natural pass from the east to the west. The Crooked River flows down to the west, cascading out of the mountains just under the pass's highest elevation of 200 feet, leaving 150-foot-high sheer cliffs to the north and south. A single stone watchtower sits at the top of the pass. It's currently abandoned, with no signs of struggle within. Anyone who climbs to the top of the 30-foot-tall tower on a clear day can see the village of Varnhold to the southeast.

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex, the building counts as a Refuge; if the PCs later build a settlement here, the structure grants that settlement a free Watchtower.

LV2. TALON PEAK SEVERE 9

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

A crumbling tower stands atop a low mountain here. Known locally as Talon Peak because the jagged ruins of the tower look almost like a sharp claw protruding from the peak of the steep mountain, this location has been the nesting ground of rocs for many years. Recently, a particularly dangerous roc with black plumage has moved in.

While the Tors of Levenies are themselves quite hard to navigate, attempting to fully explore Talon Peak is particularly difficult (this hex counts as greater difficult terrain for purposes of hexploration).

One need not reach the apex of Talon Peak to Travel or Reconnoiter this hex, but to reach the tower at its peak, the final 250 feet of the journey requires non-flying creatures to succeed at a DC 25 Athletics check to Climb. If the PCs aren't particularly concerned with speed and are willing to take an hour to make the climb, only one PC needs to succeed at the check; the others can Follow the Expert. On a failure, every PC involved in the climb takes 8d6 bludgeoning damage (DC 28 basic Reflex save) over the hour from falls and tumbles. On a critical failure, the PCs fail the attempt to reach the top of Talon Peak.

Creature: The midnight-black roc that currently nests in the ruined tower atop Talon Peak once lived in the Branthlend Mountains, but when her mate was killed by the black dragon Ilthuliak a year ago, she relocated to this nesting site in the Tors of Levenies. One day, she may well migrate to another region if the urge to find a new mate takes her, but for now, the beast is content hunting and feeding here.

When the PCs arrive, roll a DC 11 flat check. On a success, the Talon Peak roc is present and attacks ferociously to defend its nest; otherwise, the roc is hunting and its nest is undefended. The roc returns in 1d4 hours; if its eggs have been disturbed, the creature immediately starts searching the area nearby for the cause of the disturbance.

TALON PEAK ROC CREATURE 12

UNIQUE | N | GARGANTUAN | ANIMAL

Variant roc *(Pathfinder Bestiary* 281)
Perception +22, low-light vision
Skills Acrobatics +20, Athletics +24
Str +8, **Dex** +5, **Con** +7, **Int** –4, **Wis** +4, **Cha** +0
AC 33; **Fort** +25, **Ref** +23, **Will** +20
HP 220

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Wing Rebuff ↷ **Trigger** A creature moves from beyond the reach of the roc's wing to within the reach of the roc's wing; **Effect** The roc makes a wing Strike against the triggering creature. If the roc Pushes the creature, it disrupts the triggering move action.

Speed 20 feet, fly 60 feet

Melee ❖ beak +26 (reach 15 feet), **Damage** 3d12+12 piercing

Melee ❖ talon +26 (agile, reach 15 feet), **Damage** 3d8+12 slashing plus Improved Grab

Melee ❖ wing +26 (agile, reach 30 feet), **Damage** 2d8+12 bludgeoning plus Improved Push 10 feet

Flying Strafe ❖❖ The roc Flies up to its Speed and makes two talon Strikes at any point during that movement. Each Strike must target a different creature. Each attack takes the normal multiple attack penalty.

Snack The roc gains a +2 circumstance bonus to hit with its beak if the target is grabbed or restrained in its talon.

Snatch The Talon Peak roc can Fly at half Speed while it has a creature grabbed or restrained in either or both of its talons, carrying that creature along with it.



TALON PEAK ROC

Treasure: Two dead adventurers lie strewn about the nest. Among their remains are 30 gp, a gold ring worth 50 gp, a *staff of evocation*, a suit of *+1 full plate*, a *+1 scimitar*, and a *type I bag of holding* filled with a dozen polished (but valueless) gremlin skulls.

If the PCs are trying to fulfill the Omelet King quest (page 525), three eggs in this nest can satisfy that quest's goal. A roc egg measures 4 feet in diameter and weighs 200 pounds; it counts as 22 Bulk for the purposes of transporting it (while this is below the *bag of holding*'s limit, the bag's opening is far too small to accommodate a roc egg). A roc egg has Hardness 3 and 16 HP (BT 8).

TRANSPORT A ROC EGG

EXPLORATION | CONCENTRATE | MOVE

Working as a group, you attempt to transport a roc egg safely through wilderness terrain. You move at one-quarter your travel speed to keep the egg from being jostled or damaged too badly in transport. If four or more characters work together at this activity, the egg can be transported safely. If three or fewer characters transport the egg, one must succeed at a DC 25 Athletics check and the others must Follow the Expert. If two or fewer characters are working together, the DC increases to 27, and if only one character is attempting to Transport the Egg, the DC remains 27 but they also treat their actual result as one degree of success worse than their rolled result. At your discretion, if the PCs come up with a particularly ingenious method for transporting the egg, they can gain up to a +3 circumstance bonus to the Athletics check. And of course, the use of magic like *shrink item* or *teleport* can automatically ensure success without having to use a special activity to Transport the Egg at all.

Critical Success You protect the egg from damage and move at half your travel speed instead of one-quarter.

Success You protect the egg from damage.

Failure The egg takes 1d8 points of damage.

Critical Failure The egg takes 2d8 points of damage.

Resource: If the PCs build a settlement here, the tower serves as a Ruined Watchtower.

LV3. CULCHEK CAVE

HIDDEN | RESOURCE

Once the lair of the Culchek spriggans—the group that invades the village of Varnhold in Chapter 6—this cave is likely abandoned by the time the PCs reach the

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

area. The entrance remains difficult to find, hidden as it is behind a spur of rock and concealing brush; a character must succeed at a DC 20 Perception check to reveal its location during Reconnoitering of the hex. The 15-room complex is completely empty—when the spriggans moved into Varnhold, they took everything of value and destroyed all that was left behind. (If the PCs happen to arrive here early in the campaign, feel free to use the spriggans detailed in Chapter 6, designing your own cave complex for your players to explore.)

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex after the caves are abandoned, the Culcheck cave serves as a Refuge.

LV4. THE GHOST STONE MODERATE 9

STANDARD

A strange, gray monolith, its stone sides polished and smooth, stands at the western end of a valley here.

The local centaurs refer to this as the Ghost Stone, for at night, the air surrounding the stone within a 120-foot radius glows with a soft radiance, while strange, ghostly shapes flit and writhe through the air around it. The Ghost Stone itself is a spire-like structure with a dull point that stands 15 feet high—an ancient elven relic, abandoned and forgotten. It once served as the foundation for a portal to the Ethereal Plane, but today it serves only to make the boundary between this world and the next unnaturally thin. On the Ethereal Plane, the area glows with a strange, bright radiance and the Ghost Stone itself sits as a solid, stationary curiosity that often attracts natives of that realm. Recently, this attraction has caused something of a minor territorial war.

Creatures: Before the PCs actually lay eyes on the Ghost Stone, an ether spider approaches them, seeking their help. Named Zzamas, the ether spider speaks very few words of Common and knows that most humanoids find her shape unsettling. As a result, she tries to make contact with the PCs by speaking to them from hiding, calling out in a strange buzzing voice, "You help me, yes?"

Zzamas's rudimentary Common and hideous shape might encourage some PCs to attack, but if a group establishes communication—an easier task if a PC can speak Aklo—Zzamas explains that several xills have forced her from her home, and she wants the PCs' help in killing them. She promises a "fancy chest with stuff inside" as payment for their help.

The Ghost Stone has indeed been claimed by a group of xills—six of them, in fact. If the PCs agree to help Zzamas, the ether spider aids them in the fight; otherwise, if the PCs enter the area of influence of the Ghost Stone, they will need to fight against the six otherplanar horrors themselves. The xills find the Ghost Stone's aura somewhat intoxicating, and all six are sickened 1 as a result of this effect; they cannot reduce their sickened condition below 1 as long as they remain in the area. The xills fight to the death.

DRUNKEN XILLS (6) CREATURE 6

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 299

Initiative Perception +14 while sickened 1

ZZAMAS CREATURE 5

Female ether spider (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 155)

Initiative Perception +12

THE GHOST STONE WAR

30 XP

The PCs must help the ether spider Zzamas drive off the xills who have claimed the Ghost Stone as their territory.

Source: Zzamas the ether spider (area **LV4**)

Completion: All six xills must be slain or forced to flee.

Reward: Zzamas promises to reward the PCs with a treasure chest she recently found drifting through the Ethereal Plane. The chest is locked (DC 25 Thievery to Pick the Lock), and once belonged to a wizard who is long dead. Inside are a *wand of shrink item* and a spellbook. This book should be filled with six spells of levels 1–5 that are useful to the party's wizards; it also contains details for the *legend lore* and *unseen custodians* rituals (*Advanced Player's Guide* 245).

LV5. IRONSTONE GULLY

RESOURCE STREET

A shallow cave extends into the mountainside here. To the untrained eye, this cave might seem unremarkable (apart from serving as the lair for a harmless colony of bats), but a PC who succeeds at a DC 25 Nature or Perception check learns the truth—the far wall of the cave holds an incredibly rich vein of iron ore that could be a valuable resource for any kingdom that claims this hex.

Resources: If this hex is Claimed and the PCs Establish a mine Work Site here, it provides double the normal Ore Commodities.

LV6. VORDAKAI'S TOMB

RESOURCE STANDARD

This location is presented in full detail in Chapter 6.

Resources: If this hex is Claimed after the PCs have completely defeated all the dangers in the tomb, this hex provides a Refuge.

LV7. VALLEY OF THE DEAD SEVERE 9

STANDARD

The six-mile wide entrance to this valley is marked by posts every fifty to sixty feet, each decorated with skulls and other bones.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

The bones and skulls form a wall of warnings erected by the Nomen centaur clan. The clan calls the lands beyond this valley "Olah-Kakanket"—the Valley of the Dead.

Beyond the warning wall of bone totems, the valley doesn't seem much different than the surrounding foothills. Yet the further one travels toward the mountains, the more a strange feeling of oppression grows. The wind seems oddly muted as it flows through the trees and grass, the birds and insects grow quiet, and the unusually regular crags along the surrounding mountains seem almost to crouch in expectation of the PCs' approach.

A mile past the bone totems, the first of the gravestones appears. These 6- to 10-foot-tall stone pillars are badly weathered—many are partially or wholly collapsed, but each bears strange, ancient runes. A PC who succeeds at a DC 25 Society check identifies them as a list of names written in Cyclops. There are thousands of gravestones within the Valley of the Dead, but the cyclops bodies beneath them have long since decayed into soil—all that remains are fragments of bones.

At the westernmost point in the valley, where the ragged Tors of Levenies rise 300 feet above the surrounding foothills, a crack in the cliff wall allows a 15-foot-wide stone stairway to wind up into the mountains. This path takes a circuitous route, winding back and forth over a length of 8 miles through the tors until finally opening upon area **LV6**.

Creatures: Dark and ominous shapes loom at the throat of the stairs where the shadows gather. These are the guardian creatures sent to watch the approach to Vordakai's Tomb—six skeletal hulks raised from the bones of great cyclopes.



SKELETAL HULK

SKELETAL HULKS (6) CREATURE 7

Pathfinder Bestiary 299

Initiative Perception +16

LV8. EMPTY DRAGON LAIR

RESOURCE STANDARD

Deep in the trackless reaches of the Tors of Levenies lies a large cave entrance. Within, a 50-foot-wide tunnel stretches 300 feet into the mountain before opening into a large, vaulted chamber 140 feet in diameter. Yet more impressive is the dry skeleton of an adult silver dragon sprawled in the center of the cavern. The dragon's remains are not completely intact—the bones along the right arm and wing are strangely incomplete, as if they had been melted away by powerful acid. No sign of the dragon's skull remains at all—or of the dragon's treasure. A PC who succeeds at a DC 20 Perception check notices a healthy scattering of silver and black dragon scales. Rumors of a silver dragon named Amvarean are obviously out of date—the black dragon Ilthuliak slew the younger silver dragon many years ago and stole her treasure. While Amvarean's soul has long since been judged by Pharasma, Ilthuliak remains very much alive. See Chapter 10 for more details on this dangerous foe.

Resource: If this hex is Claimed, the empty lair serves as a Refuge.

ZONE 10: HOOKTONGUE

Most of this region consists of the sprawling swamplands of Hooktongue Slough, other than a few hexes to the northeast that are soggy and damp but have relatively solid footing. The swamp itself

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

functions as greater difficult terrain. The large number of rivers and creeks in the swamp allow for the use of small watercrafts such as rafts or rowboats, and if the party is equipped with these vehicles and at least one of the group is an expert in Fishing, River, Sailor, or Swamp Lore, the party can treat these hexes as merely difficult terrain when exploring them.

HOOKTONGUE (HT) ZONE 10

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–3	6 bog striders[B2]	Trivial 10
4–8	2 boggard wardens (See page 155)	Low 10
9–11	6 will-o'-wisps[B1]	Low 10
12–13	3 nuckelavees[B2]	Moderate 10
14–15	4 marsh giants[B2]	Moderate 10
16–17	2 giant flytraps[B1]	Moderate 10
18–19	1 catoblepas[B2]	Moderate 10
20	1 froghemoth[B2]	Severe 10

Bog Striders Any bog striders the PCs encounter are from the settlement of Tok-Nikrat (area **HT12**); they try to engage peacefully with the PCs but flee toward home if attacked. At your discretion, if these bog striders are made helpful, they can guide the PCs to a location in the swamp (their initial attitude is indifferent).

Boggard Wardens These boggards are additional wardens beyond those already encountered in the village of M'botuu (detailed on page 154); they try to capture PCs alive to bring back to the village, but if one is slain, the other attempts to escape, leading the PCs in a direction opposite from M'botuu and hoping to find a hiding spot in the meantime.

Marsh Giants There are no marsh giant settlements in Hooktongue Slough, but there are small roving groups living nomadic lives in the region; they have no love of boggards. If the PCs can prove their superiority over the giants by defeating three of them in combat, the last one begs for mercy and, at your discretion, could act as a guide in the swamp—or could seek revenge by leading the PCs into a dangerous encounter.

HT1. WYVERNSTONE BRIDGE

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

A stone bridge spans a gorge here, through which the East Sellen River flows. This engineering marvel, built nearly 200 years ago just after Choral the Conqueror united Brevoy, offers an easy route over the wide river just before its southern flow empties into the Hooktongue Slough. Although the roads that once extended from the bridge are long gone, the bridge itself remains intact.

HT2. CLOUDBERRY FIELD

RESOURCE | STANDARD

A field of golden cloudberries, a semi-tart fruit usable in pies, jams, and alcoholic drinks, grows here in a large meadow overlooking the northern reaches of Hooktongue Slough. The berry patch covers several acres and often attracts local wildlife—and thus, local predators—so the PCs automatically have a wandering monster encounter when they first enter this hex.

Resource: A Harvest Crops or Gather Livestock activity attempted in this hex earns one degree of success better than the rolled result.

HT3. BOGGARD AMBUSH MODERATE 10

RESOURCE | STANDARD

The East Sellen River widens gradually over the course of 3 miles here, slowing to a crawl as it empties into Lake Hooktongue. When the East Sellen trade route was open, this point was often used as a waystation for travelers, with several buildings set up on stilts in the bog. For the past several years, though, the trade route has been closed due to the increased aggression of the M'botuu boggards.

Creatures: The mostly collapsed shacks and huts are now little more than camouflage for a group of four boggard cultists who have turned the ruins into an ambush site. They've already picked off several of Drelev's explorers and are eager to spring their ambush on anyone trying to navigate the area. These boggards were once members of Sepoko's cult, but when the boggard cleric fell under the influence of the spirit naga Ngara, he attempted to sacrifice his cultists to prove his worth to his new spiritual obsession. The four boggard cultists who dwell amid these ruins today are all who survived the late-night treachery Sepoko unleashed on the cult. A mix of fear and shame kept the boggard cultists from returning to M'botuu, but today, the four are rather proud of their success here and have no desire to return. These ruins are their home now, and in the months since they've settled here, they've only grown in power.

Unless the PCs are traveling stealthily, the boggard cultists notice their approach and set up an ambush. When potential victims reach the area, the boggards roll initiative with Stealth checks, opening combat with spells and blowgun darts from positions on the upper floors of ruined shacks. They fight until only one of their number remains standing, at which point the surviving cultist begs for mercy. Such a cultist remains shifty and constantly plots escape; they will say anything they think the PCs want in order to earn their favor—the boggard could point the way toward M'botuu but is far more likely to try to point the PCs toward a dangerous local predator's den.

BOGGARD CULTISTS (4) CREATURE 8

RARE | CE | MEDIUM | AMPHIBIOUS | BOGGARD | HUMANOID

Variant boggard (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 44)

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Perception +16; darkvision
Languages Abyssal, Boggard, Common
Skills Athletics +16, Intimidation +17, Medicine +18, Nature +15, Performance +15, Religion +17, Stealth 17
Str +4, **Dex** +5, **Con** +4, **Int** +3, **Wis** +6, **Cha** +3
Items blowgun (6 darts coated with giant wasp venom), hide armor, *+1 striking whip*

AC 27; **Fort** +14, **Ref** +17, **Will** +18
HP 135

Speed 20 feet, swim 25 feet; swamp stride
Melee ❖ *whip* +18 (disarm, finesse, nonlethal, reach, trip), **Damage** 2d6+8 slashing
Melee ❖ tongue +16 (reach 10 feet), **Effect** tongue grab
Ranged ❖ blowgun +17 (agile, nonlethal), **Damage** 1 piercing plus giant wasp venom
Divine Prepared Spells DC 26, attack +18; **4th** *divine wrath*, *heal*, *sound burst*; **3rd** *blindness*, *fear*, *vampiric touch*; **2nd** *darkness*, *heal*, *see invisibility*; **1st** *command*, *heal*, *ray of enfeeblement*; **Cantrips (4th)** *daze*, *divine lance*, *know direction*, *shield*, *stabilize*
Gogunta's Croak ❖ (auditory, divine, emotion, enchantment, fear, mental) The boggard cultist unleashes a terrifying croak. Any non-boggard within 30 feet must attempt a DC 25 Will save.
Critical Success The creature is temporarily immune to Gogunta's Croak for 1 minute.
Success The creature is frightened 1
Failure The creature is frightened 2.
Critical Failure The creature is frightened 3 and is also fleeing during their next turn.
Swamp Stride A boggard cultist ignores difficult terrain caused by swamp terrain features.
Tongue Grab If the boggard cultist hits a creature with its tongue, that creature becomes grabbed by the boggard. Unlike with a normal Grab, the creature isn't immobilized, but it can't move beyond the reach of the boggard's tongue. A creature can sever the tongue by hitting AC 25 and dealing at least 10 slashing damage. Though this doesn't deal any damage to the boggard, it prevents it from using its tongue Strike until it regrows its tongue, which takes a week.

Resource: The ruined buildings can be repaired if this hex is Claimed and a settlement is established here; the ruins can be rebuilt into three different Structures: one lot of Houses, one lot of Inns, and one lot of Piers.

HT4. THE SINKING BOG — TRIVIAL 10

STANDARD

This hex cannot be used to build roads, settlements, Farmlands, Work Sites, or any other form of structure.

Hazard: This region of swampland is known to the boggards and other denizens of the area as the Sinking Bog, due to the unusual number of patches of quicksand that fill the area. Travel through this hex automatically exposes the PCs to quicksand. If the PCs Reconnoiter this hex, they're also exposed to a patch of green slime.

GREEN SLIME — HAZARD 9

Gamemastery Guide 78

QUICKSAND — HAZARD 3

Core Rulebook 526

HT5. HAUNTED FEN — SEVERE 10

STANDARD

The entire north shore of Lake Hooktongue, ranging from the boggard ambush site down to Fort Drelev, has a reputation for being haunted, but this particular stretch of boggy lakeshore is the most notorious part, known locally as the Haunted Fen. As the PCs first enter this hex, anyone who succeeds at a DC 20 Swamp Lore or a DC 25 Nature or Society check to Recall Knowledge recalls legends that fishers and boaters who stray too near the shoreline in this area often hear voices calling out to them. None dispute the fact that trappers who venture into this area seem to go missing more often than not. There have been an unusual number of bodies found here missing eyes and fingers, as if both were chewed away by something that deliberately left the rest of the body untouched. This has only increased the region's notoriety. On a critical success on the check to Recall Knowledge, a character notes that these eerie clues suggest the predation of a dangerous creature known as an ahuizotl.

Creature: Indeed, the source of the stories about the Haunted Fen is a particularly powerful ahuizotl named Irahkatu, a cunning and cruel predator with a particularly prodigious appetite. If he realizes his domain has been intruded upon, Irahkatu stalks the PCs, waiting for them to be distracted or for night to fall before ambushing them. If it looks like the PCs are going to leave the hex before nightfall, Irahkatu uses Voice Imitation to try to lure them back, then ambushes the smallest PC. Once combat begins, Irahkatu fights to the death, pursuing foes as far as the edges of this hex if necessary.

IRAHKATU — CREATURE 13

UNIQUE | NE | LARGE | AMPHIBIOUS | BEAST

Variant male ahuizotl (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 12)
Perception +22; darkvision
Languages Aklo, Common
Skills Athletics +25, Deception +23 (+27 when using Voice Imitation), Stealth +25
Str +8, **Dex** +6, **Con** +6, **Int** +0, **Wis** +5, **Cha** +4
Voice Imitation Irahkatu can mimic the sounds of a person

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

in distress by attempting a Deception check to Lie. Irahkatu has a +4 circumstance bonus to this check.

AC 34; **Fort** +25, **Ref** +21, **Will** +20

HP 235

Speed 25 feet, swim 35 feet

Melee ❖ jaws +27, **Damage** 3d12+14 piercing

Melee ❖ claw +27 (agile), **Damage** 3d8+14 slashing

Melee ❖ tail claw +27 (agile, reach 10 feet), **Damage** 3d6+14 slashing plus Improved Grab

Disfigure ❖❖ **Requirements** Irahkatu has a Medium or smaller creature grabbed with his tail claw or has already damaged a creature with his claw or tail claw Strike this turn; **Effect** Irahkatu attempts an Athletics check against the creature's Fortitude DC.

Critical Success Irahkatu tears at the target's eyes. The target takes 14d6 slashing damage and is blinded for 24 hours. This blinded condition is removed earlier if the creature is fully healed of all damage.

Success Irahkatu mangles some fingers. The target takes 7d6 slashing damage and is clumsy 1 for 24 hours.

Failure Irahkatu claws at the creature, dealing 3d6 slashing damage.

Critical Failure The creature is unaffected.

Tail Drag ❖ **Requirements** Irahkatu has a Medium or smaller creature grabbed with his tail claw; **Effect** Irahkatu attempts an Athletics check against the creature's Fortitude DC.

Critical Success If the creature is 10 feet away from Irahkatu, it is dragged into a square adjacent to it. Irahkatu can make a jaws Strike against the creature.

Success If the creature is 10 feet away from Irahkatu, it is dragged into a square adjacent to Irahkatu.

Failure The creature is not dragged.

Critical Failure The creature is not dragged and Irahkatu no longer has the creature grabbed.

Treasure: Once Irahkatu has been defeated, a successful DC 28 Survival check to Track or a DC 30 Perception check made as part of a Reconnoiter activity can reveal to the PCs a mound of hidden vegetation and mud that the ahuizotl used as a nest. Irahkatu has used the skulls of many of its victims to decorate the walls inside his lair, and three of these skulls are adorned with valuables: one boggard skull wears a silver circlet set with moonstones worth 300 gp, a dwarf skull has seven gold teeth in its jaws worth a total of 70 gp, and a human skull wears a *mask of the banshee* (*Advanced Player's Guide* 261).

HT6. M'BOTUU

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

This is the largest boggard settlement in Hooktongue Slough; it's explored in detail in Part 9 of this chapter (page 154).

Resource: The village of M'botuu is a Freehold. If it is brought into the PCs' kingdom, they automatically gain a village settlement that contains the following two free structures: Barracks and Tenements. One of its Urban Grid borders is a Water border.

HT7. LAKE HOOKTONGUE EXTREME 10

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

Lake Hooktongue is the heart of Hooktongue Slough. Countless minor rivers and streams wind through the swamp into this lake, the surface of which is typically calm and serene. The lake itself is quite deep, reaching 900 feet in several places. The lake also has a sinister reputation, for many believe it to be the lair of an ancient water orm named Hooktongue—the same creature that gives its name to both the lake and the surrounding swampland. With a successful DC 15 River Lore check or a DC 20 Nature or Society check to Recall Knowledge, a PC recalls that Hooktongue is said to be an immense horned serpent with jaws strong enough to crush a bear. Hooktongue hasn't been spotted in the lake for nearly a decade, and most believe the creature to have died.

Creatures: Hooktongue still lives, but he has been slumbering for many years at the bottom of the lake. Recently, though, the legendary water orm has woken with a powerful hunger. He has been feeding on the giant eels and crocodiles that constitute the lake's traditional threats, and these creatures have largely fled upriver as a result. Whether an attempt to cross the lake by boat or to explore its depths attracts Hooktongue's attention is left to you to decide, but until the water orm is driven off or slain, it will continue to endanger those who would use the lake to travel or fish (detailed in Resources below). If reduced to 30 Hit Points or less, Hooktongue uses Water Travel to flee upriver. In this event, he won't return to this lake anytime soon.

HOOKTONGUE CREATURE 14

UNIQUE | N | HUGE | AMPHIBIOUS | ANIMAL

Variant water orm (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 289)

Perception +25; darkvision

Languages Aquan (can't speak any language)

Skills Athletics +28, Stealth +27

Str +8, **Dex** +5, **Con** +5, **Int** –3, **Wis** +5, **Cha** +0

Slow Metabolism Hooktongue can go for 10 years without feeding. After this, its hunger makes it slowed 1 but doesn't otherwise impact its lifespan. If Hooktongue is slowed as a result of starvation, it can remove this condition by using Swallow Whole to gulp down a meal.

Undetectable (abjuration, primal) Hooktongue automatically tries to counteract any detection, revelation, or scrying divination attempted against it, using its Stealth modifier for the counteract check.

CHAPTER 2
PART 1: HEXPLORING THE STOLEN LANDS
PART 2: HEX ENCOUNTERS
PART 3: THE OLD SYCAMORE
PART 4: SOOTSCALE CAVERNS
PART 5: THE LONELY BARROW
PART 6: ISLE OF THE LIZARD KING
PART 7: CANDLEMERE ISLAND
PART 8: THE FORGOTTEN KEEP
PART 9: M'BOTUU

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

AC 35; **Fort** +27, **Ref** +25, **Will** +23
HP 275; **Resistances** cold 15, fire 15

Speed 20 feet, swim 50 feet

Melee ❖ jaws +30 (reach 15 feet), **Damage** 3d12+14 piercing plus Grab

Melee ❖ tongue +30 (agile, reach 25 feet), **Damage** 3d8+14 piercing plus Hooktongue Venom

Capsize ❖ (attack) Hooktongue attempts to capsize an aquatic vessel of its size or smaller that it's adjacent to. It must succeed at an Athletics check with a DC of 35 or the pilot's Sailing Lore DC, whichever is higher.

Hooktongue Venom (poison); **Saving Throw** Fortitude DC 34; **Maximum Duration** 6 rounds; **Stage 1** 2d6 poison damage and clumsy 1 (1 round); **Stage 2** 3d6 poison damage, clumsy 1, and confused (1 round); **Stage 3** 4d6 poison damage, clumsy 2, and confused (1 round)

Swallow Whole ❖ (attack) Large, 2d10+10 bludgeoning, Rupture 28

Poison Spray ❖❖ (evocation, poison, primal) Hooktongue sprays poison from its throat in an 80-foot line that deals 15d6 poison damage (DC 34 basic Reflex save). A creature that fails or critically fails this save is exposed to Hooktongue Venom as well. Hooktongue can't use Poison Spray again for 1d4 rounds.

Water Travel ❖❖❖ (primal, transmutation, water) Hooktongue dissolves into water, appearing only as a long, serpentine silhouette on the waves. While in this form, Hooktongue's swim Speed increases to 600 feet, it automatically succeeds at Athletics checks to Swim, and it gains a +4 circumstance bonus to Stealth checks in water. Hooktongue can remain in this form for 8 hours but can't enter salt water when using this ability. Hooktongue can return to its normal form using a single action, which has the concentrate trait.



HOOKTONGUE

Treasure: Hooktongue isn't interested in treasure, but PCs who can breathe water for an hour can Search the lake depths in this hex. If they succeed at a DC 10 Athletics check to Swim and a DC 20 Perception check, they locate a sunken barge wedged into a 300-foot-deep cleft just a few hundred feet from shore.

While the bulk of the goods in the barge have long since decayed, a waterproof chest remains. Its lock has rusted to ruin; Forcing It Open underwater requires a PC to succeed at a DC 30 Athletics check, but if the 10 Bulk chest is hauled onshore, the DC drops to 20. Inside the chest are several bags of coins: 2,600 cp, 1,400 sp, 450 gp, and 20 pp in all. In addition, the chest contains a *lifting belt*, a *wand of remove disease* (3rd), a suit of *moonlit chain*, and a *minor sturdy shield*.

Resources: Hooktongue remains a danger to anyone who uses the lake as long as it lives; any attempt to make a Boating check in this hex is reduced by one degree of success.

If the PCs succeed in slaying Hooktongue, word quickly spreads of this impressive deed. Reduce Unrest by 4, and this hex is treated as a Landmark if the hex is Claimed. In addition, the sudden upswell of fish in the lake now that the primary predator is gone helps to feed the kingdom; as long as this hex remains Claimed, reduce the kingdom's Consumption by 1. In time, the giant eels, crocodiles, and other predators return as well, but they present a much more manageable threat than Hooktongue ever did.

HT8. DRAGONFLY GLADE SEVERE 10

STANDARD

In this unusually beautiful swamp glade, dragonflies of all sizes buzz and flit through the air, making this

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

a favorite hunting ground for boggards (although none are present when the PCs first visit the glade). While most of the dragonflies are harmless (ranging from normal-sized up to a wingspan of 2 feet), giant dragonflies dwell in the glade as well.

Creatures: Most of the giant dragonflies that dwell in this glade are typical Medium-sized specimens of their kind (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 98), but four specimens are truly enormous creatures with 16-foot wingspans. The smaller creatures avoid the PCs, but these four enormous dragonflies do not—they flit forth to attack at once and fight to the death.

ENORMOUS DRAGONFLIES (4) CREATURE 9

N LARGE ANIMAL

Variant giant dragonfly (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 98)

Perception +16; darkvision, wavesense (imprecise) 30 feet

Skills Acrobatics +17 (+19 to Maneuver in Flight), Athletics +19, Stealth +19

Str +6, **Dex** +4, **Con** +2, **Int** –5, **Wis** +3, **Cha** +0

AC 27; **Fort** +17, **Ref** +21, **Will** +14

HP 165

Speed 20 feet, fly 60 feet

Melee ❖ mandibles +20, **Damage** 2d12+9 piercing plus Grab

Clutch ❖ **Requirements** The enormous dragonfly has a Large or smaller creature grabbed in its mandibles; **Effect** The dragonfly tries to transfer the grabbed creature to be clutched by its legs. The enormous dragonfly attempts an Athletics check against the creature's Reflex DC. On a success, it transfers the creature (which remains grabbed) to its legs, freeing its mandibles to attack. The dragonfly can have only one creature clutched at a time.

Snatch The enormous dragonfly can Fly at half Speed while it has a creature grabbed or restrained by Clutch, carrying that creature along with it.

Swoop ❖❖ The dragonfly Flies up to its Speed and makes one mandible Strike at any point during that movement.

Treasure: A boggard skeleton lies on a low, almost dry hummock of land near the lair of the enormous dragonflies, a victim of his own overconfidence. His *greater animal staff* lies a few feet away.

DRAGONFLY CLOAK

30 XP

A traveling cleric of Erastil named Berzaki specializes in crafting magic items from giant insect parts. He promises to make a magic item for the first person who can bring him a set of particularly large and magnificent dragonfly wings. He suggests the PCs seek out the dragonfly glade at area **HT8** as an excellent potential site to gather these wings.

Source: Berzaki (once the PCs reach 9th level)

Completion: The wings of all four enormous dragonflies at area **HT8** will suffice; they can be harvested automatically once the dragonflies are slain.

Reward: Berzaki uses the materials to craft a scintillating and majestic *cape of the mountebank* for the PCs as a reward, and has plenty of wing left over for his own projects as well.

HT9. THE SWAMP SCAR SEVERE 10

LANDMARK

An immense mound of fallen trees and logs lie in a jagged line here, forming a swath of decaying plant matter created by various river currents over the course of decades. Nearly 500 feet long and 40 feet high, this swath is known locally as the Swamp Scar. The mound of vegetation is riddled with burrows and nooks, and it's within these hollows that the Scar's most dangerous denizen dwells.

Creature: A powerful spirit naga named Ngara has dwelt in the Swamp Scar for years. As unsuspecting humanoids stumble into the area, she slithers out to enchant them and make them her minions via *inveigle*. Those who resist are killed and eaten, but those who succumb become the naga's agents, prowling the swamp and surrounding lands in a constant search for new victims to bring to Ngara to serve as meals. She keeps a pair of *inveigled* marsh giants as guardians here, but her most significant minion is the boggard priest-king Sepoko (detailed on page 158), whom she allows to run the village of M'botuu as her proxy. The naga would love to add the PCs to her little army of hunters and gatherers, but if she's unable to control them, she's just as happy to kill and eat them—not necessarily in that order.

MARSH GIANTS (2) CREATURE 8

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 125

Initiative Perception +16

NGARA CREATURE 12

UNIQUE NE LARGE ABERRATION

Female variant spirit naga (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 179)

Perception +22; darkvision

Languages Aklo, Common

Skills Acrobatics +23, Athletics +22, Deception +25, Intimidation +25, Occultism +22, Stealth +23

Str +4, **Dex** +5, **Con** +4, **Int** +2, **Wis** +4, **Cha** +7

AC 33; **Fort** +19, **Ref** +24, **Will** +23

HP 215

Speed 25 feet, swim 15 feet

Melee ❖ fangs +24 (agile, finesse), **Damage** 3d10+8 piercing plus spirit naga venom

Occult Spontaneous Spells DC 32, attack +20; **6th** (4 slots) *dominate*, *feeblemind*, *phantasmal calamity*, *spirit blast*;

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

5th (5 slots) *black tentacles*, *dispel magic*, *subconscious suggestion*, *tongues*; **4th** (4 slots) *clairvoyance*, *confusion*, *fly*, *modify memory*; **3rd** (4 slots) *dream message*, *mind reading*, *paralyze*, *vampiric touch*; **2nd** (4 slots) *blur*, *humanoid form*, *mirror image*, *telekinetic maneuver*; **1st** (4 slots) *charm*, *command*, *grim tendrils*, *unseen servant*; **Cantrips (5th)** *daze*, *detect magic*, *mage hand*, *read aura*, *sigil*

Rituals DC 31; *inveigle*

Spirit Naga Venom (poison) **Saving Throw** DC 32 Fortitude; **Maximum Duration** 6 rounds; **Stage 1** 2d6 poison damage and stupefied 1 (1 round); **Stage 2** 2d6 poison damage and stupefied 2 (1 round)

Treasure: While Ngara has little interest in material wealth (to her, the greatest "treasures" are mind-controlled minions), she does have a fondness for rings. With no fingers to wear them, she's taken to using *mage hand* and *unseen servant* to use roots and vines to dangle her ring collection from the tangles above her lair's entrance. This collection consists 15 nonmagical rings of various values (worth 500 gp total), along with a *ring of the ram* and a *ring of wizardry I*.

HT10. CHUUL LAIR — MODERATE 10

STANDARD

A rocky cave lies within a steep hillside by the swamp's shore, nearly hidden by high rushes and cattails.

Creatures: This cave is the den of four chuuls. One of the creatures hides within the cave to the north, while the other three lurk in the water to the south, ready to ambush and surround any creatures venturing near their home. At night, they all reside in the cave, the walls of which are decorated with crude but detailed paintings of chuuls eating humans, created from the smeared leavings of their victims' blood.

The chuuls try to flank opponents whenever possible, and fight to the death.

ELITE CHUULS (4) — CREATURE 8

Pathfinder Bestiary 6, 64

Initiative Perception +17

Treasure: The chuuls compulsively store trophies they've collected from past victims, including a *+1 quarterstaff* shod with silver at either end and decorated with carvings of predatory birds worth 180 gp, a pair of *boots of bounding*, a coral holy symbol of Gozreh worth 50 gp, a leaf-shaped mithral brooch worth 100 gp, and an *iron medallion talisman*.

HT11. LILY PATCH — MODERATE 10

RESOURCE STANDARD

Hazard: The azure lily is a relatively notorious carnivorous plant known to grow in Hooktongue Slough—and it's also one of the rarest. It's unusual to find more than one of these dangerous plants growing in any part the swamp, and they're unheard of beyond its borders. By remarkable chance, a grove of azure lilies has bloomed on a low hummock here, appearing as a thick tangle of tough scrub with blue flowers. An azure lily's pollen is rather toxic, with a single lily producing enough pollen to drive those exposed to it into a frenzy. The plants feed on the blood spilled by creatures fighting in their midst but generate only enough pollen to do so once a month. If the PCs merely Travel through this hex and succeed at a DC 11 flat check, they miss this dangerous hazard entirely, while a failure leads to 1d4 PCs being exposed to the pollen burst. If the PCs Reconnoiter the hex, they automatically encounter the hazard, with the entire party being exposed to the pollen burst.

AZURE LILIES — HAZARD 12

RARE ENVIRONMENTAL

Stealth +30 (expert)

Description The azure lilies expel a burst of toxic pollen.

Disable DC 33 Nature or Survival (expert) to harvest the plant's pollen without disturbing the blossoms.

AC 30; **Fort** +27, **Ref** +25

HP 120 (BT 60); **Immunities** critical hits, object immunities, precision damage

Pollen Burst ↷ (emotion, enchantment, mental, poison); **Trigger** The lily patch is disturbed; **Effect** The pollen erupts in a 30-foot-radius burst. Any living creature in the burst must attempt a DC 30 Will save, though creatures with the plant trait are immune.

Critical Success The creature is unaffected.

Success The creature takes 6d6 mental damage as the pollen causes wracking headaches and jolts of pain.

Failure The creature takes 12d6 mental damage and is confused for 1 minute. The creature can attempt a new save at the end of each of its turns to end the confusion early.

Critical Failure The creature takes 20d6 mental damage and is confused for 1 minute, with no save to end the confusion early.

Reset 1 month.

Treasure: Azure lily pollen, if harvested without triggering the plant, can be refined into a potent toxin. If the PCs manage to disable this hazard, they can gather enough of the pollen to craft up to five doses of azure lily pollen (detailed on page 584). If the PCs trigger the hazard, succeeding at a DC 33 Nature or Survival check after the hazard is defeated gathers only enough for a single dose of azure lily pollen.

Resource: The act of harvesting and preparing azure lily pollen into a poison is a complex process

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

that takes weeks and generally yields only a few doses each month, at best. If the PCs Claim this hex, and if their kingdom has Master rank in Agriculture, they can harvest the pollen via the following Region downtime activity during Kingdom turns.

HARVEST AZURE LILY POLLEN

DOWNTIME REGION

Requirement Master rank in Agriculture

You or a small group of trained herbalists or naturalists work to harvest and process azure lily pollen in hopes of creating a few doses of the poison (detailed on page 584). Attempt a DC 30 Agriculture check. You must then wait 1 Kingdom turn before attempting this activity again, to give the lilies time to recover.

Critical Success You create 2 doses of azure lily pollen.

Success You create 1 dose of azure lily pollen but must also attempt a DC 11 flat check. On a failure, some of the poison makes its way into criminal hands; increase Crime by 1.

Failure You fail to harvest any azure lily pollen, in part because many of the resources make their way into the kingdom's criminal underworld. Increase Crime by 1.

Critical Failure Not only do you fail to harvest any pollen, and not only do resources make their way into the hands of criminals, but whispers and rumors that you allowed this to happen on purpose spread through the kingdom. Increase Unrest by 1d4, Corruption by 1, and Crime by 2.

HT12. TOK-NIKRAT TRIVIAL 10

STANDARD

The swamp vegetation recedes here, forming a 100-foot-wide ring of open water surrounding a heavily wooded island 200 feet in diameter. The water is 50 feet deep on average.

Creatures: Though bog striders are normally solitary creatures, a dozen of them have established something akin to a community in the center of this island. Their leader, an aging veteran named Tok-Tekt, wages a war of attrition against the boggards of the swamp. A boggard raiding party from M'botuu recently captured his son Ka-Kekt, and the last time the bog strider leader attempted a rescue, the boggards slew three of his people. As a result, Tok-Tekt doesn't expect to see his son again and has all but buried him.

The bog striders themselves are an insular people who do not seek contact with the "landwalker" races, but if the PCs rescue Ka-Kekt and escort him here (or simply travel here after rescuing him and letting him make his own way home), they'll be welcomed as friends. If the PCs approach the bog strider enclave before saving Ka-Kekt, and the residents notice their approach, the bog striders greet the party with angry shrill chirpings from the edge of their island; if the PCs attack, the bog striders fight to the death to defend their home. If, on the other hand, the PCs attempt to establish a more peaceful meeting with the insectile people, they'll need to adjust the bog striders' initial hostility to a friendly attitude, at which point Tok-Tekt asks them to save his son.

BOG STRIDERS (11) CREATURE 2

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 43

Initiative Perception +8

TOK-TEKT CREATURE 3

Elite male bog strider (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 6, 43)

Initiative Perception +10

SAVE THE BOG STRIDER

30 XP 30 KINGDOM XP

Tok-Tekt's son, Ka-Kekt, is held prisoner in the boggard village of M'botuu, and must be rescued.

Source: Either Ka-Kekt (area **G4**; page 149) or Tok-Tekt (area **HT12**)

Completion: Release Ka-Kekt from his prison hut at area **G4**. The bog strider is resourceful and knows the swamp, so the PCs don't need to escort him home, but they'll need to return to Tok-Nikrat to fully complete the quest.

Reward: In thanks for saving his son, Tok-Tekt names the "landwalker" PCs "bog friends." The bog striders have no material wealth to share, but Tok-Tekt and his kin are quite knowledgeable about Hooktongue Slough and can inform the PCs of every encounter area in the zone. The PCs can automatically integrate Tok-Nikrat into their kingdom if they Claim this Hex.

Resource: Tok-Nikrat is a very small Freehold. If it's brought into the PCs' kingdom, they automatically gain a village settlement that contains a single lot of Tenements. All four of its Urban Grid borders are Water borders.

HT13. BOG OF BONES MODERATE 10

STANDARD

An unearthly chill hangs over this narrow marsh nestled between two higher forested hills at the edge of the Narlmarches. Small eddies of water swirl around bubbling plumes of escaping swamp gas here, and the otherwise ubiquitous swamp song of crickets, birds, and frogs falls silent.

Creatures: Decades ago, four priests of Urgathoa came to the city of Pitax with plans to establish a cult. Three of the priests, however, grew jealous of the fourth's uncanny skill at commanding undead creatures. They convinced each other that if they joined

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

forces, they could slay him and use their necromantic talents to draw his secrets from his dead flesh, but they underestimated how favored he was in Urgathoa's eyes. After the three lured the fourth into the depths of this swamp, they ambushed and drowned him. It was then that Urgathoa's rage poured down on the priests: she cursed all three into bog mummies and forbade them to ever leave the swamp. The spirit of the fourth she accepted into her realm, secretly quite pleased that he had so conveniently come to her without a long stay on the Material Plane as an undead being.

These three bog mummies are more powerful than most of their kind, for while Urgathoa cursed them with undeath, she saw fit to allow them to keep some of their unholy powers and spellcasting, promising them via visions during their death and animation that, should they drown enough new victims, they could eventually repay their debt. Of course, since the mummies cannot leave this bog of bones, and since few visit this region, they have come to realize that Urgathoa's promise was little more than a mockery.



BOG MUMMY CULTIST

BOG MUMMY CULTISTS (3) CREATURE 9

RARE NE MEDIUM MUMMY UNDEAD

Variant bog mummy (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 177)

Perception +19; darkvision, tremorsense (imprecise) 30 feet

Languages Common, Necril

Skills Athletics +19, Stealth +18 (+20 while buried in a bog)

Str +6, **Dex** +3, **Con** +4, **Int** +0, **Wis** +6, **Cha** +3

Items *+1 cold-resistant leather armor*

AC 28; **Fort** +19, **Ref** +16, **Will** +21

HP 135, negative healing; **Immunities** death effects, disease, paralyzed, poison, unconscious; **Weaknesses** cold 10; **Resistances** cold 5, fire 10

Breath of the Bog (aura, divine, enchantment, mental) 30 feet. A creature that begins its turn within the area feels as if its lungs were filling with water and must succeed at a DC 25 Fortitude save or be unable to speak or breathe. The creature can hold its breath and can attempt a new save at the end of its turn. A creature that succeeds is temporarily immune to breath of the bog for 24 hours.

Rejuvenation (divine, necromancy) Unless the damage that destroys a bog mummy cultist is positive damage, necromantic energies rebuild its body from swamp muck 1 week later. If the uncompleted body is destroyed during that time, the process starts anew. Anyone who succeeds at a DC 26 Religion check to Recall Knowledge realizes that a *consecrate* ritual performed on the site that a bog mummy cultist was destroyed prevents its rejuvenation, the way positive damage prevents the rejuvenation from occurring.

Rise Up ↷ **Trigger** A creature walks on top of a bog mummy cultist that lies buried in the mud or peat below; **Requirements** Initiative has not yet been rolled; **Effect** The bog mummy automatically notices the creature and Burrows before rolling initiative.

Speed 20 feet, burrow 15 feet

Melee ❖ fist +19 (agile), **Damage** 2d8+10 plus bog rot

Divine Innate Spells DC 28, attack +20; **5th** *crisis of faith*; **4th** *divine wrath*, *grim tendrils*; **Cantrips (5th)** *divine lance*

Bog Rot (curse, disease, divine, necromancy, negative) This affliction can't be reduced below stage 1, nor can the damage from it be healed, until it's successfully treated with *remove curse* or a similar effect; the affliction can then be removed as normal for a disease. A creature killed by bog rot melts into a noxious sludge and can't be brought back to life except by a 7th-level *resurrect* ritual or similar magic; **Saving Throw** DC 28 Fortitude; **Stage 1** carrier with no ill effect (1 minute); **Stage 2** 3d6 negative damage and clumsy 1 (1 day)

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

HT14. HYDRA DEN — SEVERE 10

STANDARD

The foot-deep water of this bog opens into a much deeper pond filled by three small tributaries before draining away into a larger expanse to the west. Solid ground leads along the eastern edge past a line of scraggly trees set back from a thick curtain of cattails. Many of the reeds lie bent or broken, crushed into the underlying mud.

Creatures: A huge, 12-headed hydra lairs within this pond—one of the most dangerous predators in the entire swamp. Grown fat on boggards, bog striders, deer, fish, giant herons, and other wildlife, it spends most of its time lurking in the flooded undergrowth and monitoring nearby shorelines for passing creatures. It attacks anyone it sees, lunging out of the water to pounce if possible and rolling initiative with Stealth.

HOOKTONGUE HYDRA — CREATURE 13

UNIQUE | N | HUGE | BEAST

Variant hydra (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 210)
Perception +26; low-light vision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet
Skills Athletics +27, Stealth +24 (+27 in water)
Str +8, **Dex** +5, **Con** +6, **Int** –3, **Wis** +5, **Cha** –1

AC 34; all-around vision; **Fort** +25, **Ref** +24, **Will** +22
HP (body) 240, hydra regeneration 15
HP (head) 45, head regrowth; **Immunities** area damage; **Weaknesses** slashing 5
Attack of Opportunity ↻
Head Regrowth As hydra.
Hydra Regeneration As hydra, but DC 35 Fortitude to regrow heads.
Multiple Opportunities As hydra (12 reactions).

Speed 25 feet, swim 25 feet
Melee ❖ fangs +27 (reach 10 feet), **Damage** 3d10+14 piercing
Focused Assault ❖❖ As hydra.
Storm of Jaws ❖❖ As hydra.

Treasure: The half-eaten remains of the hydra's latest victim, an adventurer who was traveling north along the Sellen River, lies in its den. Most of the dead elf's gear is ruined, but an *oathbow* lies nearby, filthy with mud but so far undamaged by the hydra's activity.

HT15. SLUG BOG — SEVERE 10

STANDARD

A thunderous crashing of trees and surging water fills this part of the swamp, startling most animals into furtive attempts to hide or flee. Up ahead, the high reeds part to reveal a large, shallow bog fed by multiple slow-moving waterways.

Creatures: Most swamp denizens avoid this region during the current season, as this desolate part of the swamp is used as a mating ground for giant slugs. No less than half a dozen agitated slugs have already engaged one another, attempting to establish mating rights within the region. Their massive bodies thrash about the bog, and they excitedly spit acid at each other, spraying the nearby trees in the process. They aggressively attack anything passing through the area, their competition forgotten in the wake of fresh prey.

GIANT SLUGS (6) — CREATURE 8

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 244
Initiative Perception +14

WANTED: SLUG SPIT

30 XP

Local alchemist and only slightly dangerous eccentric Chesk Umberweed promised a group of dwarves he could deliver some powerful metal-etching acid, but he has run out of supplies. He needs a dozen vials of giant slug acid as soon as possible.

Source: Wanted poster (these posters start popping up once the PCs reach 10th level)

Completion: A single giant slug provides enough acid to acquire the dozen vials Chesk needs, but harvesting the acid must be done within an hour of the slug's death.

Reward: Chesk gives four moderate elixirs of life and three greater alchemist's fires to the PCs in return for the acid delivery.

ZONE 11: DRELEV

Northwest of the marshy expanse of Hooktongue Slough, the landscape dries into grassy plains dotted here and there with small sunken areas of standing water and thick vegetation. This region has recently been claimed by one of the more successful settlers from Rostland, Hannis Drelev. Most of Hannis's efforts have been put into the creation of a fort and supporting town on Lake Hooktongue's only stretch of solid shoreline, and as such, the grasslands to the west remain mostly wilderness.

DRELEV (DR) — ZONE 11

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 10 table (page 95)	Varies
6–8	6 hill giants[B1]	Low 11
9–11	1 cauthooj[B1]	Low 11
12–13	3 giant flytraps[B1]	Moderate 11
14–15	4 aurumvoraxes[B2]	Moderate 11
16–17	1 irlgaunt[B2]	Moderate 11
18–19	1 viper vine[B2]	Moderate 11
20	1 ankou[B2]	Severe 11

Ankou An encounter with one of these dangerous fey may seem like chance to the PCs initially, but in fact, any ankou encountered in the wild is an agent sent by Nyrissa herself to attack the PCs, trying to test their mettle.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Whether or not an ankou can be captured or convinced to reveal more information about the mysterious fey queen is left to you to decide. Ankous have little interest in common folk, and thus only make their presence known to more powerful characters such as the PCs.

Hill Giants These giants have been driven south out of the Glenebon Uplands or the Tiger Lords' region by aggressive barbarians, monsters, or just boredom. They've found that, while life in the soggy grasslands is safer overall, the lack of comforting hilly horizons has left them edgy and jumpy. The giants are eager to attack the PCs and take their things, but as soon as half of them are defeated, the remaining giants' spirits break and they try to make peace with the PCs. Whether or not hill giants are a good idea to befriend is left to you to determine.

DR1. SPEARTOOTH'S DEN — SEVERE 11

HIDDEN

A narrow valley filled with thorny plants lies nestled here between two sharp-sloped hills. A successful DC 30 Nature or Perception check or a DC 25 Plains Lore check made while the group is Reconnoitering this hex provides the PCs with evidence that a huge feline predator dwells in the area. Once the big cat's tracks are found, a PC can attempt a DC 30 Survival check to Track the predator into a narrow tunnel through a particularly dense patch of thorns.

Creature: An immense smilodon dwells in this valley. The creature is quite old, notoriously cantankerous, covered in scars, and bears fangs nearly 2 feet long. The Tiger Lords call this beast Speartooth and revere him almost as a god; they often leave kills in this area to appease the beast. The denizens of Fort Drelev have come to fear Speartooth as well, for the smilodon has not only eluded all attempts by Drelev's forces to capture or kill it, but has also killed no fewer than two dozen of their guards. A notorious man-eater, Speartooth's legend is quickly growing throughout the Stolen Lands.

Roll a DC 11 flat check when the PCs first visit Speartooth's lair; on a success, Speartooth is present and rolls Stealth for initiative. If it's not around, the saber-toothed tiger returns in 1d4 hours, dragging a dead horse in its jaws. If it encounters intruders in its lair, it furiously attacks, focusing on the largest foe first; Speartooth fights to the death to defend its territory.

SPEARTOOTH — CREATURE 14

UNIQUE | N | LARGE | ANIMAL

Variant smilodon (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 53)

Perception +25; low-light vision, scent (imprecise) 60 feet

Skills Acrobatics +25, Athletics +28, Stealth +27

Str +8, **Dex** +2, **Con** +4, **Int** –4, **Wis** +2, **Cha** +0

AC 36; **Fort** +28, **Ref** +25, **Will** +23

HP 255

Speed 30 feet

Melee ❖ fangs +29, **Damage** 3d12+14 piercing plus Grab

Melee ❖ claw +29 (agile), **Damage** 3d8+14 slashing plus Grab

Pierce Armor ❖ Speartooth makes a fangs Strike against a creature it has grabbed. If the attack hits, the creature is knocked prone; if the creature is wearing armor with hardness 10 or lower, the armor is broken. If this Strike breaks a creature's armor or damages a creature who is unarmored or wearing broken armor, the creature also takes 3d6 persistent bleed damage. This Strike doesn't further damage armor that's already broken.

Pounce ❖ Speartooth Strides and makes a Strike at the end of that movement. If Speartooth began this action hidden, it remains hidden until after this ability's Strike.

Sneak Attack Speartooth deals 2d6 extra precision damage to creatures that are flat-footed.

Treasure: Among the 24 corpses of the Fort Drelev guards killed by Speartooth lie several ruined weapons and pieces of punctured armor. Of more interest is the body of an infamous hunter Hannis hired from Pitax to take down Speartooth—this dead hunter's *+1 striking shock composite longbow* and two remaining *viper arrows* didn't help when Speartooth pounced on him in his camp and mauled him to death.

WANTED: SPEARTOOTH

30 XP

The saber-toothed tiger Speartooth has long plagued the hills west of Hooktongue. They say it's killed and eaten over a hundred people! So far, no one's managed to bring the beast down.

Source: Wanted poster (this poster starts to appear once the PCs reach 11th level)

Completion: Find Speartooth, kill it, and deliver its 22-inch-long fangs to the captain of the guard in any settlement in the PCs' kingdom.

Reward: The bounty for Speartooth is 2,000 gp.

DR2. FORT DRELEV

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

Baron Hannis Drelev is swift in getting his fort and town established, but if the PCs visit this area before beginning Chapter 7, they'll find the town and fortress still under construction. Full details on Fort Drelev appear in Part 2 of Chapter 7 (page 308).

Resource: Fort Drelev is a Freehold town, and the PCs' kingdom must be at least 3rd level before integrating it. Fort Drelev is a town that has 2 Water borders and 2 Land borders (one of which also has a Wooden Wall). The town occupies four blocks on the Urban Grid, and all 16 of its lots have structures built.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

These consist of the following: Festival Hall, Houses (4 lots), Inn, Keep, Piers (2), Smithy, Stable, Tavern (Popular), Temple, and Watchtower.

DR3. WILD HORSES — TRIVIAL 11

STANDARD

A herd of wild horses graze these plains. Their leader, a powerful stallion named Windchaser, once served an elderly druid of the River Kingdoms as a bonded companion. The druid, aware that his own death was nigh, dismissed the stallion and awakened them to sentience before releasing them back into the wild. Now, the intelligent horse defends their herd against predators and anyone who ventures too close, using their knowledge of the local area to keep them safe.

Creatures: Windchaser can speak, but they generally prefer not to unless they trust someone; their initial attitude is unfriendly. If the PCs can make them friendly, the awakened horse can tell the PCs about all the non-hidden encounter areas in the hills or plains of the Slough, including the location of Armag's Tomb and the fact that the Tiger Lord barbarians are concealing themselves in a hidden valley there. If made helpful, Windchaser may even deign to become a PC's mount.

RIDING HORSES (16) — CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 209
Initiative Perception +5

WINDCHASER — CREATURE 8

UNIQUE | CN | LARGE | BEAST

Variant war horse
Perception +16; low-light vision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet
Languages Common, Druidic
Skills Acrobatics +15, Athletics +18
Str +6, **Dex** +1, **Con** +6, **Int** +2, **Wis** +3, **Cha**+2
AC 27; **Fort** +18, **Ref** +15, **Will** +16
HP 138
Attack of Opportunity ↻
Buck ↻ DC 26
Speed 40 feet
Melee ◆ hoof +20, **Damage** 2d10+9 bludgeoning
Gallop ◆◆ Windchaser Strides twice, gaining a +10-foot circumstance bonus to their Speed during these Strides.

DR4. DESPERATE REFUGEES

RESOURCE | STANDARD

During the start of this campaign, nothing of interest is found in this hex. But once Chapter 5 begins and word of the PCs' growing nation spreads, a forlorn group of refugees consisting of a mix of merchants, street performers, and a few worshippers of the god Hanspur (a minor god of rivers and river travel) flee the city of Pitax in hopes of reaching what they've heard is a kinder, gentler nation to the east. Unfortunately, the refugees vastly underestimated the dangers of the Stolen Lands, and after suffering death and horror from the claws and teeth of several monstrous predators, they hunker down to a relatively safe campsite here, afraid to move forward or back.

When the PCs arrive, the refugees are arguing about whether they should head north to Fort Drelev or simply return in defeat to Pitax. When they realize who the PCs are, they desperately fall on their hands and knees before them, begging to be escorted to the promised land to the east.

The refugees are commoners and craftspeople. Escorting them through the lands safely should be a difficult task, but if the PCs can get them to their nation, the act of kindness will be well repaid over time.

Resource: If the PCs transport these refugees safely to one of their settlements, the grateful refugees spread tales of their saviors' good deeds, reducing Unrest by 2. In addition, they pool their resources and talents and allow the PCs to build a Trade Shop in that settlement during the next Activity phase for free; doing so does not count against that phase's limits on Civic activities taken in a turn.

ZONE 12: TIGER LORDS

This swath of hills has been claimed by the Tiger Lord barbarians. While they don't directly control this entire zone, it encompasses lands they view as their territory.

TIGER LORDS (TL) — ZONE 12

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 11 table (page 103)	Varies
6–8	4 aurumvoraxes[B2]	Low 12
9–11	4 mastodons[B2]	Low 12
12–13	4 Tiger Lords (page 320)	Moderate 12
14–15	1 ankou[B2]	Moderate 12
16–17	2 athachs[B2]	Moderate 12
18–19	1 doprillu[B2]	Moderate 12
20	1 jotund troll[B2]	Severe 12

Ankou See the Ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

Tiger Lords An encounter with a Tiger Lord warband in this zone is made up of four Tiger Lords. They are associated with the larger camp located near Armag's Tomb (area **TL3**) but aren't the same barbarians the PCs will encounter there. They attack on sight and fight to the death, but at your discretion, any captured alive may boast and brag about their group in a way that could reveal clues to the location of Armag's Tomb.

TL1. FLOODED MINE

RESOURCE | STANDARD

A wooden head frame in the side of a sloped hill marks the entrance to a mine; the rope to its joist has gone

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

missing, and a pair of worn picks lies discarded on the ground. This mine was recently established by Baron Hannis Drelev's men after some promising assaying revealed silver. Unfortunately, the miners swiftly struck an aquifer that immediately flooded the mine, forcing the men to abandon the site, and not long after, the spread of the Tiger Lords through the region cut off Drelev's access to the mine entirely.

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex, they'll need to repair the flooded silver mine before they can take advantage of it. Doing so requires successfully undertaking the Repair the Flooded Mine Leadership activity during a Kingdom turn's Activity phase.

REPAIR THE FLOODED MINE

DOWNTIME | LEADERSHIP

Requirements Your kingdom is Master rank in Engineering.

A group of engineers work to drain the flooded mine, shore up its damaged section, and establish the mine as a functional Work Site. Spend 20 RP, then attempt a DC 32 Engineering check.

Critical Success The mine is repaired, and as a bonus, your workers Establish a Work Site at the mine immediately. This mine produces 2 Ore Commodities per Kingdom turn.

Success As a critical success, but you must take a separate Establish Work Site activity to activate the mine.

Failure Work on repairing the mine proceeds, but at a much slower (and more expensive) pace than you'd hoped. The mine remains flooded, but you can attempt this check again on the next Kingdom turn.

Critical Failure As failure, but a catastrophic failure costs the lives of several workers. Increase Unrest by 2 and Decay by 1. The next time you attempt to Repair the Flooded Mine, it costs 40 RP.

TL2. GIANT'S CAVE — SEVERE 12

RESOURCE | STANDARD

Several wagons, one entirely overturned and all in various stages of destruction, lie scattered around the entrance of a large cave at the base of a barren hillside.

Creatures: While the Tiger Lords' intrusion forced out many hill giants, a stubborn and powerful family remains entrenched here. These three have ignored offers of allegiance with Armag's army in favor of waylaying travelers along the border between the River Kingdoms and Brevoy. The shattered wagons are the remains of their latest conquest, and they're currently arguing loudly in their cave over the best way to split their ill-gotten gains; they suffer a –2 circumstance penalty to Perception checks as a result. Emboldened by recent victories, the giants give no thought to strategy or tactics, and fight boldly to the death.

DARG, FESL, AND URDA — CREATURE 12

UNIQUE | CE | LARGE | EARTH | GIANT | HUMANOID

Variant hill giants (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 170)

Perception +20; low-light vision

Language Common, Jotun

Skills Athletics +25, Intimidation +20

Str +7, **Dex** +2, **Con** +5, **Int** –2, **Wis** +4, **Cha** +0

Items *+1 striking greatclub*, hide armor, sack with 5 rocks

AC 33; **Fort** +24, **Ref** +19, **Will** +22

HP 250

Catch Rock ↷

Speed 35 feet

Melee ❖ *greatclub* +27 (backswing, reach 10 feet, shove), **Damage** 3d10+13 bludgeoning

Melee ❖ fist +26 (agile, reach 10 feet), **Damage** 3d6+13 bludgeoning

Ranged ❖ rock +23 (brutal, range increment 120 feet), **Damage** 2d8+13 bludgeoning

Throw Rock ❖

Knockback ❖ **Requirements** The hill giant's last action was a successful melee Strike; **Effect** The hill giant's swing drives their enemy back. They push the foe back 5 feet, with the effects of a successful Shove. The hill giant can follow the foe as normal on a successful Shove.

Wide Swing ❖ The hill giant makes a single greatclub Strike and compares the attack roll result to the ACs of up to two foes within its reach. This counts as two attacks for the hill giant's multiple attack penalty.

Treasure: The giants' treasure consists of 700 sp, 208 gp, a suit of *+1 resilient half-plate*, a spyglass, a greater juggernaut mutagen, a *potion of flying*, and a *+2 striking dwarven waraxe*.

Resource: Among the spoils the giants have gathered from hunters, poachers, pilgrims, explorers, and merchants are several wagonloads of tools and building materials. The tools grant the kingdom 4 bonus Resource Dice on the next Kingdom turn. In addition, once the giants are defeated or driven off, this hex functions as a Refuge once Claimed.

TL3. ARMAG'S TOMB

RESOURCE | STANDARD

This area is fully detailed in Part 3 of Chapter 7.

Resource: If the PCs defeat all the dangers in this tomb and Claim this hex, it functions as a Refuge.

TL4. EXPLORER'S GRAVE

HIDDEN

A long-dead Taldan explorer lies partially buried in a cleft here. Success at a DC 30 Perception check made as part of Reconnoitering the hex allows a PC to discover the body.

Treasure: Most of the corpse's gear has rotted or rusted away, but his *moderate sturdy steel shield*,

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

decorated with the coat of arms of a long-defunct Taldan noble family, remains usable.

TL5. AURUMVORAX DEN — SEVERE 12

STANDARD

Creatures: A set of burrows honeycombs a granite hillside here, pocking the hillside with dozens of small openings. These mark the entrances to a tangled warren of tunnels serving as the lair for a half-dozen particularly hardy aurumvoraxes. This extended family of golden guardians wandered into these lands from Numeria years ago, and their swiftly growing offspring have started to spread throughout the region ever since.

The aurumvoraxes are very territorial, and if they notice any sign of intrusion into the area, they come raging out of their burrows to attack. They'll pursue trespassers for miles before giving up the chase, and they fight to the death.

ELITE AURUMVORAXES (2) — CREATURE 10

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 6, 29

Initiative Perception +20

Treasure: The aurumvorax warren is a tight fit for Medium creatures, who must Squeeze to explore its deepest reaches. The actual den is located at the center of the tangle of tunnels; exploring the warren and finding the den requires a successful DC 30 Survival check or DC 35 Perception check made as part of a 4-hour Investigate activity.

The central den contains numerous skeletons and treasures that have survived the aurumvoraxes' tendency to gnaw on things that are shiny. This includes 3,360 sp, a silver-and-ivory scepter worth 250 gp, a copper necklace set with pearls worth 80 gp, a *golden lions wondrous figurine*, a *+1 flaming kukri*, and a *wand of levitate* (3rd).

TL6. CHIMERA PRIDE — SEVERE 12

STANDARD

A thirty-foot-wide cave opening overlooks the valley floor near the top of a hill here. The cave opening is devoid of vegetation and strewn with bones. Three nearby stone outcroppings bear signs of scratch marks left behind by some unseen animal or beast.

Creatures: A pride of three oversized chimeras lair in this large cavern, taking to the air each day to hunt the southern plains. They particularly enjoy the flesh of wild horses, as evidenced by the half-eaten carcass and bones strewn about the cave entrance.

The chimeras stay airborne for as long as possible, using their breath weapons at first before swooping in to make three-headed strikes; they then use that tactic again the next round before taking back to the air to repeat their fire-breathing pattern. Once two are slain, the last chimera flees the region once it has fewer than 25 Hit Points remaining.

OVERSIZED CHIMERAS (3) — CREATURE 12

RARE CE LARGE BEAST

Variant chimera (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 63)

Perception +23; darkvision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet

Languages Draconic

Skills Acrobatics +20, Athletics +25, Stealth +22

Str +7, **Dex** +2, **Con** +5, **Int** –3, **Wis** +5, **Cha** +0

AC 33; **Fort** +25, **Ref** +22, **Will** +19

HP 220

Three Headed Any ability that would sever an oversized chimera's head (such as a critical hit with a vorpal weapon) severs one head at random. Losing a head doesn't kill a chimera (as long as it has one head left), but it does prevent it from making Strikes with the lost head or using the head's Breath Weapon.

Triple Opportunity An oversized chimera gains 2 extra reactions each round that it can use only to make Attacks of Opportunity. It must use a different head for each reaction, and it can't use more than one on the same triggering action. If it loses one of its heads, it also loses one of these extra reactions.

Attack of Opportunity ↷

Speed 25 feet, fly 40 feet

Melee ❖ dragon jaws +26, **Damage** 2d6+11 piercing plus 3d6 fire

Melee ❖ lion jaws +26, **Damage** 3d10+11 piercing

Melee ❖ goat horns +26, **Damage** 3d10+11 piercing

Melee ❖ claw +26 (agile), **Damage** 3d8+11 slashing

Breath Weapon ❖❖ (arcane, evocation) The oversized chimera breathes out a blistering cone of fire that deals 13d6 fire damage to all creatures in the area (DC 32 basic Reflex save).

Draconic Bite An oversized chimera's dragon head deals an extra 3d6 fire damage.

Three-Headed Strike ❖❖ The oversized chimera makes a Strike with its dragon jaws, lion jaws, and goat horns, each at a –2 penalty and targeting a different creature. These Strikes count as only 1 attack for the chimera's multiple attack penalty, and the penalty doesn't increase until after it has made all 3 attacks.

Treasure: So far, the chimeras have mostly preyed on horses or other wild animals, though they sometimes fly over the swamp as well. Three dead boggards are proof of this, and one of those three was a relatively powerful sorcerer. While the body has been torn to ribbons, their *type I bracers of armor*, *wand of lightning bolt (5th)*, and *+1 corrosive striking whip* have survived.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

ZONE 13: RUSHLIGHT

Although the region known as Rushlight isn't officially part of Pitax, none have so far contested that nation's use of the region. King Castruccio Irovetti has, in particular, used Rushlight as his private hunting grounds and also hosted events there. To augment the former, he's had agents stock Rushlight with dangerous creatures, some of which have begun to adapt quite well to the region.

RUSHLIGHT (RU) — **ZONE 13**

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 12 table (page 105)	Varies
6–8	6 mastodons[B2]	Low 13
9–11	1 ankou[B2]	Low 13
12–13	3 cauthoojes[B1]	Moderate 13
14–15	2 irlgaunts[B2]	Moderate 13
16–17	1 wemmuth[B1]	Moderate 13
18–19	3 Pitax wardens (page 336)	Moderate 13
20	1 warsworn[B1]	Severe 13

Ankou See the Ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

Pitax Wardens This encounter is with a group of three wardens on patrol in Rushlight. If war with Pitax has begun, they'll attack the PCs on sight. Otherwise, they'll interrogate the PCs about their purpose in the region; depending on the answers, they'll either let them move on, escort them out of the region back to Drelev, or attack. Once a fight begins, a Pitax warden fights to the death, as none of these loyalists want to risk their king's anger. If the PCs have already won the war with Pitax, reroll this encounter instead using the zone 14 table.

Warsworn Encounters with warsworns can only occur after the War of the River Kings begins. If you roll this result before then, reroll on this table until you roll a non-warsworn encounter.

RU1. HEMLOCK ISLAND

LANDMARK

Like the island in Candlemere to the southeast, this island has a reputation for being haunted by "lights." Yet unlike Candlemere's island, Hemlock Island bears no strange ruins or notable infestation of monsters. The only denizens of this scenic, beautiful island are brightly colored rainbow egrets that scream like humans when slain. A large pool of water sits at the center of Hemlock Island—a deep spring from which a swift-moving river flows down to fill the surrounding lake of Rushlight and its own river that flows southwest to Pitax.

Hemlock Island is Ilora's proposed meeting place with the PCs (as detailed in area **GU3**) once the War of the River Kings begins.

RU2. RUSHLIGHT FESTIVAL GROUNDS

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

A well-traveled road from the city of Pitax allows easy travel to these festival grounds, used often by King Castruccio Irovetti for tournaments, hosting private parties, and various other celebrations. This hex is well patrolled as a result, at least until the War of the River Kings begins partway through Chapter 8. Before that event, all wandering monster encounters in this hex are automatically with Pitax wardens.

The festival grounds themselves are presented in full detail in Part 1 of Chapter 8.

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex, Pitax considers it an act of war. This ends any diplomatic relations the PCs might have with Pitax, and it increases Pitax's Negotiation DC to 40. If the PCs build a settlement here, the permanent structures on the festival grounds grant a free Cistern and one lot of Houses. In addition, the presence of the coliseum halves the cost of building an Arena in the settlement.

RU3. CATSPAW CAMP

STANDARD

There's nothing of interest here until the War of the River Kings starts, when the Catspaw Marauders set up camp here. See page 353 of Chapter 8 for details.

ZONE 14: GLENEBON LOWLANDS

The idyllic grasslands of Rushlight extend further north here, yet this area is less well patrolled. Here, monsters and dangerous wildlife are left to their own devices by Pitax—as long as they don't drift too far west. When the War of the River Kings begins, King Castruccio Irovetti uses this region to practice maneuvers for his armies, but until then, the Glenebon Lowlands remain relatively empty of encounters other than those with wandering monsters.

GLENEBON LOWLANDS (GL) — **ZONE 14**

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 13 table (above)	Varies
6–8	6 mammoths[B1]	Low 14
9–11	1 jotund troll[B2]	Low 14
12–13	3 irlgaunts[B2]	Moderate 14
14–15	4 athachs[B2]	Moderate 14
16–17	2 ankous[B2]	Moderate 14
18–19	1 warsworn[B1]	Moderate 14
20	Wild hunt (detailed below)	Severe 14

Ankous See the Ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

Warsworn See the warsworn entry in Zone 13 above.

Wild Hunt An encounter with the wild hunt in the Glenebon Lowlands is with a single wild hunt archer (page 618) traveling with a wild hunt hound (page 616). These agents of the First World are merely scouting the lay of the land, having heard rumors that the Stolen Lands may soon be a place where the First World holds greater sway. They initially attack the PCs simply for the thrill of the hunt. If either archer or hound is reduced to fewer than 60 Hit Points, they will break off the attack and call for a truce,

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

explaining that they were simply "practicing" for the greater hunt to come. They don't know any details about that but can certainly pretend to know them if dropping ominous warnings to the PCs secures an amusing reaction of fear.

GL1. TUSKER'S STOMPING GROUND

STANDARD

This region is destined to become the campsite for a collection of hill giants gathered under Castruccio's banner. Prior to the War of the River Kings, this hex is empty of anything noteworthy, but once the war begins, Tusker's Raiders can be found here—see page 351 of Chapter 8 for more details.

GL2. MARSHALING GROUND

STANDARD

After the War of the River Kings begins, this area becomes the marshaling ground for the Pitax Horde, but until then, there's nothing of interest in this hex. See page 353 of Chapter 8 for details on the Pitax Horde.

ZONE 15: PITAX

The nation of Pitax extends into this corner of the Stolen Lands, with its capital city sitting at the very edge of the nation's border. Pitax itself is relatively safe to travel—for all his faults, King Castruccio Irovetti does keep the nation safe enough for his citizens, despite the dangers presented by Glenebon and the sinister forest of Thousand Voices.

All the hexes in this zone are officially part of the nation of Pitax, and as such, attempts to Claim any of the hexes in this zone are regarded as acts of war by Pitax. Once Pitax has been captured or defeated, the PCs can claim hexes here normally.

PITAX (PX) — **ZONE 15**

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–12	4 Pitax wardens (page 108)	Low 15
13–16	2 ankous[B2]	Low 15
17–19	Wild hunt (detailed below)	Moderate 15
20	2 warsworns[B1]	Severe 15

Ankous See the ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

Pitax Wardens This encounter is with a group of four wardens on patrol in Pitax. See the Pitax Wardens encounter in Zone 13 for further details. If the PCs have already won the war with Pitax, reroll this encounter by rolling 1d8+12 to determine the new result.

Warsworns See the warsworn entry in Zone 13 on page 108.

Wild Hunt An encounter with the wild hunt in Pitax is with a single wild hunt archer (page 618) accompanied by a wild hunt hound (page 616). These fey avoid urban areas and are more interested in observing events in Pitax than they are fighting. If confronted, the archer smiles mercurially and informs the PCs that they are not yet quarry, but that the wild hunt looks forward to the coming chase. The archer remains evasive and teasing on all topics if questioned, but feel free to use this encounter to foreshadow upcoming events regarding the wild hunt in the adventure's final chapter. If attacked, the wild hunt fights to the death.

PX1. LITTLETOWN

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

The city of Pitax is by far the largest settlement in the nation; most of the others are small villages like Littletown. Many of these villages are located along the banks of the Pitax River further south—Littletown is the only one located upstream from Pitax. Initially founded with hopes of serving as a lumber town, the dangers of Thousand Voices (which do not traditionally reach beyond the forest's borders but are quick to devour any who brave the tangles under its boughs) quickly put an end to those hopes.

Littletown is a cozy, thriving village of farmers and vintners, none of whom suspect what their king has planned for them. If the PCs visit Littletown after the War of the River Kings begins, they find the entire village in ruins; see page 353 of Chapter 8 for details. Until then, any who visit Littletown find it a cozy enough place with relatively little to encourage a long stay.

LITTLETOWN — **SETTLEMENT 2**

LN | VILLAGE

Government autocracy

Population 297 (200 humans, 50 halflings, 20 dwarves, 17 gnomes, 7 others)

Languages Common

Religions Gozreh

Threats King Castruccio Irovetti's unexpected plans

Cozy and Fortunate Until the king sacrifices the town to the war effort, Littletown's tradition of rural relaxation makes it a delightful place to rest and recover, its complacent citizens completely ignorant of the fact that their days are numbered. As a result, a character who spends Downtime on long-term rest in Littletown gains an additional 5 Hit Points from the rest.

Lorthy Kullden (CN male human aristocrat 2) Mayor

Resource: The PCs won't have a chance to bring Littletown into their nation until after the village's destruction. After that, if the PCs build a settlement in this hex, the village's ruins can be rebuilt into a single lot of Houses, a General Store, and a Town Hall.

PX2. PITAX

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

The capital city of Pitax is fully detailed in Chapter 8, including its stat block and the resources the PCs can gain from integrating it into their own kingdom.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

ZONE 16: GLENEBON UPLANDS

The hills of northern Glenebon present a rural beauty, yet the rolling dales and thickly vegetated valleys hide a wide range of particularly dangerous threats.

GLENEBON UPLANDS (GU) — ZONE 16

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 14 list (page 108)	Varies
6–8	3 ankous[B2]	Low 16
9–11	2 wemmuths[B1]	Low 16
12–13	Wild hunt (detailed below)	Moderate 16
14–15	6 elite athachs[B2]	Moderate 16
16–17	2 skulltaker[B1]	Moderate 16
18–19	4 hill giant butchers (see below)	Moderate 16
20	Minognos-Ushad (page 118)	Severe 16

Ankous See the Ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

Hill Giant Butchers These brutal giants serve Kob Moleg. They've been tasked with patrolling the uplands for humanoids to catch as food and are particularly fond of adventurers, since they tend to carry lots of treasure. The hill giants ambush the PCs if possible.

Minognos-Ushad An encounter with the legendary wyvern of the Glenebon Uplands occurs as Minognos-Ushad is out on the hunt. She's looking for larger prey to sate her hunger and flies low over the PCs to scare them, but doesn't attack unless the PCs initiate combat. In this event, she fights until reduced to 100 Hit Points or fewer, at which point she attempts to flee back to her lair in area **BR3** to recover. Further encounters with Minognos-Ushad (after she heals) are with a vengeful wyvern who is eager to fight again.

Wild Hunt An encounter with the wild hunt in the Glenebon Uplands is with a wild hunt archer (page 618) mounted on a wild hunt horse (page 617) and accompanied by a wild hunt hound (page 616). These agents of the First World are merely scouting the lay of the land. If archer, horse, or hound is reduced to fewer than 60 Hit Points, they break off the attack and call for a truce, as detailed in the Wild Hunt entry for Zone 14 on page 108.

HILL GIANT BUTCHER — CREATURE 14

RARE | CE | LARGE | EARTH | GIANT | HUMANOID

Variant hill giant (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 170)

Perception +25; low-light vision

Language Common, Jotun

Skills Athletics +28, Intimidation +24, Survival +25

Str +8, **Dex** +4, **Con** +5, **Int** –2, **Wis** +5, **Cha** +0

Items *+2 striking battle axe*, *+1 striking hatchet*, *+1 resilient hide armor*, sack with 5 rocks

AC 36; **Fort** +28, **Ref** +23, Will +26

HP 260

Catch Rock ↷

Speed 35 feet

Melee ❖ *battle axe* +30 (sweep), **Damage** 2d8+16 slashing

Melee ❖ *hatchet* +30 (agile, sweep, thrown 10 feet), **Damage** 2d6+16 slashing

Ranged ❖ rock +26 (brutal, range increment 120 feet), **Damage** 3d4+16 bludgeoning

Primal Innate Spells DC 31; **7th** *entangle*, *longstrider*; **6th** *barkskin*

Menace Prey ❖ (concentrate) The hill giant butcher designates up to two creatures they can see and hear, or one they're Tracking, as their prey. The hill giant butcher gains a +2 circumstance bonus to Perception checks to Seek the prey and to Intimidation checks to Demoralize the prey. This effect lasts until the hill giant butcher uses Menace Prey again.

Sneak Attack The hill giant butcher deals an extra 2d6 precision damage to flat-footed creatures.

Throw Rock ❖

Twin Butchery ❖ **Frequency** once per round; **Requirement** the hill giant butcher is wielding two melee weapons, each in a different hand; **Effect** The hill giant butcher uses both of its axes against a single target. It makes two Strikes against its menaced prey, one with each of the required weapons. If both hit the same menaced prey, combine their damage for the purpose of its resistances and weaknesses. In addition, if both Strikes hit, the menaced prey is flat-footed until the start of the hill giant butcher's next turn. Apply the hill giant butcher's multiple attack penalty normally.

Wide Swing ❖ As hill giant.

THE EATER OF KINGS

30 XP | KINGDOM 30 XP

The legend of Minognos-Ushad, the "Eater of Kings," has figured prominently in Tiger Lord folklore and local fireside tales for ages. If someone were to slay the ancient wyvern, their name would resound through the ages as a legend.

Source: Once the PCs reach 15th level, they'll begin to hear rumors of the notorious beast as citizens in their kingdom openly wonder how long it might be before the Eater of Kings notices the region's newest monarch and comes to feed. A PC who researches Minognos-Ushad can attempt either a DC 39 Arcana check or a DC 34 Dragon Lore check; even on a failure, the PC learns that Minognos-Ushad hunts in the Glenebon Uplands and Numeria. On a success, they learn that her lair is in the Branthlend Mountains, and on a critical success, they learn that her lair is in a place called Hungerdark (area **BR3**).

Completion: Kill Minognos-Ushad, either during a random encounter or in her lair.

Reward: At the start of the next Kingdom turn, the Tiger Lords are impressed enough that they approach the PCs' kingdom to join the nation; this allows the PCs to gain an automatic critical success at a free Pledge of Fealty activity for the Tiger Lords. If the Tiger Lords have already pledged to the kingdom, they instead

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

bring offerings to the ruler, and at the start of the next Kingdom turn, the PCs gain 6 bonus Resource Dice.

GU1. STEAMGROTTO — LOW 16

LANDMARK

Dozens of sulfurous-smelling ponds and foul springs dot the hills in this hex. Most of these contain geysers that spray boiling water and steam. The timing of these eruptions varies, so travel here is dangerous.

Travel through this hex automatically exposes the PCs to geysers, causing them to take the Navigate Steamgrotto activity (characters can use the Follow the Expert activity when Navigating Steamgrotto). If the PCs Reconnoiter this hex, the additional time they spend in Steamgrotto reduces their result from Navigating Steamgrotto by one degree of success.

Due to the volatility of these geysers, this hex cannot be used to build roads, settlements, Farmlands, Work Sites, or any other form of structure.

NAVIGATE STEAMGROTTO

CONCENTRATE EXPLORATION

You spend time observing the patterns of geyser eruptions in Steamgrotto, then plan your moves through the region as best you can to avoid exposing yourself to danger. You can attempt to Navigate Steamgrotto using Nature, Perception, or Survival and rolling a successful DC 35 check, but using Perception doesn't provide you deeper insights into the nature of the danger and you suffer a –4 circumstance penalty as a result.

Critical Success You avoid the danger and anyone who Follows the Expert gains double the normal bonus to their roll granted from that activity.

Success You avoid the danger.

Failure You step a bit too close to a few geysers and mistime your movements. You take 10d6 fire damage (DC 36 basic Reflex save).

Critical Failure You badly misjudge your movements and are hit full-force by a geyser. You take 20d6 fire damage (DC 36 basic Reflex save).

Reward: The first time the PCs Navigate Steamgrotto, regardless of their level of success, they earn 30 XP.

GU2. WHITEROSE

LANDMARK RESOURCE

Whiterose and its hilltop abbey are presented in full detail in Part 3 of Chapter 8.

Resource: Once Whiterose Abbey and the dangers surrounding it are dealt with, the abbey itself functions as a Refuge if the hex is Claimed. If the PCs decide to establish a settlement here, the abbey functions as a free Temple structure, while the nearby winery as a free Brewery structure.

GU3. ILORA'S CAMP — TRIVIAL 16

SECRET

The Pitax River grows narrow here as it nears its source. Both riverbanks are thick with brambles, and the predominance of unusually noisy crows, aggressive rattlesnakes, swaths of stinging nettles (page 77), and various ticks and mosquitoes makes the region a deservedly remote one; this hex is greater difficult terrain. This isolation serves the precise needs of a Pitaxian exile named Ilora Nuski. Her campsite is quite hidden, requiring a successful DC 35 Perception check to discover while the hex is Reconnoitered.

Creature: Ilora's campsite, hidden deep in the brambles, consists of little more than a pair of well-used tents 30 feet from the river's edge. There's not even a real clearing around the tents, since Ilora can move through the brambles with supernatural ease. These same brambles block the view from the river but allow Ilora to keep an eye on anyone who might be using the waterway to reach her hideout.

Ilora has seen better days, but even those days were fraught with peril. In her previous life, she was the leader of a group of bandits called the River Razors, a merry band of rangers, druids, and rogues who relied upon their shared talents and skills at bushcraft and primal magic to prey upon aristocrats and rich merchants who used the rivers of Pitax to transport their wealth. After King Castruccio took the crown and banditry increasingly became organized by the Pitax thieves' guild, Ilora saw her beloved homeland transform into something she hated. Gone were the days when "honest" smugglers and bandits could use Pitax as a safe haven for their work. The rise of drug abuse in the city, the influx of deluded "jesters and fools" eager to please a pompous ruler, and the overwhelming presence of the Pitax wardens turned the city into something she loathed, and her days of banditry turned to rebellion.

The king and his agents were quick to squash the River Razors, and today, Ilora is the only surviving member. Unable to show her face in Pitax, Ilora continues to build plans to free Pitax from Castruccio and return its rule to the proper families. She's learned much of the city and knows quite a bit about its defenses, and her reputation as a wanted criminal is likely to come to the PCs' attention sooner or later.

If the PCs don't stumble across her camp on their own during exploration, Ilora eventually learns about them herself. Every few months, she makes the increasingly risky trip downriver to sneak into Pitax under cover of darkness, both to steal supplies she can't gather in the wild and to listen under open tavern windows to catch up on current events. She hears stories of the PCs' kingdom and is intrigued from the start, but she doesn't

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

take action until the War of the River Kings begins. At this point, she casts *animal messenger* to deliver a message to the PCs, inviting them via a short note: "If you wish to discuss how to handle our common enemy, meet me on Hemlock Island at the rise of the next full moon." (Feel free to replace Hemlock Island with a landmark of your choice.) The exact assistance Ilora can give the PCs to aid their war effort is detailed in Chapter 8 (page 349).

Ilora's campsite is protected by an *alarm* spell, which helps her become aware of intruders, but she hasn't survived this long in the Glenebon Uplands by being aggressive. She knows the monsters and dangers of the region could slay her swiftly, so she works to maintain a low profile on her hunting or foraging trips. By the time the PCs contact her, she has been living on her own in the wild for years. While her personal hygiene and diplomatic abilities have suffered greatly from her isolation, she maintains a strong sense of self and a natural dignity. Ilora doesn't need society to thrive, but that doesn't mean she's fine with allowing Castruccio to continue to ruin the city she still thinks of as home.

If the PCs manage to encounter her and befriend her before the War of the River Kings begins, Ilora gratefully accepts any offer of asylum in the PCs' kingdom; when the war begins, she can provide them advice immediately rather than waiting to arrange a meeting on Hemlock Island.

Ilora only fights foes she's confident she can handle in battle. Against foes that are obviously more powerful than herself, she has plenty of practice in evasion and does her best to flee. She doesn't generally hold grudges—Castruccio being a notable exception—but if the PCs continue to vex her, she may be pushed to extremes and seek powerful (but dangerous) alliances with regional threats.

ILORA NUSKI — CREATURE 12

UNIQUE | CN | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Perception +22

Languages Common, Hallit, Sylvan

Skills Acrobatics +23, Athletics +21 (+23 while jumping), Nature +22, River Lore +22, Society +20, Stealth +25, Survival +24

Str +3, **Dex** +5, **Con** +3, **Int** +2, **Wis** +4, **Cha** –1

Items *boots of bounding*, *+1 striking shortswords* (2), *+1 resilient studded leather armor*

AC 33; **Fort** +21, **Ref** +25, **Will** +22

HP 220

Twin Riposte ↷ **Trigger** A creature within Ilora's reach critically fails a melee Strike against her; **Requirements** Ilora is benefiting from Twin Parry; **Effect** Ilora attempts a melee Strike or uses a Disarm action against the triggering opponent.

Speed 30 feet

Melee ❖ shortsword +26 (agile, finesse, versatile S), **Damage** 2d6+6 piercing

Primal Prepared Spells DC 30, attack +22; **3rd** *heal*; **2nd** *animal messenger*, *entangle*; **1st** *alarm*, *pass without trace*; **Cantrips (3rd)** *electric arc*, *light*, *produce flame*, *tanglefoot*

Nature's Edge Ilora always finds the weak points in her foes' defenses when they're on unfavorable terrain. Enemies are flat-footed to her if they're in difficult terrain, restrained, or immobilized due to natural or magical environmental effects.

Twin Parry ❖ **Requirements** Ilora wields two melee weapons, one in each hand; **Effect** Ilora gains a +1 circumstance bonus to AC until the start of her next turn. She loses this bonus if she no longer meets the requirements.

Twin Takedown ❖ **Frequency** once per round; **Requirements** Ilora wields two melee weapons, each in a different hand. **Effect** Ilora makes two Strikes against her target, one with each of the required weapons. If both hit the same target, combine the damage from the weapons for the purpose of resistances and weaknesses. She applies her multiple attack penalty to each Strike normally.

Wild Stride Ilora moves quickly through obstacles. She ignores the effects of nonmagical difficult terrain and treats the hindrances of greater difficult terrain as those of difficult terrain. Within 300 feet of a river bank, she ignores the effects of all nonmagical difficult and greater difficult terrain.

Award: If the PCs manage to secure Ilora's aid against Pitax, they earn 80 XP.

ZONE 17: NUMERIA

Only a small, remote reach of the nation of Numeria extends into the Stolen Lands, a portion of the region that isn't directly under the control of the Black Sovereign. Though remote from the regions of Numeria where killer robots, mutant horrors, or other technological terrors hold sway, these badlands still contain dangerous threats.

NUMERIA (NU) — ZONE 17

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–3	Roll on zone 16 table (page 110)	Varies
4–6	Mammoth herd[B1]	Trivial 17
7–9	4 hill giant butchers (page 110)	Moderate 17
10–11	4 ankous[B2]	Low 17
12–13	Minognos-Ushad (page 118)	Moderate 17
14–15	2 radiant wardens[B2]	Moderate 17
16–17	1 elite adamantine golem[B1]	Moderate 17
18–19	Wild hunt (detailed below)	Moderate 17
20	One elite guthallath[B6]	Severe 17

Ankous See the Ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Constructs Any encounters with adamantine golems, guthallaths, or radiant wardens in Numeria are with ancient robotic versions of these creatures. In encounters with them, describe them as having more technological aspects. The guthallath's erosion aura could be caused by clouds of deconstructor nanites and its annihilation beams manifest as plasma blasts. The adamantine golem might have tank treads instead of legs and its vent ability might manifest as a spray of dozens of laser beams in a cone. And the radiant warden's radiant beams and blast serve as rippling attacks of focused graviton beams. All of these constructs have weakness 15 to critical hits and electricity, but their other statistics do not change. If you'd rather not introduce Numeria's themes of super-science and strange technology, you can either present these constructs as standard versions, or re-roll your encounter to get a more appropriate result for your game.

Hill Giant Butchers These brutal giants serve Kob Moleg (detailed on page 352). See the hill giant butchers entry in zone 16 on page 110 for more details.

Mammoth Herd This encounter is with a wandering herd of mammoths, typically a dozen or so. An encounter with a large number of mammoths is still relatively minor for high-level characters, so feel free to simply have an encounter with a mammoth herd in Numeria be a flavorful but ultimately non-combat encounter.

Minognos-Ushad See the Minognos-Ushad entry in Zone 16 on page 110.

Wild Hunt An encounter with the wild hunt in Numeria is with a wild hunt scout (page 619) accompanied by two wild hunt hounds (page 616). These agents of the First World see the strange technological influences in Numeria as a curiosity, but don't really have much interest in the land at this time. They regard the PCs with the same curiosity, but don't initially attack unless they are attacked first, in which case they fight until reduced to 60 or fewer Hit Points before fleeing or calling for a truce, as detailed in the Wild Hunt entry for Zone 14 on page 108.

NUMERIAN TRADE

30 XP | 30 KINGDOM XP

Malchar Tevalkan is an ambitious merchant who wants to open a trade route with Numeria. But first, he needs someone to build a road for him to use for his route!

Source: Malchar Tevalkan (once the PCs reach 17th level)

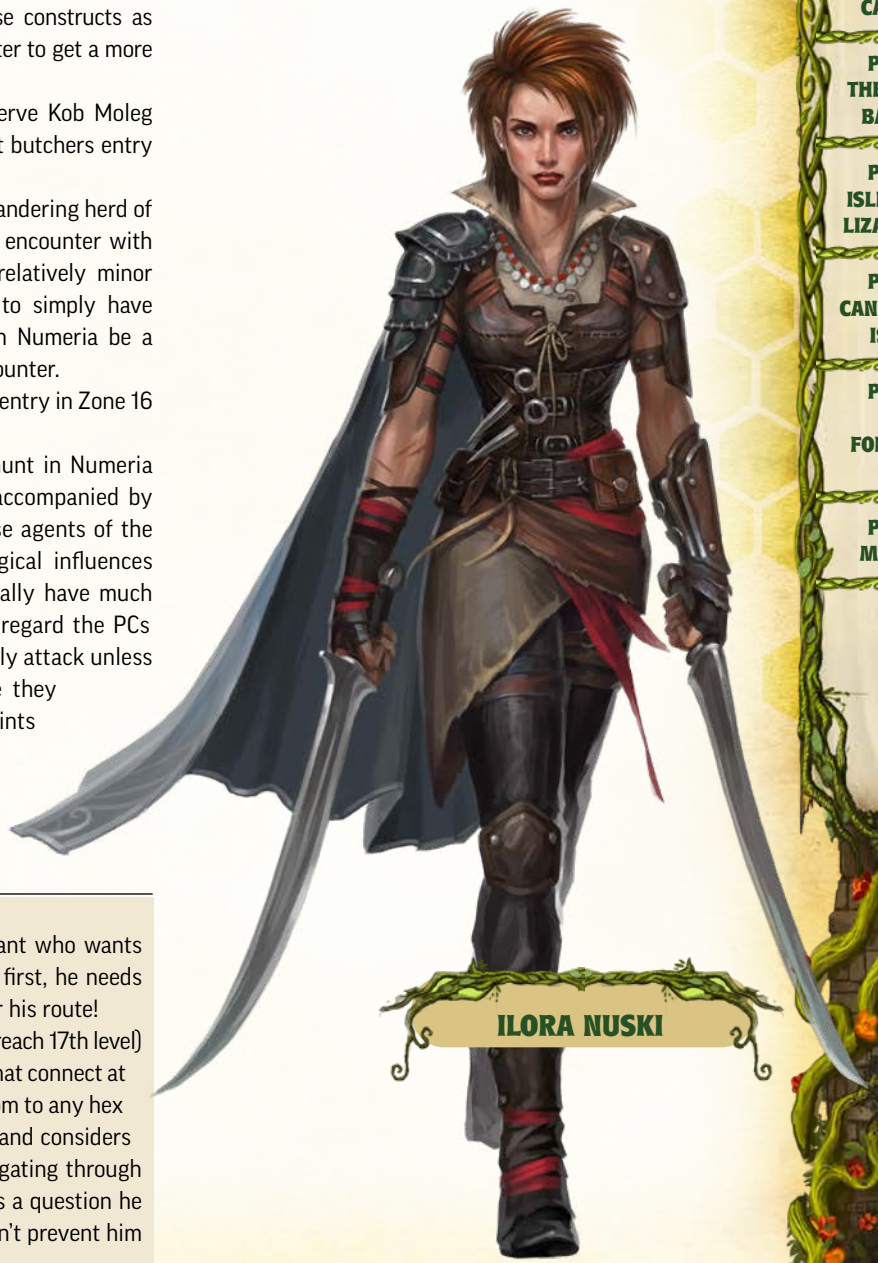
Completion: Once the PCs build roads that connect at least one city or metropolis in their kingdom to any hex in zone 17, Malchar Tevalkan is delighted and considers the task complete—how he plans on navigating through Numeria itself to the closest settlement is a question he doesn't yet have answers for, but that won't prevent him from rewarding the PCs.

Reward: Malchar begins using the roads immediately to move his merchants and wares; even though he's not quite yet trading with Numeria, this additional movement affords the PCs a free Trade Agreement that increases the amount of Resource Dice gained when they Manage Trade Agreements by 2 (except on a critical failure).

NU1. THE MAMMOTH GRAVEYARD SEVERE 17

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

Along the northern slopes of the Branthlend Mountains, the grassy hills of Glenebon grow increasingly barren and rugged as they lead west into Numeria. All manner of strange creatures dwell in these regions, but here



ILORA NUSKI

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

along the northern and northeastern edges of the Glenebon Uplands, the primary denizens are vast, roaming herds of woolly mammoths.

At this specific point along the northern Branthlend foothills is a legendary location—a mammoth graveyard. An immense box canyon nestled between two bald foothills creates a strange gathering place for wandering woolly mammoths, which feel a strange pull to this cleft when their time grows near. Several such sites are known throughout Numeria, and they are often sought after for the rich troves of ivory promised by the bones that lie within.

Creature: For many years, this graveyard has been watched over by an incredibly old mammoth. He is more than a mere animal—he is Hillstomper, a sapient creature awakened years ago by a now-dead druid (the same druid, in fact, who awakened the horse Windchaser, detailed in area **DR3**).

Hillstomper has a shameful problem, though, and has been wandering the hills of this hex for weeks, agonizing over it. Unless the PCs are being particularly stealthy, he notices them soon after they enter this hex, and he approaches them cautiously. Hillstomper bears several partially healed wounds and burns; one of his eyes is completely sightless from the scarring. The elderly and unusually intelligent mammoth approaches the PCs with a pronounced limp, then hails them in his deep, rumbling voice, calling for help in Common. If the PCs attack, Hillstomper attempts to flee, leading them toward the graveyard in hopes of getting them in a fight with the creatures that dwell there.

If, on the other hand, the PCs agree to speak to him, Hillstomper thanks them and begs for their aid. He explains that he's been charged with guarding the mammoth graveyard in the mountain foothills to the south, but that several weeks ago, two cairn linnorms claimed the place as their new den. Hillstomper desperately wants to destroy the linnorms, or at least drive them out of the graveyard he has been entrusted to guard, but his two previous attempts have left him gravely wounded. If the PCs are interested in helping the awakened mammoth, he agrees to aid them in the fight to reclaim the graveyard if they wish.



THE MAMMOTH'S SHAME

30 XP | KINGDOM 30 XP

Help Hillstomper with the cause of his shame.

Source: Hillstomper, the awakened mammoth

Completion: Kill the cairn linnorms that have moved into the mammoth graveyard.

Reward: Hillstomper allows the PCs to incorporate the graveyard into their kingdom, allowing them to Claim this Hex automatically with a critical success during a following Kingdom turn.

The mammoth graveyard itself is a rocky canyon filled with boulders and tangled heaps of bones and tusks. Any Huge or smaller creature treats the area as difficult terrain. The cairn linnorms that now dwell in the graveyard have smashed apart several of the skeletons at the heart of the canyon to make a sort of nest out of mammoth bones and tusks, but they eagerly slither forward to attack. The linnorms fight to the death.

HILLSTOMPER CREATURE 11

UNIQUE | N | HUGE | ANIMAL

Variant mammoth (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 154)

Perception +21; low-light vision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet

Languages Common

Skills Athletics +25, Diplomacy +19, Intimidation +19, Survival +21

Str +8, **Dex** +1, **Con** +5, **Int** +2, **Wis** +2, **Cha** +2

AC 31; **Fort** +22, **Ref** +16, **Will** +21; +2 status to saves vs. cold

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

HP 200
Cold Adaptation As mammoth.

Speed 45 feet
Melee ❖ tusk +24 (reach 15 feet), **Damage** 3d8+14 piercing
Melee ❖ trunk +24 (reach 15 feet), **Effect** grabbing trunk
Melee ❖ foot +24 (reach 10 feet), **Damage** 2d10+14 bludgeoning
Dual Tusks ❖ As mammoth.
Grabbing Trunk As mammoth
Trample ❖❖❖ Large or smaller, foot, DC 30

CAIRN LINNORMS (2) CREATURE 18

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 166
Initiative Perception +30

Treasure: The cairn linnorms have an impressive stash of treasure spread out between a few sturdy treasure chests or simply heaped on the ground between them. This treasure consists of 18,200 cp, 3,204 sp, 260 gp, 32 pp, a silver coffer worth 25 gp that contains seven silver rings each worth 20 gp, an onyx and jade necklace worth 80 gp, a gold crown decorated with topazes worth a total of 180 gp, a suit of +2 *resilient elven chain* (standard grade), a green dragonhide breastplate (standard grade), a +2 *greater striking cold iron scimitar* (standard grade), a *scroll of summon dragon* (8th), a *wand of mind probe*, a leather pouch containing three vials of *dust of disappearance*, an *adult black dragon's breath potion*, a *major staff of fire*, an adamantine greataxe (standard grade), a pair of *major alchemist goggles*, a *truesight potion*, and a pair of *boots of speed*.

Resource: If the PCs Claim this hex, they must decide one of two ways to incorporate the Mammoth Graveyard into their kingdom. If they choose to leave it as it is, it functions as a Landmark and the PCs gain 3 Fame Points at the start of their next turn. If they choose to plunder it for ivory, they instead gain 6 bonus Resource Dice and 3 Infamy Points at the start of their next turn, but do not gain the Landmark benefits. A famous kingdom that chooses to plunder the ivory gains no Infamy points, and instead increases its Corruption by 2, as the citizens grow discontented with the leadership's unusual choice. An infamous kingdom that chooses to leave it as a landmark gains no Fame points, and instead increases its Crime by 2, as certain citizens in the kingdom plunder some of the ivory for themselves.

ZONE 18: THOUSAND VOICES

These tangled reaches consist of a dense woodland of primeval growth. Predominantly pine and fir trees, the undergrowth in this forest is particularly tangled; this zone is difficult terrain. More disturbing, those who intrude upon the forest are constantly beset upon by faint whispers, as if mocking, mournful spirits were deriding the intruders or bemoaning their doom. This unsettling supernatural effect is a relatively recent manifestation, one that descended upon the woodland just a few decades ago when Nyrissa first manifested the Castle of Knives within the forest. Before this event, the woods were known as the Branthlend Forest, but today, this old name is all but forgotten. Now, the forest is known as Thousand Voices.

The unsettling whispers persist as long as Nyrissa's influence remains, causing all intruders within Thousand Voices to take a –1 status penalty on all Will saving throws (this penalty is increased to –2 against emotion effects). This is an effect with the emotion, mental, and primal traits, and it ends as soon as Nyrissa is defeated at the end of Chapter 10.

THOUSAND VOICES (TV) ZONE 18

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 16 table (page 110)	Varies
6–8	1 sard[B2]	Low 18
9–11	1 bandersnatch (page 610)	Low 18
12–13	6 elite ankous[B2]	Moderate 18
14–15	3 whimwyrms (page 615)	Moderate 18
16–17	Wild hunt (detailed below)	Moderate 18
18–19	Lantern King's emissary (detailed below)	Moderate 18
20	1 mu spore[B1]	Severe 18

Ankous See the Ankou entry in Zone 11 on page 103.

Lantern King's Emissary An encounter with an emissary from the First World is with a vilderavn herald (page 614) mounted on a zomok (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 303). This vilderavn serves the Lantern King, who sent them to Thousand Voices to observe Nyrissa's growing influence. They land before the PCs and, pretending to serve Nyrissa, imperiously demand to know why the PCs have intruded upon Thousand Voices. Of course, they know well who the PCs are by reputation, unless they've taken pains to disguise themselves–the vilderavn wants the PCs to succeed at building their kingdom so Nyrissa can absorb it and thus complete her apology to their master, the Lantern King; the vilderavn, of course, reveals none of this to the party. Instead, they encourage the PCs to "return to their realm and see to its needs; this woodland is not yours for the taking." The vilderavn attacks if attacked first, or if the PCs refuse to turn back and leave the forest behind. If combat breaks out, the vilderavn and their zomok mount work to drive the PCs out or incapacitate them rather than kill them; they want the PCs to survive and finish building their kingdom, after all! Only one of these emissaries patrols the forest; if they are slain, this encounter won't occur again. Likewise, once Chapter 10 begins and Nyrissa has started the process of absorbing the PCs' kingdom, the emissary's role here is no longer needed–in this case, this encounter is with the wild hunt instead.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Wild Hunt An encounter with the wild hunt in Thousand Voices is with a pair of wild hunt archers (page 618) accompanied by four wild hunt hounds (page 616). These agents of the First World are merely scouting the lay of the land. They initially attack the PCs simply for the thrill of the hunt. If at least half are slain, the remainder break off the attack and call for a truce, truce, as detailed in the Wild Hunt entry for Zone 14 on page 108.

TV1. CASTLE OF KNIVES

RESOURCE SECRET

One of the strangest ruins in Thousand Voices looms amid the underbrush and twisted trees here: the Castle of Knives. All that remains of the ruin are blade-like shards of stone. Seemingly once the supporting elements of the structure's walls and towers, these knife-shaped monoliths now give the ruin the appearance of a fortress that an ancient giant tried to build by burying immense stone knives in the ground, blades pointed to the sky.

In truth, this strange structure is an anchor point for Nyrissa's realm of Thousandbreaths—whenever she targets a world to absorb a kingdom, the Castle of Knives manifests somewhere in the region. She typically chooses a remote location to place this anchor to prevent idle visitations. Despite its appearance as an ancient, aged ruin, the Castle of Knives is less than a decade old in this world at the time Kingmaker begins, for Nyrissa's interest in the Stolen Lands is relatively recent. None who have stumbled upon the ruins suspect this, instead assuming that the ruins simply went overlooked due to their remote location.

When Nyrissa or her agents need to travel to the Stolen Lands, she can open a portal at this location to allow passage between Thousandbreaths and Golarion. It's via this route that the black dragon Ilthuliak sometimes travels (as detailed in zone 19), and when Chapter 10 begins, this portal serves as the anchor for the dangerous blooms Nyrissa triggers throughout the Stolen Lands.

If the PCs visit this site before beginning Chapter 10, they find merely a strange, eerie ruin. Succeeding at a DC 38 Architecture Lore or First World Lore check to Recall Knowledge allows them to confirm that the structure is much more recent than it appears, and a critical success suggests that the structure is a projection of a larger region in the First World. Full rules for how the PCs can use the Castle of Knives to travel to Thousandbreaths appear on page 443 of Chapter 10.

Resource: While the Castle of Knives is technically a ruin, its nature prevents it from being salvaged to help build a structure or to serve as a Refuge if the PCs Claim this hex. In fact, if this hex is Claimed before Chapter 10 concludes, Nyrissa's influence causes the hex to become lost at the start of any Kingdom turn—structures built here, settlers who attempt to put down roots here, and any other improvements made to the region simply vanish. At your discretion, these missing resources and people can be encountered later in Chapter 10 as the PCs explore Thousandbreaths, but this method of entering Nyrissa's realm should not serve as a shortcut for the PCs, since Nyrissa has control over what she plucks out of this hex for her own amusement. After Chapter 10 ends, this hex functions as a normal hex and can be Claimed normally, but does not offer any other advantages.

TV2. THE WEEPING GROVE SEVERE 18

STANDARD

Creature: Although very few of them remain today in Thousand Voices, the legendary Trees that Weep are frequently mentioned as part of the whispered rumors

TREE THAT WEEPS

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

concerning this dense woodland. Said to possess twisted human faces and a proclivity to weep tears of pure fear, these ancient, towering scythe trees have grown tall and powerful on energy leached from the First World. Rumors hold that the Trees that Weep can be found throughout Thousand Voices; in truth, only three of these trees grow here, found in a relatively lightly forested grove near the center of this hex.

The Trees that Weep tower above the surrounding underbrush and shrubberies in the grove at heights of just over 50 feet. Whenever thrill seekers or adventurers bother the trees too often, the plants simply uproot and wander into a new part of the forest, and over the span of a month, their influence causes the surrounding vegetation to atrophy, creating a new Weeping Grove. It's been many years since any have visited them, and the Trees that Weep are eager to feed on humanoid flesh once more. They pose as dead trees as long as possible so that they can attempt a Woodland Ambush; they roll Stealth for initiative. When the Trees that Weep attack, their mouths emit a mournful cry and tears of toxic sap run from eye-like knots in their bark and across their scythe-like branches, creating a supernatural aura of despair around them—those who would be their prey are able to envision only a future of slow digestion within a tree's gullet.

TREE THAT WEEPS (3) CREATURE 18

RARE CE GARGANTUAN PLANT

Variant scythe tree (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 235)

Perception +30; lifesense 30 feet, low-light vision

Languages Aklo, Arboreal, Sylvan

Skills Athletics +35, Stealth +31 (+33 in forests)

Str +9, **Dex** +5, **Con** +6, **Int** +0, **Wis** +6, **Cha** +0

Weeping Aura (aura, emotion, incapacitation, mental, primal) 30 feet; **Requirements** The Tree that Weeps isn't using Dead Tree; **Effect** A creature that begins its turn in the aura is potentially overwhelmed with despair and must attempt a DC 40 Will save.

Critical Success The creature is unaffected and is temporarily immune for 1 hour.

Success The creature is sickened 1.

Failure The creature is paralyzed for 1 round by despair, and then sickened 2 after recovering from paralysis.

Critical Failure As failure, but the paralysis doesn't end automatically. A character can attempt a new Will save to end the paralysis at the end of their turn; the DC is reduced by 1 each turn that passes.

AC 41; **Fort** +17, **Ref** +8, **Will** +9

HP 400; **Immunities** poison; **Resistances** bludgeoning 20, piercing 20

Axe Vulnerability A Tree that Weeps takes 20 additional damage from axes.

Ripping Disarm ↷ **Trigger** A creature rolls a critical failure on a melee weapon Strike against the Tree that Weeps; **Effect** The Tree that Weeps attempts to Disarm the creature of the weapon used to attempt the Strike.

Speed 15 feet

Melee ❖ scythe branch +35 (backswing, deadly d10, reach 15 feet), **Damage** 3d8+17 slashing plus 2d8 poison

Dead Tree ❖ (concentrate) Until the Tree that Weeps acts, it appears to be a dead tree. It automatically takes 43 as the result of its Deception checks and has a Deception DC of 43 to pass as a dead tree.

Woodland Ambush ❖ **Requirements** The Tree that Weeps is using Dead Tree in forested terrain, and a creature that hasn't detected it is within 30 feet; **Effect** The Tree that Weeps Strides with a +10-foot circumstance bonus to its Speed in the direction of the triggering creature. Once the creature is in reach, the Tree that Weeps makes a scythe branch Strike against it. The creature is flat-footed against this Strike.

Treasure: The Trees that Weep haven't seen adventurers in their grove for many years, but the remains of one unfortunate adventurer who stumbled upon the grove months after the trees first arrived still lie amid the tangled undergrowth. This human's skeleton lies at the center of the grove, still wearing a *+3 greater resilient breastplate* and clutching a *+3 greater striking bastard sword* in one bony hand.

ZONE 19: BRANTHLEND MOUNTAINS

The Branthlend Mountains are the least hospitable region in the Stolen Lands. This zone counts as greater difficult terrain.

BRANTHLEND MOUNTAINS (BR) ZONE 19

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 18 table (page 115)	varies
6–8	2 skulltakers (*Bestiary* 300)	Low 19
9–11	Wild hunt (detailed below)	Low 19
12–13	2 bandersnatches (page 610)	Moderate 19
14–15	1 tor linnorm (*Bestiary* 227)	Moderate 19
16–17	Ilthuliak (page 454)	Moderate 19
18–19	4 whimwyrms (page 615)	Moderate 19
20	1 elite lerritan (*Bestiary 2* 6, 159)	Severe 19

Ilthuliak These days, the legendary dragon Ilthuliak spends most of her time in her lair in the First World (as detailed on page 454 in Chapter 10), but now and then she emerges to spend a few hours flying through the skies above her old haunts. This encounter should be just a distant glimpse of the dragon flying above unless the PCs have already faced her once in her den in Chapter 10, in which case she's specifically hunting them for revenge.

Wild Hunt An encounter with the wild hunt in the Branthlend Mountains is with a pair of wild hunt scouts (page 619). These agents of the First World are merely scouting the lay of the land. They initially attack the PCs

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

simply for the thrill of the hunt. If either is reduced to fewer than 60 Hit Points, they flee or call for a truce, as detailed in the wild hunt entry for Zone 14 on page 108.

BR1. MOUNT BRANTHLEND

LANDMARK

This mountain, which at 5,400 feet tall is the highest peak in all the Stolen Lands, is a knob-like pinnacle of stark white stone. Many of the surrounding clans of nomadic warriors tell tales of this mountain's history, claiming the peak was scoured of life and vegetation when a scorned warlord's queen transformed into a powerful Numerian spine dragon atop its crown.

BR2. ILTHULIAK'S LAIR

LANDMARK

Here, where the placid Whisper River plummets over a 900-foot-high cliffside into a 150-foot-deep tarn, the terrain grows more tangled and swampy than anywhere else in the woodlands' reach to the south and west. The transition from deep, algae-choked tarn to solid land is gradual, resulting in a 2-mile-wide swath of dense swamp. Many of the surrounding rocks and trees appear half-melted or burnt, and bones of countless creatures large and small litter the swampland. Yet most impressive of all these features is the glittering skull of a dragon that has been impaled atop the jagged trunk of a dead oak.

A PC who succeeds on a DC 30 Arcana check to Recall Knowledge can recognize the telltale marks surrounding a black dragon's lair. On a critical success, the signs can be correctly interpreted as indicating a black dragon great wyrm. A PC who succeeds at a DC 26 Dragon Lore or Society check to Recall Knowledge recalls tales of the black dragon Ilthuliak, who reputedly dwells deep in these woods. A PC who succeeds at a DC 32 Arcana check or a DC 28 Dragon Lore check to Recall Knowledge identifies the dragon skull in the tree as that of an adult silver dragon.

While this region did serve Ilthuliak as a lair for many centuries, her recent alliance with Nyrissa gave her the opportunity to relocate her lair to the First World realm of Thousandbreaths. She (and her treasure) can be found therein, as detailed on page 454 of Chapter 10. Apart from the skull of the silver dragon Amvarean (which Nyrissa ordered Ilthuliak to leave behind), no trace of the dragon's treasure remains, although a search of the tarn's bed reveals an underwater nest sized for an immense black dragon.

BR3. HUNGERDARK SEVERE 19

RESOURCE STANDARD

At the edge of the tangled reach of Thousand Voices, a dark cleft cuts up the face of the mountains, almost as if a titanic axe struck the 500-foot-tall cliff here. The cleft leads 1,500 feet into the mountains, into a deep cavern known locally as Hungerdark. A brackish pool of water collects in the deepest recesses of this cavern, but few animals approach within a mile of this location, for Hungerdark is far from abandoned. It's the domain of a legendary monster.

Creature: An immense wyvern, a matriarch of her kind, has laired in Hungerdark for nearly 2 centuries. Known by the regional barbarians as Minognos-Ushad ("Eater of Kings"), the wyvern has survived countless attempts on her life and has more than earned her name from the countless warlords she's consumed. Although quite old, Minognos-Ushad is still very dangerous. She spends an increasing amount of time slumbering in her den, emerging once a month or so to seek out prey in the Glenebon Uplands or Numeria. Unless the PCs have already defeated her, she is present when they arrive, but unfortunately for them, she is an extremely light sleeper (taking no penalty on Perception checks while she sleeps) and is quick to attack any intruders she notices. Furthermore, she shares her lair with four whimwyrms who have long admired her power and magnificence. Minognos-Ushad initiates combat with her breath weapon, then focuses on the strongest-looking foe in the following rounds. Her whimwyrm allies leave her targets alone, instead focusing their attacks on other foes. Confronted here in Hungerdark, she fights to the death.

If the PCs defeated Minognos-Ushad already, they must still contend with the whimwyrms she shared her lair with!

MINOGNOS-USHAD CREATURE 19

UNIQUE NE HUGE DRAGON

Variant wyvern (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 133)

Perception +30; darkvision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet

Languages Common, Draconic

Skills Acrobatics +33, Athletics +37, Intimidation +31, Stealth +33

Str +10, **Dex** +6, **Con** +6, **Int** +0, **Wis** +6, **Cha** +4

AC 43; **Fort** +33, **Ref** +35, **Will** +31

HP 295; **Immunities** paralyzed, unconscious; **Resistances** poison 20

Attack of Opportunity ↷

Savage ↷ **Trigger** A creature grabbed by Minognos-Ushad critically fails a check to Escape; **Effect** Minognos-Ushad makes a stinger Strike against the triggering creature.

Speed 30 feet, fly 100 feet

Melee ❖ fangs +37 (reach 10 feet), **Damage** 4d10+18 piercing

Melee ❖ claw +37 (reach 10 feet), **Damage** 4d8+18 slashing plus Improved Grab

Melee ❖ stinger +37 (agile, reach 20 feet), **Damage** 4d6+18 piercing plus wyvern venom

Breath Weapon ❖❖ (evocation, poison, primal)

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Minognos-Ushad breathes a 60-foot cone of poison. Creatures in the cone take 20d6 poison damage (DC 41 basic Reflex save). Minognos-Ushad can't use Breath Weapon again for 1d4 rounds.

Powerful Dive ❖❖ (move) Minognos-Ushad Flies up to her fly Speed and must both move forward at least 20 feet and descend at least 10 feet. If she ends her movement within melee reach of at least one enemy her size or smaller, she can make a claw Strike against that enemy. If the claw hits, as a free action she can either automatically Grab the target or knock it prone.

Punishing Momentum ❖ **Requirements** Minognos-Ushad grabbed a creature this turn using Powerful Dive; **Effect** Minognos-Ushad can Fly at half Speed while holding the creature in her claws, carrying that creature along with her and dropping it at the end of her movement. Alternatively, she can Strike the creature with her stinger with a +2 circumstance bonus.

Wyvern Venom (poison); **Saving Throw** Fortitude DC 41; **Maximum Duration** 6 rounds; **Stage 1** 5d10 poison damage and clumsy 1 (1 round); **Stage 2** 6d10 poison damage and clumsy 2 (1 round); **Stage 3** 8d10 poison damage and clumsy 3 (1 round)

WHIMWYRMS (4) CREATURE 17

See page 615

Initiative Perception +31

Treasure: Over the years, a significant amount of treasure has accumulated in the depths of Minognos-Ushad's lair, despite her relative disinterest in hoarding. Most of the gear worn by the hapless explorers, barbarians, bandits, and adventurers she's slaughtered over the years has long ago rusted away or completely crumbled to ruin, but a few hours' work sifting through the grisly remains reveals an impressive collection, including 28,110 cp, 13,905 sp, 7,452 gp, 333 pp, a well-preserved darkwood casket embossed with the Thuvian flag containing three vials (one containing a true elixir of life, one containing an elixir of rejuvenation, and one empty vial with markings on the side that success at a DC 20 Crafting check reveals to a PC that it once contained a dose of the rare and wondrous Sun Orchid Elixir), a number of rings, necklaces, and bracelets worth a total of 3,000 gp, three different crowns belonging to three different long dead monarchs (each crown is worth 500 gp, and at your option returning them to their source nation could set up an entire new adventure of your own design), a set of *anklets of alacrity* mixed in with the nonmagical jewelry, a *greater flame tongue*, a *scroll of meteor swarm*, and a *ghost dust talisman*.

Resource: Hungerdark functions as a Refuge if this hex is Claimed.



MINOGNOS-USHAD

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



PART 3:

THE OLD SYCAMORE

Looming over the hills in the southern Greenbelt (area **GB14**), a graying hulk of a sycamore tree clings precariously to its last years of life. The 100-foot-tall tree stands as a known landmark and is visible for miles around. It's also infested with mitflits. These malicious gremlins spend their days perfecting sadistic pranks, torturing animals, playing with oversized vermin, and tormenting the Sootscale kobolds who dwell in a cave 12 miles to the south.

Recently, the mitflits stole the Sootscales' most holy statue and are holding it hostage for the third time in as many months. Though the mitflits thoroughly enjoy this little game, the kobolds have new leadership, and with Tartuccio now making the decisions for the Sootscales, their retaliation was swift and, to the gremlins, unexpectedly insulting. That the kobolds dared to try to reclaim the treasure the mitflits themselves had just stolen—and before the gremlins even got the chance to gloat—has truly outraged the little blue creatures. For many days now, the lands between the Old Sycamore and the Sootscale caves have become the site of a sort of miniaturized war, and as the PCs approach the Old Sycamore, they'll find it increasingly common to stumble across dead kobolds and mitflits, their pitiful gear stripped by the victors.

THE MITFLIT LAIR

The mitflit lair itself has only a single entrance, hidden amid the ancient sycamore's roots. A PC who succeeds at a DC 15 Perception check finds this hidden entrance, which

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

consists of a root-lined shaft that drops 10 feet down to the middle of a 40-foot tunnel; this tunnel runs east-west and connects areas **A1** and **A2**. These roots allow a person to Climb down into either area by succeeding at a DC 15 Athletics check. If the PCs observe the sycamore from afar, every night they spot five or six mitflits from area **A6** scampering out of the hole to scatter into the surrounding hills, off to gather food, catch animals to torment, or look for Sootscales to fight. The mitflits are Small, and their lair is accordingly sized. Ceiling height is rarely over 5 feet, and much of the uppermost foot is a tangle of roots and dangling fungus, forcing Medium creatures to stoop and awkwardly adjust the swing of their weapons—as a result, these creatures take a –1 circumstance penalty on attack rolls and are clumsy 1 within the lair.

The mitflit hive beneath the Old Sycamore once housed several dozen of the gremlins, but the war with the Sootscales has thinned their ranks. Currently, the hive numbers 31 mitflits, although when the PCs arrive, only 19 (plus their leader) lurk within. If the PCs fail to drive the mitflits out by killing them all, the remaining mitflits return to the hive at the end of the day, replenishing their population at the rate of 6 mitflits per hour over the two hours following dusk. At the end of the last hour, a final mitflit straggler pops his little blue head in, for better or worse.

A1. PRANK WORKSHOP LOW 2

Three tiny crude wooden workbenches occupy the center of this room, their tops strewn with various little tools, metal and wooden hardware, and blocks of wood.

The mitflits use this odd workshop to design prank devices, but with their new war against the Sootscales, they've taken to making pranks of a more lethal nature. To date, only seven mitflits have been killed making these risky modifications. The slope down to the southwest quickly becomes a 30-foot-deep shaft that drops into area **A3**. The shaft walls are thick with hanging roots, so creatures can Climb this shaft with a successful DC 5 Athletics check. The slope to the northeast leads to the junction between the exit shaft and the 20-foot-long tunnel leading to area **A2**.

Creatures: A pair of the nest's most talented tinker mitflits, Dingetooth and Uurch, are engaged in a competition using a new device they've built. The two take turns firing marbles at one another's open mouth with a miniature catapult rigged out of bones and branches. The goal is to see who can get the most marbles into the other's mouth before they run out of marbles; since each mitflit usually swallows the marble when a hit is scored, they're running out relatively quickly.

As soon as they spot intruders, Dingetooth shrieks and charges into melee while Uurch uses the marble launcher to hurl all of her marbles at once at the PCs. If one mitflit is slain, the other panics and flees down to area **A3** to warn the others.

DINGETOOTH AND UURCH CREATURE 1

UNIQUE LE SMALL FEY GREMLIN

Male and female mitflit gremlins (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 192)
Perception +5; darkvision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet
Languages Undercommon
Skills Acrobatics +6, Diplomacy +2 (+8 vs. arthropods), Nature +6, Stealth +6, Thievery +6
Str +0, **Dex** +3, **Con** +0, **Int** +1, **Wis** +2, **Cha** –1
Items marbles (6), shortsword
Self-Loathing (emotion, mental) As mitflit.
Vermin Empathy As mitflit.

AC 16; **Fort** +3, **Ref** +8, **Will** +5
HP 25; **Weaknesses** cold iron 2

Speed 20 feet; climb 20 feet
Melee ❖ shortsword +9 (agile, finesse, versatile S), **Damage** 1d6 piercing
Primal Innate Spells DC 17; **2nd** *speak with animals* (at will, arthropods only); **1st** *bane*; **Cantrips (1st)** *prestidigitation*
Launch Marbles ❖❖ The mitflit uses the marble launcher to fire six marbles at a creature in area **A1**. The target must attempt a DC 16 Reflex save.
Success The creature is unaffected.
Failure The creature is distracted by the marbles and is clumsy 2 until the end of its next turn.
Critical Failure As failure, but one of the marbles hits the creature somewhere sensitive, causing 1d6 nonlethal bludgeoning damage.
Vengeful Anger (emotion, mental) As mitflit.

A2. HATCHERY LOW 2

The wet-looking floor of this large cavern is crisscrossed by several shallow trenches, each containing trickles of putrid fluid. Six foul mounds of compost and dung lie heaped about the room, each studded with small spherical eggs.

This area serves as a centipede hatchery. The mitflits love their many-legged pets, which they hand-feed and shower with horridly maudlin displays of affection. The fluid is runoff of foul-tasting but nutrient-rich water that seeps in from above. To the west, the cave leads down to a tunnel that slopes up toward the junction between the exit shaft and the 20-foot-long tunnel that leads to area **A1**, while to the east, the tunnel slopes in a corkscrew pattern, descending 20 feet to area **A6**.

Creatures: Currently, only a single mitflit watches the hatchery. Quoggy is the hive's most accomplished and respected vermin breeder, and if caught unawares,

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

she sits upon a small stool in front of a large wooden bowl filled with a foul-smelling paste made of ground-up kobold bones, kobold blood, and crushed mice. Three giant centipedes happily feed on this mess. The centipedes hiss when they see intruders; Quoggy orders them to attack before she scurries out of the room to the east to seek help from the other mitflits.

GIANT CENTIPEDES (3) CREATURE -1

Giant centipede (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 61)
Initiative Perception +6

QUOGGY CREATURE -1

Female mitflit (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 192)
Initiative Perception +4

A3. CHAMBER OF TORMENT MODERATE 2

Anyone approaching this room automatically hears cries of terror from the room's unfortunate prisoner.

Thick tangles of long, pallid roots obscure the walls of this egg-shaped cavern. To the east, the chamber opens into a wide, root-filled chasm.

Creatures: A group of six mitflits joyously torment a captured Sootscale kobold—one of four black-scaled kobolds who have been tied into the roots along the walls. The other three already hang limply by their bonds, dead from the mitflits' torment. The last kobold shrieks in pain as the six mitflits take turns poking it with sharp sticks—each shriek eliciting a fresh wave of giggles and cheers from the mitflits. If the PCs interrupt their sport, the mitflits drop their sticks and draw their swords in rage. They fight until the party slays at least three mitflits, at which point the survivors flee through area **A4** and gather in area **A5** to regroup.

The kobold prisoner is a warrior named Mikmek, the last Sootscale survivor of a recent gremlin ambush. If rescued, Mikmek swallows his pride, falls to his knees, and thanks his saviors in chirping Draconic. He promises his saviors "many treasures" if the PCs help him finish his quest to rescue the Sootscales' holy statue from these nasty blue mitflits. If they agree, he is prepared to serve as a loyal adventuring companion, at least until they reach the chieftain of the Sootscales. If armed with a weapon he can use, he squeals in delight.

MIKMEK CREATURE -1

Male Sootscale kobold warrior (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 212)
Initiative Perception +3

MITFLITS (6) CREATURE -1

Pathfinder Bestiary 192
Initiative Perception +4

THE SACRED STATUE

30 XP

The stolen sacred Sootscale statue must be returned.

Source: Mikmek the kobold (area **A3**)

Completion: The PCs must deliver the statue to either Tartuk (that is, Tartuccio) in area **B5** or to Chief Sootscale in area **B4** (which can aid him in freeing his tribe from Tartuccio's influence).

Reward: Delivering the statue to Tartuk wins the PCs safe passage out of the kobold lair, as well as a shiny topaz worth 30 gp—and (if the characters ask for it) Svetlana's wedding ring. Delivering the statue to Chief Sootscale helps him win back control of the Sootscales—more details can be found on page 128.

A4. CENTIPEDE CHASM LOW 2

A deep chasm splits the passage. The chasm is a few yards wide and twice as deep, but tangled roots fill the entire area. The passage continues on the far side, and between the two ledges, loops have been tied to serve as handholds.



GIANT WHIPTAIL CENTIPEDE

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

The chasm is only 20 feet deep, and the rough walls above it make for a relatively easy DC 5 Athletics check to Climb across, thanks to the numerous roots hanging from the walls. The chasm walls are a bit more difficult, though, requiring a DC 15 Climb check.

Creature: While the chasm appears empty, it serves as the dwelling place of the pride and joy of the mitflits: an immense, 25-foot-long giant whiptail centipede, which lies coiled at the far north end of the chasm. Whenever anything other than a mitflit attempts to cross the chasm, the centipede attempts a Perception check to notice it. If it spots non-mitflits, it hisses and clambers up the wall to attack, using its Undulate ability to swiftly navigate the cave's narrow confines as needed.

GIANT WHIPTAIL CENTIPEDE — CREATURE 3

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 50

Initiative Perception +9

Hazard: The mitflits cleverly tied several of the loops hanging from the walls to tear loose as soon as anyone puts pressure on them. The gremlins, of course, already know which knots are rigged and clamber across without touching them.

RIGGED CLIMBING LOOPS — HAZARD 0

MECHANICAL | TRAP

Stealth DC 20

Description Loose handholds rip away from the walls to drop unsuspecting climbers into the chasm below.

Disable DC 16 Crafting (trained) or Thievery to anchor the climbing loops more securely

Tear Free ↷ Trigger A creature climbs across the chasm without knowing which of the loops are rigged; **Effect** The loops rip free, dropping the climber 20 feet into the chasm below and dealing 10 points of bludgeoning damage. The falling creature can use the Grab an Edge reaction to avoid falling if it succeeds at a DC 11 flat check; failure indicates that the edge grabbed rips away as well.

A5. WAR ROOM — SEVERE 2

In the center of this room stands a rickety table held together with twine, covered with a filthy checkered tablecloth and heaped with mounds of dirt, twigs, and gravel, apparently arranged to form some sort of map. At the edge of the map, weighing down a scrap of paper, rests a bloodstained ivory statuette of what looks like a crouching reptilian devil. A bulging burlap sack sits under the table.



GRABBLES AND TICKLEBACK

This room serves both as a war room and the den of the mitflits' leader, Grabbles. He's created a relatively accurate map of the region around the Old Sycamore and the Sootscale caves—the sycamore is represented by a tangle of branches and the cave by a pile of bloodstained rocks. A PC succeeding at a DC 15 Survival or Scouting Lore check recognizes the map for what it represents, which allows them to automatically discover the entrance to the Sootscale caves if the PCs have not already found it.

Creatures: Grabbles stands near the table, squabbling over his next plan of attack against the kobolds with four mitflit advisers. Looming nearby is Tickleback, Grabbles' pet and mount, a stocky tunnel tick the size of a bugbear (although this giant tick is Medium, its stats are the same as the typical Small giant tick). Grabbles has an unusually large gap between his teeth, causing him to make whistling sounds when he talks. A particularly unsightly scattering of pimples decorates his face and tongue.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

As soon as he spots intruders, Grabbles clambers onto Tickleback and rides him into battle to fight to the death. The other mitflits attack as Grabbles commands, doing their best to follow his sometimes contradictory or slipshod orders, although they only fight to the death as long as Grabbles still lives—if their leader falls, the remaining mitflits flee.

GRABBLES CREATURE 2

UNIQUE LE SMALL FEY GREMLIN

Male mitflit gremlin (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 192)
Perception +7; darkvision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet
Languages Common, Undercommon
Skills Acrobatics +8, Diplomacy +7 (+9 vs. arthropods), Nature +4, Stealth +8, Thievery +8
Str +1, **Dex** +4, **Con** +3, **Int** +0, **Wis** +1, **Cha** +3
Items leather armor, trident
Self-Loathing (emotion, mental) As mitflit
Vermin Empathy As mitflit.

AC 18; **Fort** +7, **Ref** +10, **Will** +5
HP 35; **Weaknesses** cold iron 2

Speed 20 feet; climb 20 feet
Melee ❖ trident +7 (thrown 20 feet), **Damage** 1d8+3 piercing
Ranged ❖ trident +10 (thrown 20 feet), **Damage** 1d8+3 piercing
Primal Innate Spells DC 17; **2nd** *speak with animals* (at will, arthropods only); **1st** *bane*; **Cantrips (1st)** *prestidigitation*
Ride Tick (auditory, concentrate) Grabbles can use Diplomacy to Command an Animal when riding Tickleback.
Vengeful Anger (emotion, mental) As mitflit.

MITFLITS (4) CREATURE -1

Pathfinder Bestiary 192
Initiative Perception +4

TICKLEBACK CREATURE 1

Giant tick (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 260)
Initiative Perception +6

Treasure: The ivory statuette depicts a crouching horned devil. This statue was stolen from the Sootscale kobolds, for whom the statue is a sacred relic and—before Tartuccio took over as Tartuk—was the focal point of their worship; they revered the statue as a mighty, winged kobold named Old Sharptooth. The statue is nonmagical, but worth 25 gp.

The paper weighed down by the statuette is an accounting of the status of the war, as defined by key pieces of stolen treasure. Written in charcoal in Undercommon, the paper consists of two columns, one labeled "Us" and one labeled "Them." The "Us" column lists only two things: "kobold statue" and "lots of spears and coins." The "Them" column lists "magic dust," "lots of coins," and "shiny human ring." The burlap sack contains the mitflits' treasure, much of which they looted from slain kobolds. It holds 12 spearheads, 193 cp, 120 sp, and 8 gp.

A6. COMMON ROOM MODERATE 2

Haphazard piles of broken beds, chairs, wagon wheels, and an assortment of worn, tattered, and dingy objects, pilfered or salvaged from big folk, precariously clutter this mildewed room. A crookedly propped row of bookcases buckles against the far wall, the shelves filled with bits of bone, feathers, and dried centipede legs. Old window frames, cracked and splintered, dangle from the wall like works of fine art.

Here the mitflits eat, sleep, and engage in various types of anti-social behavior. A passage to the northern end of this chamber leads upward to area **A2**.

Creatures: Six mitflits occupy this room. Two make a wretched attempt to perform a folk song on shabby stringed instruments; two more sit nearby, jeering and throwing rocks at the musicians. A third pair of mitflits huddles beneath a ragged sheet, reading a book with torn pages. The book is upside down. Upon sighting interlopers, all six rise up in anger and attack, but as soon as one mitflit falls in combat, the remaining mitflits shriek in fear and flee to area **A5**.

MITFLITS (6) CREATURE -1

Pathfinder Bestiary 192
Initiative Perception +4

THE PERILS OF BEFRIENDING GREMLINS

Unlike their mortal enemies, the Sootscales, the mitflits of the Old Sycamore aren't particularly well-suited for integration into the PCs' kingdom—yet they still remain sapient creatures. Unlike kobolds, though, mitflits are not humanoids—these creatures are fey, and as a result, their nature as gremlins is as much the result of supernatural factors as it is their society.

If the PCs manage to establish a peaceful accord with the mitflits, they'll need to work hard to watch over them and to help them avoid their impulses to wreck things and undo hard work. They are, after all, still gremlins, and the urge to meddle is difficult for mitflits to unlearn. Exactly how difficult befriending the mitflits can be is left to you to determine, but if the PCs do manage the accomplishment, consider giving them some sort of benefit as well. After all, the mitflits are fey creatures, and even though they're natives of the Material Plane, they may be able to provide some insight into the First World blooms once they begin.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



PART 4:

SOOTSCALE CAVERNS

The Sootscale kobolds traditionally change their name with each new leader, but times are strange for these scrappy creatures. Recently, a purple kobold has become an important leader among the Sootscales. Calling himself Tartuk, this mysterious kobold allowed the previous leader to retain a largely ceremonial role as the leader of the tribe, but Chief Sootscale is no fool. He knows it's only a matter of time before Tartuk has him killed—and that the purple kobold is only waiting for the rest of the tribe to fall completely under his control before he gets rid of the last remnant of the tribe's once-proud tradition as Sootscales.

In truth, Tartuk is much more than an insurgent kobold—he's not even a kobold at all, but the gnome spy Tartuccio, who seized control of the Sootscales after assuming the appearance of a unique kobold with the aid of a magical ritual that allows him to change shape. As Tartuk, Tartuccio works to secure control of the kobolds with the intent of building himself an army that, eventually, he'll use to undermine the PCs' efforts at claiming the Stolen Lands.

THE SOOTSCALE CAVERNS

The Sootscales live in an abandoned silver mine in the side of a hill just north of the Shrike River. They have occupied the mine for decades, periodically clashing with the region's bandits, mitflits, and trappers, but always enduring. The Sootscales all have black scales and share a fondness for swimming in the Shrike River and catching fish with their tiny teeth.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

The individual kobolds still consider Chief Sootscale to be their leader, even though the chief himself is cowed by the eerie magic and creepy coloration presented by Tartuk. The weird purple kobold claims to hail from somewhere to the west (the closest thing to the truth he's told the kobolds), and he's a destructive force who derives a perverse glee from manipulating the tribe.

As the lair itself was originally a human mine, the caves themselves aren't completely awkward for Medium creatures—the kobolds themselves adore their eight-foot-high "vaulted ceilings," and consider them a sign of great kobold prosperity.

B1. MAIN ENTRANCE — TRIVIAL 2

An outcropping of large boulders emerges from the weathered face of a nearby hillock. A narrow opening in the rock leads into darkness below. A fallen sign leans against the side of the cave entrance, and a cage made of branches and sticks sits on the other side.

The fallen sign is weathered and bears a few faded words in Common: "Oaktop Silver Mine." Taldan explorers founded and operated this mine but abandoned it long before they could establish much infrastructure within, as it quickly grew obvious that the location was impractically distant from their other settlements. An alcove to the west contains a locked iron gate—the lone kobold on watch (detailed below) carries the key. Alternately, an individual with thieves' tools can Pick the Lock with a successful DC 15 Thievery check. In the area beyond, three rope nooses hang from holes in the ceiling above rusty iron hooks set in the floor. When pulled down and looped on the hooks below, these ropes seal shut the three pit traps that guard the entrance.

Creatures: The stick cage contains a single, sobbing mitflit—his eyes squinted tightly shut against the light during the day. The wretched creature is the only prisoner the kobolds have managed to take alive, and they've placed him here as a warning to any mitflits who might approach. If released, the thankless gremlin hisses and runs away; if prevented from fleeing, he attacks and fights to the death.

A lone kobold scout named Nakpik stands watch here, crouched behind one of the big rocks at the cave entrance. If he spots the PCs, he chirps loudly in surprise—he was expecting mitflits, not bigger foes. Nakpik hesitates for a few moments, confused since he has no actual orders regarding big folk, then makes an unusual decision driven by an uncharacteristic stroke of logic. He hails the characters and cries out in Common, "Wait! Wait! I wanna talk!"

Unless the PCs attack at once, Nakpik explains that his tribe's special statue was stolen recently by mitflits, and he invites the characters to come with him into the caves to speak to their leader about a reward for retrieving the statue. If the characters attack, Nakpik shrieks in terror and runs into the cave to area **B4** to warn the rest of the Sootscales; otherwise, he proudly escorts the characters into the cave to area **B5** to speak to Tartuk, picking up several curious kobolds along the way who follow in their wake, eager to see what happens. Nakpik takes care to show the characters around the pits to the south as he escorts them.

MITFLIT — CREATURE -1

Pathfinder Bestiary 192
Initiative Perception +4

NAKPIK — CREATURE 1

Male kobold scout (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 213)
Initiative Perception +8

Hazard: Three pit traps ward the entrance tunnel. The kobolds avoid these traps by scuttling along the edges. Since the traps are a bit narrow, any character who attempts to Grab an Edge to avoid falling gains a +2 circumstance bonus to the check.

HIDDEN PITS (3) — HAZARD 0

Pathfinder Core Rulebook 522
Stealth DC 18

B2. ALCOVES — TRIVIAL 2

Even for the Sootscale kobolds, these tight tunnel openings are cramped and difficult to traverse. Small creatures can move through the tunnels in single file but must treat the tunnels as difficult terrain, while Medium creatures must Squeeze to navigate them. Just beyond the tunnel openings, a pair of shadowy alcoves flank the main passageway.

Creatures: Two kobold scouts wait within the alcoves. They position themselves both in front and behind invaders, attacking when they have the greatest advantage and shrieking an alarm unless the heroes are escorted by Mikmek (as detailed on page 123) or Nakpik.

KOBOLD SCOUTS (2) — CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 213
Initiative Stealth +7

B3. TEMPLE

The walls of this cave are smeared with charcoal and blood depictions of a looming, sharp-toothed reptilian devil. Two low stone tables sit in the middle of the room, one of which is also stained with blood.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



This chamber is where the Sootscales gather to worship their patron, Old Sharptooth. The PCs are unlikely to recognize the truth of this patron at this time, as it takes a successful DC 35 Religion check to Recall Knowledge that this depiction of Old Sharptooth shows a horned devil (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 77).

Since he's taken over control of the tribe, Tartuk allows the kobolds to continue worshiping Old Sharptooth here and has used their faith as leverage. Even with the loss of the tribe's sacred statue (which now resides under the Old Sycamore; page 125), Tartuk takes delight in leading the kobolds in sacrifices to their "god," using their religious fear to keep them in line. What Tartuk doesn't realize is that Old Sharptooth is a very real devil who might even pay a belated visit to the Stolen Lands later in the campaign (as detailed in Old Sharptooth Comes Calling on page 131).

B4. COMMON ROOM SEVERE 2

Numerous beds of furs lie scattered throughout the room amid smoldering cook fires, while to the south, a ten-foot-wide alcove contains a large mound of furs framed by dozens of sticks mounted with the ash-smeared skulls of many birds and small animals.

Creatures: The war with the mitflits has reduced the size of the Sootscales by half. In all, they currently number only 20 kobolds. Many of them serve by patrolling the surrounding hills hunting for mitflits, so when the PCs arrive, this room contains only the worried chieftain and six other kobolds.

Chief Sootscale knows that tall folk mean trouble, and when he sees the PCs, he orders an attack. The PCs can prevent the fight if they're escorted by a kobold guide, if they show Sootscale the retrieved statuette of Old Sharptooth, or if they can Demoralize the chief in the first round of combat. In these cases, Chief Sootscale backs down and agrees to talk, his kobold minions ready to resume the fight at his word. The chief begs for mercy if reduced to 6 Hit Points or less, and if he's killed, the remaining kobolds drop their weapons and surrender as well.

If the PCs can speak to the kobolds, there are two possibilities. If they have not already recovered the statue of Old Sharptooth from the mitflit lair, Chief Sootscale realizes that sending the PCs to retrieve the statuette might be his tribe's best hope. He glumly admits that if the statue of Old Sharptooth isn't returned soon, Sharptooth's curse will cause all the kobolds to turn yellow and die.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

If the player characters already have the statue, Chief Sootscale demands they hand it over to him. If they do, he holds the statue in his hands with a fierce look of concentration, as if he were making a particularly difficult decision. After a tense moment, he shrieks in triumph, raises the statue over his head, and then smashes it down onto the ground, shattering it. The other kobolds in the room freeze in absolute shock while the chief, a frantic grin on his snout, thanks the PCs for "freeing us from this curse" and then encourages them to come with him to "kill the usurper."

Although there is, in fact, no real curse, Chief Sootscale believes that by breaking the statue, he has freed himself from its reach. Emboldened and infused with a rush of self-confidence for the first time since Tartuk put the notion of a "curse" into the tribe's minds, the chief leads his kobolds—and the PCs—in a coup against Tartuk in area **B5**.

CHIEF SOOTSCALE CREATURE 2

UNIQUE | LE | SMALL | HUMANOID | KOBOLD

Perception +7, darkvision
Languages Common, Draconic
Skills Acrobatics +8, Craft +4 (+6 traps), Intimidate +8, Stealth +8
Str +2, **Dex** +4, **Con** +1, **Int** +0, **Wis** +2, **Cha** + 4
Items club

AC 18; **Fort** +5, **Ref** +10, **Will** +9
HP 33

Speed 25 feet
Melee ❖ spear +8 (thrown 20 feet), **Damage** 1d6+4 piercing
Ranged ❖ club +10 (thrown 10 feet), **Damage** 1d6+4 bludgeoning
Bark Orders ❖ (auditory) Chief Sootscale pushes other kobolds under his command to fight harder and more bravely. Until the start of his next turn, all kobold allies within 30 feet of him gain a +1 status bonus on attack rolls and saving throws against fear effects.
Sneak Attack Chief Sootscale deals an extra 1d6 precision damage to flat-footed creatures.
Unbalancing Blow Whenever Chief Sootscale critically hits and deals damage to a foe with a Strike, the creature struck is flat-footed against his attacks until the end of his next turn.

KOBOLD WARRIORS (6) CREATURE -1

Pathfinder Bestiary 212
Initiative Perception +3

B5. TARTUK'S QUARTERS SEVERE 2

A rickety wooden frame formed from clean-cut branches lashed together with gut and twine runs the perimeter of this cavern. Upon the frame, banners cut from two-foot-wide strips of old blankets and horsehides hang from floor to ceiling, covering much of the walls. The sloppily painted banners bear dozens of eerie icons and mystic symbols. A great iron cauldron filled with bubbling red liquid boils in the center of the room.

Creature: Once the private cavern of Chief Sootscale, Tartuk took over this chamber and redecorated it to make it look more "mystical." Tartuk is not actually a divine spellcaster, but his skill at Deception combined with the unusual coloration of his scales and his habit of adding unnecessary hand gestures, chants, and



CHIEF SOOTSCALE

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

strange spell components to his spellcasting has been more than enough to trick the rest of the kobolds in the tribe. No Sootscale has even remotely considered the possibility that he's not really a kobold at all.

Tartuk first came to the Sootscales not long after the PCs completed Chapter 1, so the amount of time he has been in charge of the Sootscales depends on how long it took the PCs to get here. Regardless of the time spent, Tartuk has firmly entrenched himself in the role of the Sootscales' spiritual leader, in part by capitalizing on their fear of Old Sharptooth, but also by frightening them with displays of his illusory magic. Early on, kobolds that questioned his right to rule were called out as "bad kobolds" who were sacrificed to prevent the curse of Old Sharptooth from descending upon them all. He's never appeared before the kobolds in his true form or mentioned his real name in front of them, and by now, the Sootscales have entirely accepted him as one of them, despite his strange purple coloration.

Earlier in the month, after the mitflits of the Old Sycamore broke into the Sootscale caverns and stole the statue of Old Sharptooth, Tartuk almost lost control of the tribe, but he has managed to take advantage of the growing war between the two groups, convincing the kobolds to view it as a test from Old Sharptooth. The Sootscales have managed to win back their statue twice before, but each time, the gremlins stole it again before the statuette could be returned to its proper place.

Of course, the whole gremlin conflict has disrupted Tartuk's actual plans for the region, and his patience is wearing thin. If the PCs arrive at the cave, Tartuk is startled but, counting on the fact that they won't recognize him in his disguise, he encourages them to retrieve the statuette of Old Sharptooth for the Sootscales—and to kill all the mitflits in the process. If the PCs return triumphantly, Tartuk decides to accelerate his plan to remove them from the competition for the Stolen Lands and orders the kobolds to slay the PCs as a final glorious offering to Old Sharptooth—a command the kobolds fanatically try to carry out.

On the other hand, if the PCs have already recovered the statuette or have recruited Chief Sootscale's aid, Tartuk is shocked. He tries to reassert his control over the tribe, only to fail, and is forced to fight for his life with only his two most fanatically devoted minions to aid him. If reduced to fewer than 10 Hit Points, Tartuk does what he can to escape—if he manages to do so, he can become a continuing thorn in the PCs' sides as you see fit. If, on the other hand, Tartuk is slain, his body reverts to that of his true form as Tartuccio and any remaining kobolds are so horrified by the development that they flee the region unless the PCs had already formed an alliance with Chief Sootscale, in which case the kobolds are graciously thankful for their aid.

TARTUK (AKA TARTUCCIO) CREATURE 4

Page 605

Initiative Perception +9

FANATICS (2) CREATURE 0

Elite kobold warriors (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 6, 212)

Initiative Perception +5

Treasure: Tartuk demanded the kobolds pile all their treasure (plus any new treasures they gained from their war against the mitflits) in a heap in the eastern alcove of his den. This mound consists of a huge amount of worthless shiny objects, such as quartz and mica crystals, bits of metal, broken weapons and armor, and other garbage. In addition, the pile contains 320 cp, 42 sp, 12 gp, two *sleep arrows*, a *+1 weapon potency runestone*, and a soiled leather bag. Inside the bag are the treasures stolen from the mitflits (who in turn stole them from the Thorn River bandits, who took them from Oleg's Trading Post). The leather bag contains 21 sp, 9 gp, 1 pp, one dose of *dust of appearance*, and a plain brass wedding ring set with a single pearl—this is Svetlana's wedding ring, worth 12 gp as an item of jewelry but far more to Oleg and Svetlana.

Tartuk's personal journal, written in Undercommon, sits on a table here as well. Within its pages, the bitter gnome records much of his history, giving the characters a chance to gain some insight into his mindset and background; he mentions several times that he hopes to achieve success in gaining a hold in the Stolen Land so that he can impress his "patron," but nowhere in the text does he reveal this patron is Pitax. The final dozen pages of the journal contain information on his plans to infiltrate the Sootscales and use them as a force to control the region.

RECRUITING THE SOOTSCALES

If the PCs manage to rescue the Sootscales from Tartuk's influence, the kobolds are confused and frightened for a short time. If Chief Sootscale himself still lives, he'll thank the PCs personally and tell them that the Sootscales owe them; if he perished, a warrior named Gekel steps up to take his name and place. They allow the PCs to take all the treasures Tartuk claimed for himself, but they also promise to pay the PCs back at some point in the future as best they can.

Once the PCs establish their kingdom, the Sootscales' gratitude makes them particularly receptive to the Pledge of Fealty kingdom activity (detailed on page 520), and if the PCs use this activity, the actual result is improved by one degree of success.

If the Sootscales become integrated into the PCs' kingdom, the industrious kobolds' lair functions as a Work Site, granting the PCs' kingdom 2

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Ore commodities each turn. Unfortunately, the kobolds remain what they are—devil-worshipping troublemakers—so their integration into the kingdom is rocky. At the start of every Kingdom turn in which the Sootscales remain a part of the kingdom, the PCs must succeed at a DC 11 flat check; failure indicates their influence increases the kingdom's Corruption or Crime by 1 (players' choice). This continues until the PCs can achieve a critical success with the Send Diplomatic Envoy to the Sootscales to convince them to either minimize their cruelties or even consider worshipping a less evil deity.

OLD SHARPTOOTH

The horned devil the Sootscales worship as "Old Sharptooth" is a real creature, a fiend named Zozraael, and at some point in the campaign, at your discretion, Zozraael may finally learn of the Sootscales' adoration and travel to the Stolen Lands to pay a personal visit in order to investigate rumors of a cult that's been using his name as the focus for their religion. This event occurs only if the Sootscales are part of the PCs' kingdom, and shouldn't occur until the PCs are at least 13th level (when a direct confrontation with Zozraael is a Severe encounter).

See Appendix 3 for full rules on Kingdom events.

OLD SHARPTOOTH COMES CALLING — EVENT +3

CONTINUOUS | DANGEROUS | SETTLEMENT

Location The closest settlement to the Sootscale Cavern.

Event The devil Zozraael comes looking for the Sootscales, finds them allied with the PCs, and works from behind the scenes in a nearby settlement to wreak havoc and bolster the cult he didn't know he had, spreading his influence through the kingdom.

Kingdom Skill Intrigue; **Leader** Warden

Critical Success Kingdom agents manage to isolate the source of the diabolic influence: Zozraael has made a hidden lair within the settlement; the PCs have discovered where this secret den is located, and can finally take direct action to resolve the event (see resolution, below).

Success Zozraael's influence spreads, but the speed of its growth is stemmed by the investigations. Increase Unrest by 1 and one Ruin of the party's choice by 1.

Failure Zozraael's cult gains ground as he begins to destroy the kingdom from within. Increase Unrest by 1d4 and three Ruins of the party's choice by 1.

Critical Failure As failure, but Zozraael also corrupts an NPC leader, convincing them to join his cult and abandon their responsibilities to the kingdom. Treat that leadership role as vacant until this event is resolved or the NPC leader is replaced or redeemed.

Resolution Once the PCs get a critical success (or at your discretion, after the PCs undertake an adventure of your own design to discover Zozraael's lair), they can drive the devil out of their kingdom by attacking and defeating him (in which case you'll need to play the battle out in a location of your choice), or they can attempt a Hire Adventurers activity to do the same. If, by the Event phase of the next Kingdom turn, Zozraael hasn't been defeated, he moves to a new settlement and the event continues.

ZOZRAAEL — CREATURE 16

Male horned devil (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 76)

Initiative Perception +28



paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



PART 5:

THE LONELY BARROW

The isolated barrow mound of a barbarian warrior king stood in this section of the Kamelands for thousands of years. Over time, the earth near the mound subsided, opening a crack in the side of the tomb and disturbing the warlord's undead guardians, who were sworn to defend their lord and his sepulcher, even beyond death. The warlord, now known as the Lonely Warrior, has risen as an undead blasphemy himself. Still bound inside his crypt, he rages against the walls of his prison, dreaming dark dreams of conquest and blood. Yet for all their wrath and hatred, these undead have relatively little impact on the surrounding terrain. This, along with the fact that the tomb is not easily distinguishable from the other hills dotting the landscape, means that the barrow has gone undiscovered for many centuries.

Any attempt to Reconnoiter this hex reveals the entrance to the Lonely Barrow if the PCs succeed at a DC 20 Perception check. If the PCs have the treasure map from the Tomb Treasure quest (page 75), they can find the entrance automatically.

FEATURES OF THE BARROW

The Lonely Barrow is located at area **TW5** in Tuskwater. Its interior is unlit, and its ceilings average 7 feet high in halls, but rise to 9 feet high in chambers. This minor encounter area has no significant plot impact on the rest of Kingmaker, although defeating its undead occupant rewards the PCs with potent treasures, which may prove particularly useful against the trolls that will eventually challenge their rule.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

C1. ENTRYWAY — TRIVIAL 3

The walls of this octagonal chamber are caked with dust. Here and there, faint glimpses of a detailed mosaic can be seen under the grime. A thick carpet of guano covers the floor; it's crawling with insects, and the sharp tang of ammonia hangs in the air. A cobweb-filled tunnel to the east leads deeper underground.

If the PCs take a few hours to clean the walls of this entryway, they'll find them decorated with crude mosaics of simple village life: hunting, fishing, and farming. A PC who then studies the mosaics and succeeds at a DC 25 Society check to Recall Knowledge correctly interprets the village life depicted as that of ancient Kellids, and that the art style and certain fashions depicted exclude Taldan influence, suggesting this barrow's creation predates the Second Army of Exploration, dating it over 4,000 years old.

Creatures: Hundreds of vampire bats make their home in this room, flying through the open doorway each night to feed; they eagerly attack any living intruders in the entryway, but won't pursue them into area **C2**.

VAMPIRE BAT SWARMS (2) — CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 39
Initiative Perception +10

Resource: If the PCs manage to learn the truth about how ancient this barrow is by studying the wall mosaics (either here or elsewhere in the complex), they can use the discoveries as a display in one Museum of their choice constructed anywhere in their kingdom, despite the fact that these items aren't magical items. This display need not consist of the physical carvings on the walls here—detailed copies or painted reproductions will suffice.

C2. CENTRAL CHAMBER — MODERATE 3

Four tunnels exit this circular chamber in the cardinal directions. Between these entrances, each wall section is decorated with a different large, monstrous stone face, leering or grimacing into the room. A skeleton sprawls facedown in the middle of the room.

Success at a DC 20 Nature check to Recall Knowledge lets a PC recognize the stone faces as representations of the four winds, incarnated as malevolent elemental spirits. These faces are a key component of the trap placed within this room to discourage tomb robbers.

Hazard: The architects of this tomb left a dangerous trap to deter any would-be thieves.

BREATH OF DESPAIR — HAZARD 5

COMPLEX | MAGICAL | TRAP

Stealth +13 (trained)
Description The faces carved on the wall appear to inhale, then exhale slithering tendrils of darkness to harm those who would despoil the tomb.
Disable Thievery DC 23 (expert) to disarm the trap's sensors in the chamber floor, or *dispel magic* (3rd level; counteract DC 23) to counteract the faces. Breaking one of the faces on the walls reduces the trap's save DC, attack rolls, and its total actions by 1 per broken face; if all four faces are destroyed, the trap is disabled.
AC 22; **Fort** +15, **Ref** +9
Face Hardness 12; **HP** 30 (BT 15); **Immunities** critical hits, object immunities, precision damage
Draining Inhalation ↻ (divine, necromancy) **Trigger** A non-flying living creature moves more than 10 feet into area **C2**; **Effect** Each face inhales then exhales, and all living creatures in area **C2** feel their strength and vitality being drawn out of them as tendrils of shadow from the faces latch onto their bodies. Each creature must succeed at a DC 22 Fortitude save or become enfeebled 1 (enfeebled 2 on a critical failure).
Routine (4 actions) The trap loses 1 action per disabled face each turn. On each action, a different face spews a writhing breath of darkness from its mouth to a target in area **C2**. A creature can only be targeted once per round by the despairing breath, so if fewer than four creatures are in the room, the trap won't be able to take full advantage of all four of its actions.
Ranged despairing breath +17 (fear, mental), **Damage** 2d8+7 mental damage; no multiple attack penalty. A creature damaged by the despairing breath must succeed at a DC 22 Will save or become frightened 1 (or fleeing 1 on a critical failure); this effect has the fear trait.
Reset The trap resets after 1 minute.

Treasure: The skeleton is all that remains of a previous unlucky tomb robber who found their way into the barrow. While most of the skeleton's equipment has rotted away, a tarnished copper *ventriloquist's ring* still encircles one bony finger.

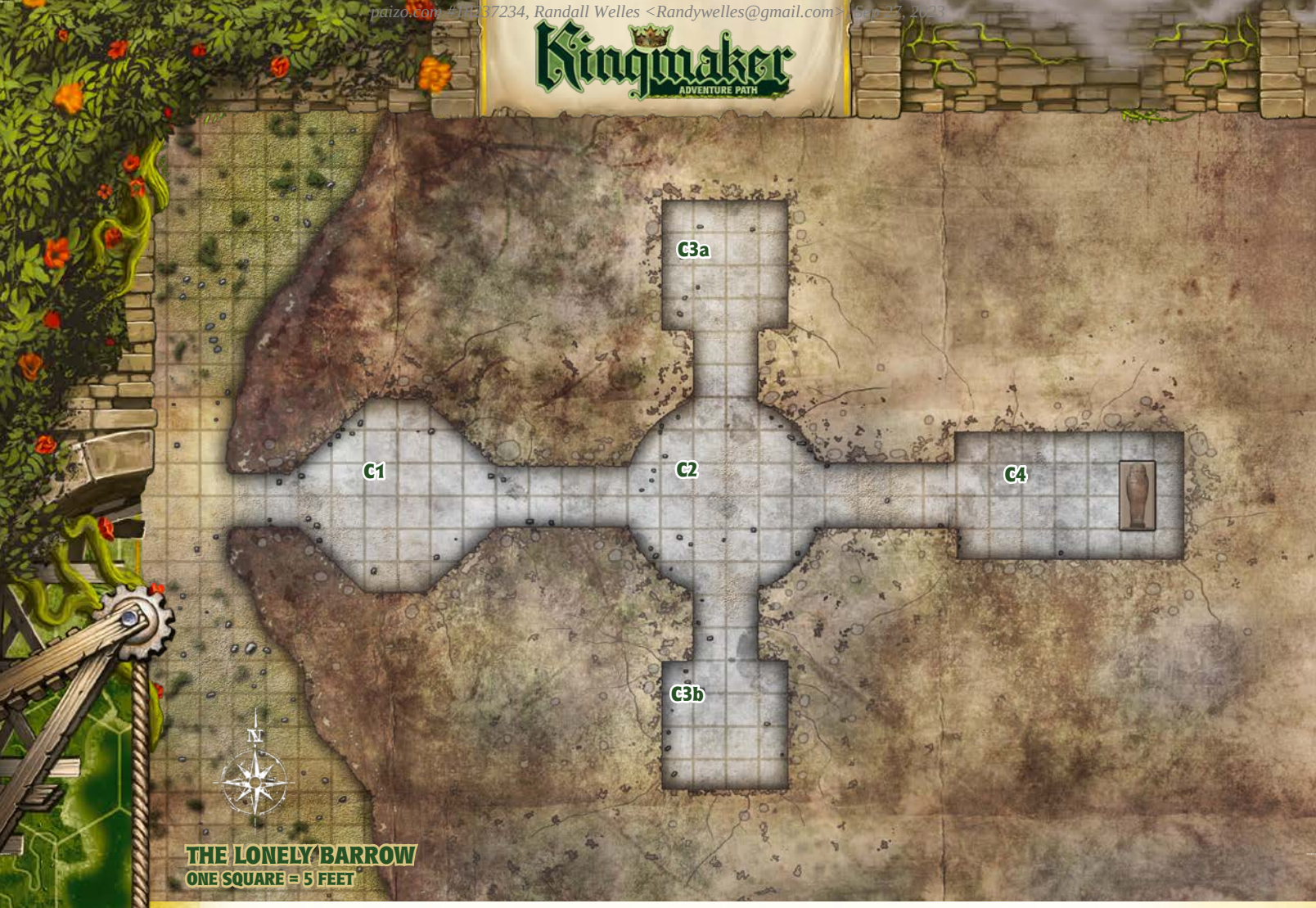
C3. CRYPTS — SEVERE 3

The walls of this dusty chamber are encrusted with grime, but here and there, hints of mosaic scenes can be glimpsed beneath the filth. Four biers line the walls, the resting places of respected warriors.

As in area **C1**, the walls of both of these crypt chambers can be cleaned and then studied to learn about the true age of the barrow. The cleaned mosaics depict scenes of hunting game (in area **C3a** to the

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



THE LONELY BARROW
ONE SQUARE = 5 FEET

north) and warfare against giants (in area **C3b** to the south). Both crypts house the remains of those warriors honored with the privilege and duty of joining their lord in death and defending his barrow.

Creatures: A pair of undead guardians—skeletal champions—stand vigil in each of these chambers. While they don't attack when they hear the sounds of the trap in area **C2**, they do stand ready to react. As soon as either of these rooms is entered, the skeletal champions in that room bang their swords on their shields, taking an action at the start of their turn to do so. This alerts the skeletal champions in the other crypt, who immediately move to join the first pair, potentially escalating a Low encounter into a Severe one. The skeletal champions pursue foes throughout the barrow, but not outside.

SKELETAL CHAMPIONS (2 OR 4) CREATURE 2

Pathfinder Bestiary 298
Initiative Perception +8

C4. THE WARRIOR'S TOMB SEVERE 3

The walls of this chamber are adorned with a plethora of weapons, shields, armor, and tattered banners and standards. Interspersed among the displayed arms are scenes of battle, pillage, and conquest. These carvings are caked in flaking pigments, and many have been defaced, apparently by repeated weapon blows.

The Lonely Barrow is the final resting place of an ancient barbarian warlord, his name long lost to history, who was interred in this crypt. The carvings and decor on the walls in this chamber have weathered the passage of time better than those to the west, and no cleaning is required to study them.

Creature: Although the warlord was laid to rest in an impressive tomb along with his loyal guards, the greedy brother who succeeded him claimed his fallen kin's magic weapon as his own rather than burying the warlord with it. Angered at this blasphemy, the warlord's spirit rose as an undead menace not long after. He sought out the treacherous brother, and although the stolen weapon became broken in the fight that followed, the undead warlord succeeded in killing his brother and returned to this cairn with his reclaimed weapon; he has stood eternal guard over his tomb ever since.

The Lonely Warrior attacks any living creature that enters his tomb and fights until destroyed. He pursues

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

foes throughout the barrow, but leaves it only to pursue anyone who fled the crypt after stealing his sword.

THE LONELY WARRIOR CREATURE 6

UNIQUE | LE | MEDIUM | UNDEAD | WIGHT

Variant cairn wight (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 292)

Perception +14; darkvision

Languages Common, Hallit, Necril

Skills Athletics +15, Intimidation +14, Stealth +13

Str +6, **Dex** +2, **Con** +6, **Int** +2, **Wis** +4, **Cha** +3

Items broken *+1 cold iron flaming bastard sword,* chain mail, wooden shield (Hardness 3, HP 12, BT 6)

AC 23 (25 with shield raised); **Fort** +15, **Ref** +13, **Will** +14

HP 106, negative healing; **Immunities** death effects, disease, paralyze, poison, unconscious

Final Spite ↻ **Trigger** The Lonely Warrior is reduced to 0 Hit Points; **Effect** The Lonely Warrior makes a Strike before being destroyed. It doesn't gain any temporary Hit Points from its drain life on this Strike.

Speed 25 feet

Melee ❖ *bastard sword* +18 (broken), **Damage** 1d8+7 slashing plus drain life

Cairn Wight Spawn (divine, necromancy) A living humanoid slain by the Lonely Warrior's weapon or claw Strike rises as a spawned wight after 1d4 rounds. This spawned wight is under the command of the Lonely Warrior. It doesn't have drain life or cairn wight spawn and is clumsy 2 for as long as it is a spawned wight. If its creator dies, the spawned wight becomes a full-fledged, autonomous cairn wight; it regains its free will, gains drain life and cairn wight spawn, and is no longer clumsy.

Drain Life (divine, necromancy) When the Lonely Warrior damages a living creature with a melee Strike, using an unarmed attack or its bound weapon, it gains 5 temporary Hit Points, and the creature must succeed at a DC 21 Fortitude save or become drained 1. Further damage dealt by it increases the drained condition value by 1 on a failed save, to a maximum of drained 4.

Lonely Dirge ❖❖ (auditory, divine, emotion, fear, mental, necromancy) The Lonely Warrior's funeral dirge is somewhat different from the standard cairn wight dirge: its droning, unnerving chant forces living creatures within 50 feet to attempt a DC 24 Will save. The Lonely Warrior can't chant a new Lonely Dirge for 1d4 rounds.

Critical Success The target is unaffected.

Success The target is stupefied 1 by gnawing pangs of loneliness until the end of its next turn.

Failure The target is stupefied 1 for 1 hour.

Critical Failure The target is stupefied 1 for 24 hours and takes a –2 status penalty to saves against drain life.

Treasure: While the Lonely Warrior is presented in this adventure as wielding a broken bastard sword, consider changing its weapon to a type used by one of your PCs, particularly if they've been lured here by the Tomb Treasure quest that promised a specific magic weapon. You don't need to adjust the Lonely Warrior's statistics beyond potentially changing the damage it deals with its Strike, since the weapon must be repaired before it can once again function as a *+1 cold iron flaming weapon*.



THE LONELY WARRIOR

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



PART 6:

ISLE OF THE LIZARD KING

A small band of lizardfolk—known in their own tongue as iruxi—inhabits a muddy island in the middle of a particularly swampy stretch of the Murque River, about 2 miles west of Candlemere. Although the lizardfolk huddle up in the winter, they become quite aggressive during the spring and summer, ferociously attacking anyone entering their territory. Despite their reputation for violence during the warmer months, these lizardfolk are traditionally non-confrontational and don't seek to expand their territory. Although they do devour other intelligent creatures, this is a practical habit rather than a ritualistic custom or a craving for cruelty. "Meat is meat," they often say, and life in the Stolen Lands is too harsh to forgo a perfectly good source of food because of a taboo against the consumption of thinking creatures.

These lizardfolk have long regarded the eerie lights that glow and dance above Candlemere's central island with something akin to religious awe, believing them to be the spirits of fallen lizardfolk heroes. The tribe's current leader, Vesket, claims to be able to speak to one of these spirits. He believes it to be a revered ancestor and holds its advice in high esteem. In reality, this "spirit" is a will-o'-wisp drawn from Candlemere Island who has discovered that urging the lizardfolk to greater violence provides it with a never-ending feast of fear and pain.

Note that these lizardfolk are chaotic neutral, rather than true neutral—and if they're left under the influence of the will-o'-wisp for much longer, they'll slide into chaotic evil and become a dangerous threat to the region!

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

CHAPTER 2
PART 1: HEXPLORING THE STOLEN LANDS
PART 2: HEX ENCOUNTERS
PART 3: THE OLD SYCAMORE
PART 4: SOOTSCALE CAVERNS
PART 5: THE LONELY BARROW
PART 6: ISLE OF THE LIZARD KING
PART 7: CANDLEMERE ISLAND
PART 8: THE FORGOTTEN KEEP
PART 9: M'BOTUU

THE LIZARDFOLK VILLAGE

The Isle of the Lizard King is located in the Kamelands at area **KL3**. No bridge connects the isle to the riverbank; the lizardfolk simply swim to and from the island as needed. Fortunately for the PCs, the waters are relatively calm, and it's only a DC 20 Athletics check to swim through the ten- to fifteen-foot-deep river. Read the following description as the PCs approach.

A low, muddy hummock protrudes from the middle of the widening river, surrounded by a palisade of outward-facing, sharpened wooden stakes. The waters of the river itself flow relatively serenely and are surely too deep to simply wade through. Beyond the palisade walls, tendrils of smoke rise from a handful of small mounds clustered around a single larger mound. A simple wooden gate on the eastern side of the hummock seems to be the only entrance to the fortified island.

Approximately 150 feet in diameter, the island sits only about 10 feet above the level of the surrounding waters. The surrounding palisade is 10 feet high. The mud mounds are the lizardfolk's homes—each has a single entrance covered with a fur pelt flap to keep the warmth in and the weather out, as well as a chimney hole at the top. 50 feet of 10- to 15-foot-deep water separates the island from both the north and south riverbanks, and breaching the palisade requires success at a DC 20 Athletics check to Climb or a DC 30 Acrobatics check to Squeeze between two of the trunks. PCs attempting to breach the palisade must also succeed at Stealth checks against the guards' Perception DC of 18 to avoid attracting the attention of the lizardfolk stationed at the gate (area **D1**).

D1. GATE — LOW 3

The palisade's wooden gate is 8 feet high and barred on the inside, requiring a successful DC 20 Athletics check to Force Open. Alternatively, a PC can try to succeed at multiple DC 15 Thievery checks to Disable a Device to remove the hinges from the gates so they simply fall down on their own; this requires four separate successful checks (one for each hinge).

Creatures: A group of four lizardfolk scouts stand sentry near the gate, and if they spot anyone approaching the village, they assume the worst and prepare for battle. Still, they won't initiate combat unless they are attacked first, or if the PCs attempt to breach the gate, climb the palisade, or otherwise attempt to invade. The lizardfolk don't receive many visitors and are a bit taken aback if the PCs wish to speak to them instead of fighting. Any attempt at Intimidation immediately goads the lizardfolk into attacking, as will any failed Deception check to Lie to them. The lizardfolk themselves are unfriendly, but if the PCs Make an Impression to shift them to indifferent with a successful DC 13 Diplomacy check, the iruxi scouts lower their guard a bit and tell the PCs to wait there while they get their king to speak with them (area **D5** details how King Vesket interacts with visitors).

If the PCs can make the scouts helpful with a critical success while Making an Impression (or through other methods, such as with magic), the scouts look at each other nervously, then one calls down to the PCs to wait there. That scout then slips out of the gate to speak to the PCs in person—she's obviously nervous and jittery as she talks; she tells the PCs that an "evil spirit" has invaded the village and has been goading their king toward greater and greater acts of cruelty. The lizardfolk shamefully admits to having been on a few "human hunts" in this case, but just as quickly says that the hunts weren't her idea—they were given to her leader by the evil spirit. The lizardfolk asks the PCs to return that night, quietly, and she promises to let them in and lead them to the spirit hut, hoping they can defeat the evil spirit and free the village from its influence. She warns them that many of the other lizardfolk, particularly their king, Vesket, are more enthralled by the spirit, and that they should avoid interacting with the others until the spirit is defeated.

If violence breaks out, the four scouts hunker behind the palisade for cover and use their blowguns on the PCs to try to poison them, but they don't engage in melee until the PCs manage to get into the village. Regardless, the iruxi raise the alarm with loud, barking cries and, as the fight goes on, other lizardfolk come to the defense of the village. Those at area **D2** arrive at the scene of battle in 1d4 rounds, and three of the lizardfolk from area **D4** arrive 1d4 rounds after that. The final warrior from **D4** arrives 2 rounds later with the muggers from area **D3**. The Lizard King himself arrives 1d8 rounds after first hearing the alarm, accompanied by his blood caimans and his spouses from area **D6**.

LIZARDFOLK SCOUTS (4) — CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 231
Initiative Perception +8

D2. FAMILY HUTS — LOW 3

Each of these mounds holds a small lizardfolk family. While only about 4 feet high on the outside, the floors are sunken, making the total interior height about 8 feet. The huts are cozy and warm, with a central firepit, woven reed dividers, and simple furnishings.

Creatures: Each of these mounds houses a family of four lizardfolk defenders, although currently, most

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



of them are out in the wilds on the hunt. Only two lizardfolk defenders remain in each of these two huts at the moment. They raise the alarm immediately if they spot intruders.

LIZARDFOLK DEFENDERS (4) CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 230
Initiative Perception +7

D3. LIZARD KENNEL LOW 3

A leather flap over the doorway to this low mound is tied shut with several sinew cords. A large stack of bones, each stripped of flesh and scarred by sharp teeth, lies near the doorway, and the air within is unpleasantly humid and reeks of reptile.

Creatures: This mound serves as a kennel for the village's pet lizards—a pair of Narlmarch muggers, giant lizards native to the Stolen Lands to the west. Though well fed, the muggers always enjoy the taste of fresh, warm-blooded prey, and attack any non-lizardfolk entering the mound. The lizards are particularly loud when angered, and their frenzied hissing and growling is likely to raise alarms.

NARLMARCH MUGGERS (2) CREATURE 3

Elite giant monitor lizard (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 6, 229)
Initiative Perception +9

Treasure: Each mugger wears a leather collar studded with rough-cut shards of quartz. Each collar is worth 5 gp.

D4. WARRIORS' HUT MODERATE 3

The exterior of this mound is decorated with colorful geometric patterns painted in muds and clays of different shades. The bleached skulls of various swamp creatures hang from the walls by ropes made of twisted vines.

A PC succeeding at a DC 20 Religion or Society check to Recall Knowledge recognizes the patterns painted on the hut as symbols of strength, virility, and skill in battle, but they're not associated with any established faith.

Creatures: Four lizardfolk warriors, the strongest and bravest members of the village, currently reside in this mound; they are inside, arguing about who has the most impressive frills and claws. All four warriors have painted their scales with blue woad and their claws

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

with red ochre. They wear leather armor and wield longspears and javelins. Loyal to the king and eager for battle, these iruxi immediately attack the PCs on sight if they encounter them in the village, but they don't raise the alarm until after one of their number is slain.

LIZARDFOLK WARRIORS (4) CREATURE 2

UNCOMMON CN MEDIUM HUMANOID LIZARDFOLK

Variant lizardfolk (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 230)

Perception +7

Languages Draconic, Iruxi

Skills Acrobatics +6, Athletics +8, Stealth +6, Survival +7

Str +4, **Dex** +2, **Con** +3, **Int** +0, **Wis** +1, **Cha** +0

Items javelins (10), leather armor, longspear

AC 17; **Fort** +9, **Ref** +8, **Will** +7

HP 36

Attack of Opportunity ↷

Speed 25 feet, swim 15 feet

Melee ❖ longspear +10 (reach), **Damage** 1d8+6 piercing

Melee ❖ jaws +10, **Damage** 1d6+6 piercing

Melee ❖ tail +10 (agile), **Damage** 1d4+6 bludgeoning

Ranged javelin +8 (thrown 30 feet), **Damage** 1d6+4 piercing

Deep Breath A lizardfolk warrior can hold their breath for 180 rounds (18 minutes).

Sudden Charge ❖❖ With a quick sprint, the lizardfolk warrior dashes up to their foe and swings. They Stride or Swim twice. If they end their movement within melee reach of at least one enemy, they can make a melee Strike against that enemy.

Terrain Advantage Non-lizardfolk creatures in difficult terrain and non-lizardfolk creatures that are in water and lack a swim Speed are flat-footed to the lizardfolk warrior.

D5. LIZARD KING'S HUT SEVERE 4

The village's central mound stands fully fifteen feet high, dwarfing the surrounding huts. Bones of all shapes and sizes crown the dome, sticking out of the dried mud at erratic angles. Fresh marsh grass has been scattered around the mound's perimeter, and two spears, hung with feathers and other fetishes and topped with the painted skulls of fanged lizards, flank the mound's entrance. The bright-green hide of some large swamp reptile serves as the hut's entrance flap.

This large mound is the home of the lizardfolk's leader, a hulking iruxi named Vesket. While impressive on the outside, the Lizard King's hut is not much different from the others on the inside—the firepit, the reed dividers, and the crude furniture are all the same, although the floor is carpeted with fresh marsh grass and plush furs and the ceiling is 15 feet high. A 5-foot-diameter hole in the dirt floor drops 10 feet to a half-flooded, muddy tunnel that leads to the hatchery (area **D6**).

Creatures: Unless the village has been alerted, Vesket can be found here. At night, there is a 3 in 4 chance that he's visiting the hatchery (area **D6**), and every morning he spends at least an hour listening to the advice of his "ancestral spirit" in area **D7**. Vesket is accompanied at all times by his two pet blood caimans (a northern variety of crocodilian with black scales and red striping on the head and back).

Unless the PCs have managed to broker a meeting with him (as detailed in area **D1**), Vesket's immediate reaction to them is a mix of rage and excitement—his ancestral spirit has promised him that someday soon



KING VESKET

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

he'd get the chance to test his valor against worthy foes. He fights to the death once battle begins; the rest of the lizardfolk immediately flee to their homes and cower if word of the king's death spreads.

If the PCs manage to secure an audience with Vesket, such a talk is likely to take place at the village gates at area **D1**. Convincing the violent iruxi to speak if the PCs encounter him without the benefit of first arranging an audience with the scouts is unlikely to occur without magic unless they tell him (and can prove) that they've slain the will-o'-wisp in area **D7**. Vesket is impatient and short-tempered, and his initial attitude is hostile. Attempts to Make an Impression must critically succeed at a DC 22 Diplomacy check to make him indifferent, but any attempt to do so that fails to make him at least unfriendly goads him into attacking. Vesket admits that they've increased their hunting of humans in the region, but says that the decision was made by his "ancestor," Stisshak, and that if the PCs wish, he will escort them there to speak to the spirit. In this event, Vesket observes the PCs' interaction with the will-o'-wisp in area **D7** as detailed there; otherwise he orders the PCs to leave his domain at once. He attacks if they refuse.

BLOOD CAIMANS (2) CREATURE 2

Crocodile (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 67)
Initiative Perception +7

KING VESKET CREATURE 6

UNIQUE | CN | MEDIUM | HUMANOID | LIZARDFOLK

Male lizardfolk king
Perception +12
Languages Common, Draconic, Iruxi
Skills Athletics +15, Diplomacy +13, Intimidation +15, Nature +12, Stealth +13
Str +5, **Dex** +3, **Con** +3, **Int** +2, **Wis** +2, **Cha** +5
Items leather armor, *+1 striking trident*

AC 23; **Fort** +15, **Ref** +15, **Will** +12
HP 115
Righteous Certainty (mental) Whenever Vesket becomes frightened, he reduces the condition value by 1. If Vesket ever realizes the spirit of Stisshak is actually a will-o'-wisp, he loses this ability.

Speed 25 feet, swim 20 feet
Melee ❖ *trident* +18 (thrown 20 feet), **Damage** 2d8+7 piercing
Melee ❖ jaws +17, **Damage** 2d8+7 piercing
Melee ❖ tail +17 (agile, sweep), **Damage** 2d6+7 bludgeoning
Ranged ❖ *trident* +18 (thrown 20 feet), **Damage** 2d8+10 piercing
Trident Twist ❖ **Requirements** Vesket is wielding a trident; **Effect** Vesket attempts to Disarm a foe. If he critically succeeds, he makes a trident melee Strike against the disarmed foe, using the same multiple attack penalty as the Disarm attempt. The trident Strike does not count toward his multiple attack penalty.
Triumphant Roar ❖ **Requirements** Vesket's last action reduced a foe to 0 Hit Points; **Effect** Vesket attempts an Intimidation check to Demoralize up to four foes within 30 feet. For each success, he gains 4 temporary Hit Points (8 on a critical success) that last for 10 minutes.

Treasure: The Lizard King has collected some treasures in his hut, including 345 sp, a coral crown embedded with lapis lazuli worth 30 gp, a malachite statuette of a serpentine dragon worth 12 gp, and various furs worth a total of 18 gp. A successful DC 21 Perception check made by a PC while searching the hut's contents is enough to discover one additional item of value—a *dragon turtle scale*.

D6. HATCHERY TRIVIAL 4

Perfumed smoke hangs heavy in the close, almost uncomfortably warm confines of this mound. A couple of red-tinted lanterns hang from the ceiling, and brightly colored woven mats drape the walls and carpet the dirt floor. A small mound of coals glows in a firepit in the center of the room.

This mound is the home of the Lizard King's chosen mates, and everyone other than the king himself is forbidden to enter. The only entrance into the hatchery is via the tunnel from area **D5**; it has no exterior doorways. One of his mates has recently laid an egg—it sits atop a small mound of mud close to the firepit.

Creatures: The three lizardfolk that dwell here are Vesket's consorts. While they're charged with guarding the eggs, they are not prisoners. More loyal to the idea of protecting the village's future than they are to Vesket, they do not come to his aid if they hear combat in area **D5**. If an intruder pokes their head out of the tunnel, the three defenders snatch up their weapons and surround the exit, trying to keep any more intruders from invading their home.

LIZARDFOLK DEFENDERS (3) CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 230
Initiative Perception +7

Treasure: The Lizard King's consorts wear jewelry worth a total of 10 gp each.

D7. SPIRIT HUT SEVERE 4

This mound has a deserted, run-down look to it. The mud is dried and cracked, and no smoke issues from its chimney.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Within, the air is strangely cold and dry, and the walls themselves have been decorated with images of violence showing lizardfolk fighting in long, bloody wars against humans, dwarves, and elves. In many of these scenes, a single regal lizardfolk directs their armies to great victories.

Creature: Vesket believes that the spirit of one his forebears, the great lizard king Stisshak, looks over his tribe and guides it from beyond. Vesket frequently comes to this hut to talk with his ancestor about history, strategy, or any other problems he is having. Most times, the spirit of Stisshak remains silent, but occasionally it responds, appearing to Vesket as a manifestation of the ancient lizardfolk king, surrounded by a pulsing greenish glow. Regardless of whether the spirit speaks, it has appeared at all the tribe's major battles, a fact that quashed any doubts among the lizardfolk about whether Vesket actually communicates with the spirits of the honored dead.

Unknown to both Vesket and the rest of the tribe, Stisshak's "spirit" is in truth a subversive will-o'-wisp that has found itself a gullible society. Having lived for centuries, the will-o'-wisp is able to convincingly portray an ancient hero from the past, and by urging Vesket to seek more glory for his people in war (often through the influence of magical nightmares or modified memories), the will-o'-wisp has a ready supply of fear to feed on. Occasionally, it grows bored and wanders off into the swamp on its own inscrutable errands, but it always returns, inevitably pushing Vesket to go to war so it can feed on the fresh fear of the dying.

If by some chance the PCs have made peaceful contact with the lizardfolk, the will-o'-wisp sees them as a new source of food and persuades Vesket to turn against them, regardless of any promises made. If the will-o'-wisp is aware of the PCs, it uses its ability to go dark to Hide. At a dramatic moment, it reappears in a flash of green light as a floating lizardfolk skull, hoping to scare the PCs. In combat, the will-o'-wisp shocks the closest person with its touch, concentrating its attacks on that character until it can feed on its victim's dying fear. If reduced to 20 Hit Points or fewer, the will-o'-wisp goes dark and flees into the swamp, abandoning the lizardfolk.

This particular will-o'-wisp has developed unusual abilities over the course of its time living among and influencing the lizardfolk, and is a bit more dangerous than most of its kind.

SPIRIT OF STISSHAK CREATURE 7

UNIQUE | CE | SMALL | ABERRATION | AIR

Variant will-o'-wisp (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 333)

Initiative Perception +18; darkvision

Languages Aklo, Common, Draconic, Iruxi

Skills Acrobatics +20, Deception +14, Intimidation +14, Religion +12, Stealth +18

Str –5, **Dex** +6, **Con** +0, **Int** +2, **Wis** +5, **Cha** +2

AC 28; **Fort** +12, **Ref** +18, **Will** +16

HP 65; **Immunities** magic

Glow (aura, light) 20 feet. As will-o'-wisp

Magic Immunity As will-o'-wisp.

Speed fly 50 feet

Melee ❖ shock +19 (electricity, magical), **Damage** 2d8+6 electricity

Occult Innate Spells DC 25; **4th** *modify memory*; **3rd** *fear*, *mind reading*, *nightmare*

Feed on Fear ❖ (concentrate) As will-o'-wisp.

Go Dark ❖ (concentrate) As will-o'-wisp.

Invoke Stisshak ❖❖ (auditory, illusion, occult, visual) **Frequency** once per day; **Effect** The Spirit of Stisshak manifests a shimmering form, that of a regal lizardfolk king made of flickering ghostly light. This image is Medium and must manifest within 10 feet of the will-o'-wisp. The will-o'-wisp can sustain the image by concentrating, and can speak through it and control minor motions (such as movement of limbs), but cannot cause it to leave the square in which it appeared. The will-o'-wisp gains a +2 circumstance bonus on Intimidation checks made to demoralize foes through this invoked image. Any damage inflicted to the will-o'-wisp or the illusion itself causes the invoked illusion to vanish immediately.

Treasure: While the will-o'-wisp neither needs nor wants treasure, Vesket believes he must make offerings to the spirit of his ancestor to keep it appeased. These offerings lie in a small pile in the middle of the floor and include a low-grade cold iron longspear, a *tree feather token*, a *bloodseeker beak talisman*, animal skins worth a total of 20 gp, three citrines worth 4 gp each, and 22 sp. The room also contains two wooden discs marked with a troll claw; Vesket was hoping to get guidance on whether to accept Hargulka's invitation to join his monster kingdom (as detailed on page 200), but the lizard king has not yet received any word from Stisshak's spirit.

Resources: If the will-o'-wisp is defeated, the lizardfolk themselves, and in particular Vesket, become appalled and ashamed if they realize the truth. Convincing Vesket he's been tricked can be tough, though, as he continues to believe his version of reality. To convince him that they were all mislead, the PCs must make a successful DC 22 Diplomacy check as part of a one-minute activity. Alternately, one month later, the lizardfolk and their king accept the truth after so many weeks of having no visitations from "Stisshak." From this point forward, assuming the PCs remain supportive of the iruxi, the lizardfolk village's Negotiation DC (page 519) is reduced to 18.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



PART 7:

CANDLEMERE ISLAND

Ages ago, the area now known as the Stolen Lands was under the control of warring groups of Kellid humans. The vast land provided ample opportunity for cults with malign intent to hide themselves away, out of sight of those who would quash their evil worship. One such cult venerated the Outer God Yog-Sothoth, an alien entity believed by some to be a self-aware incarnation of the Dark Tapestry or the Dimension of Time, and who is thought by some to be a patron of those who seek control over portals and dimensional travel. Although impartial to the needs and interests of mortal life, Yog-Sothoth's cultists have a long tradition of treating non-cultists as cattle for sacrifice.

Many cultists of Yog-Sothoth see in the Outer God opportunities for great power, and so they seek methods to draw its presence into this world for their personal gain. Through the sacrifice of individuals or of entire settlements, worshippers of Yog-Sothoth can secure the power and esoteric secrets they desire, but always at the cost of humanity, sanity, and life. Where worship of Yog-Sothoth occurs, the world itself is stained and tainted forever.

Candlemere Island is one such stain.

CANDLEMERE'S LEGACY

A misanthropic Kellid visionary and narcissist named Foras established a cult of Yog-Sothoth in this area many centuries ago, long before Taldor first arrived with their Second Army of Exploration. He named his cult the Thresholders, for he believed that by

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

luring Yog-Sothoth over the dimensional threshold upon which the Outer God was said to lurk, Foras would be rewarded with power over the dimensions themselves. He believed that with such power time travel, life beyond death, and the secrets of the universe would all be within his grasp. Under the Kellid's guide, the Thresholders constructed a vast underground complex below a single tower intended to serve as a metaphysical beacon for Yog-Sothoth's influence. From the tower, the cult made astronomical observations, while from the chambers below they prepared raids to kidnap potential sacrifices. Their evil work attracted several will-o'-wisps to the area, and it became known as Candlemere.

As their raids on regional settlements increased their notoriety, Foras's cult eventually attracted the attention of an opposing religious sect—worshippers of Pharasma who worked to beat the Thresholders back into their subterranean chambers and then seal them within. These Pharasmins—including Foras's brother—chose to lock themselves within these ancient chambers to prevent the cult's return, and the tower above was slowly forgotten and crumbled down to its foundation. The only inhabitants left were the will-o'-wisps, lending Candlemere a sinister reputation. Additional details on this ancient conflict, as well as the dungeons deep below the island, appear in Chapter 9, but the aboveground ruins and the uppermost level of the subterranean chambers aren't nearly as dangerous or threatening.

CANDLEMERE TODAY

Even thousands of years after the cult's prominence, Candlemere remains a menacing location. The name is now affixed not just to the tower but to the surrounding area as well. A large lake surrounds the reed-choked hill where the tower stands; this body of water is sometimes called Candlemere Lake, and its island is sometimes called Candlemere Island. None but pedantic cartographers argue over the distinction (and neither is precisely correct), because only the foolhardiest travelers visit Candlemere itself.

The haunted lake is notorious throughout the Stolen Lands. Stories from explorers, hunters, and traders alike support these legends with eerie tales of strange lights dancing upon the waters, blood-curdling cries from what could be lost souls, and mysterious sightings of shapes rippling across the lake's dark surface. Those who spend the night on the shore have a 20 percent chance of spotting the "Candlemere lights," flickering spheres of color that dance over the water. Sphere sightings are all but guaranteed once one travels to the island itself, for the source is the will-o'-wisps who have dwelled on the isle for centuries.

CANDLEMERE ISLAND

Candlemere Island is a forbidding heap of land choked with stinging nettles (page 77) and covered with a thin mist regardless of the ambient weather. The 40-foot-tall ruined tower at the island's summit is visible from quite a distance away, as are the darting lights of the will-o'-wisps drawn to the tower's malevolent aura; both give the island an otherworldly appearance through the swirling mist.

E1. SHORE — MODERATE 4

It's difficult to tell where the lake ends and the island begins, as the island is surrounded by dense tangles of reeds and greenish scum that floats on the still water. A dilapidated pier extends from the island's southern shore.

A few decades ago, an enterprising trader who realized no one traveled to Candlemere Island decided to build a storehouse on it for goods brought up the river. She and her doughty employees got as far as constructing part of a pier on the first day, but when night set in, the island's will-o'-wisps descended upon the group and killed them all. The unfinished pier is being slowly reclaimed by the vegetation on the island.

Creature: Will-o'-wisps aren't the only dangers that dwell on Candlemere. A single shambler lurks on the overgrown bank near the pier, just to the west side. It's desperate for a filling meal and eagerly ambushes any creatures that approach on the path or moor at the pier, fighting until slain.

SHAMBLER — **CREATURE 6**

Pathfinder Bestiary 290
Initiative Stealth +12

Treasure: On the shore near the dilapidated pier lie the shattered remains of three wooden crates. Their contents have all been rotted or picked apart by scavenging animals, save for a glass vial containing a *moderate potion of swimming* and a tattered leather pouch containing 15 gp and a garnet worth 20 gp.

E2. OVERGROWN ISLAND

Nettles and brambles cover the island except for a narrow, weedy path leading from the pier at the island's south end to the collapsed tower rising from the island's summit. In addition to the thorny plants, a thin mist makes it difficult to see the ground.

The path, winding up from the pier to the tower at the isle's peak, is overgrown, but still easier to navigate than the rest of the isle, which is covered with stinging

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

nettles and bushes with sharp-edged leaves. Except for this path, the island is greater difficult terrain.

E3. TOWER SEVERE 4

This crumbling ruin must have once been a large tower, but only a jagged stone cylinder about forty feet tall remains. Rubble litters the ground outside the tower. The structure itself has only two entrances at ground level: a wide opening to the southeast and a narrow window facing west. Both lead to an interior choked with tumbled stones and weeds. A dark gap in the floor hints at a stone staircase leading down.

The stones of this ruin are far older than ruins elsewhere in the Stolen Lands, and date from the Age of Destiny. Faint carvings of strange symbols are barely visible on some of the tower's walls. A PC who can read Aklo or who succeeds at a DC 20 Occultism or Religion check to Decipher Writing identifies them as fragments of a series of blasphemous prayers to ancient gods of the Old Cults. A reader who succeeds at a DC 20 Perception check spots the name "Yog-Sothoth" as the entity to whom the prayers are directed.

The staircase in the tower leads down to area **F1**. Medium or smaller creatures can move past the rubble, but larger creatures must succeed at a DC 20 Acrobatics check to Squeeze past or spend back-breaking hours clearing away sufficient rubble to enter.

Creatures: Several will-o'-wisps dwell on Candlemere, but they largely prefer to lurk unseen until night, when their flickering glow helps to maintain the region's unsettling reputation. The wisps tend to drift over the waters to hunt on the lake's far shores as they need to feed, but when the PCs reach this tower, they'll be confronted by one of these evil aberrations that has claimed the ruins as its personal lair. The wisp prefers to wait for the PCs to become exposed to the area's Dread Aura (detailed in the Hazard section below), but attacks regardless as soon as the PCs attempt to descend the stairs to area **F1**. It fights to the death; if the PCs leave the region and return after 24 hours, a new will-o'-wisp has moved into the area. Will-o'-wisps are immune to the Dread Aura's effects.

WILL-O'-WISP CREATURE 6

Pathfinder Bestiary 333
Initiative Perception +16

Hazard: Although the cults that once used this site haven't been to the surface in ages, the stones of the ruin still emanate a psychic echo of the sinister worship once performed here. Any creature that approaches within 100 feet of the tower feels as if something unseen were watching or waiting, and senses that intruders are distinctly unwelcome. This hazard is particularly powerful but not overwhelmingly dangerous. It's unlikely that the PCs will be able to disable it at this time, and are likely to critically fail attempts to resist the effects. This shouldn't prevent them from further exploring the basement below, but it should help to keep the PCs aware that something very powerful may well lurk just beyond their perception. The PCs should not receive XP at this time for experiencing the Dread Aura—the reward for defeating it is included in the XP awards they will earn much later during the events of Chapter 9.

DREAD AURA HAZARD 16

ENVIRONMENTAL MAGICAL

Stealth DC 42 (master)
Description The disturbing sensation of being watched, of having attracted the unwanted attention of something unimaginably powerful, or knowing the eerie conviction that unseen stars in the sky above might be looking down upon this spot grows increasingly overwhelming.
Disable DC 45 Occultism (master) to inscribe eldritch warding sigils on the stones of the tower (this is an activity that takes 1 hour to perform) or defeat the Thresholder influence in the chambers below (as detailed in Chapter 9)
Unsettling Attention ↷ (emotion, enchantment, fear, mental, occult) **Trigger** A creature ends its turn within the ruins of the tower or the chambers below while not currently being affected by the Dread Aura; **Effect** The creature feels as if its presence in the area has attracted the attention of something powerful and must attempt a DC 37 Will save.
Critical Success The creature is unaffected and is immune to the Dread Aura forever.
Success The creature is unaffected and is immune to the Dread Aura for 24 hours.
Failure The creature becomes unsettled and suffers a –2 penalty to all saves against fear effects as long as they remain within the hex containing Candlemere.
Critical Failure As failure, but each time the creature becomes frightened or flees, the fear is physically enervating, and the creature is also enfeebled 1 as long as they remain frightened or fleeing.

Treasure: Partially concealed under a stone in the interior of the tower is a unique *bloodletting kukri* named *Thirst*. The persistent damage dealt by this weapon increases from 1d8 to 2d8 when used against humans, but only when the weapon has previously been used to kill a human within the past 24 hours. A character who is not chaotic is enfeebled 2 when wielding *Thirst*.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

CANDLEMERE BASEMENT

The basement of Candlemere Tower is the first of three underground levels below the isle, and it contains a powerful magical ward—called the Spiral Seal—placed by the ancient Pharasmins to keep the Thresholders locked away for good. The PCs can explore Candlemere's basement at any time, but further progress into the lower levels should be impossible for the PCs to attempt at this time. The second and third levels, accessible only after the Spiral Seal has been breached, are detailed in full in Chapter 9.

The basement chambers were originally constructed by the Thresholders and are made of solid blocks of stone that have weathered the intervening millennia surprisingly well. Ceilings are 10 feet high throughout. The doors are all made of heavy stone that grind closed when not held open, though none bear locks or bars. Except for the fire burning in the globes of the statue in area **F3** and the *everburning torch* in area **F5**, the basement level is entirely unlit.

F1. ENTRY

This low chamber has a steep staircase leading up to the north and stairs leading down to both the east and the west. A small pile of dead leaves and dried nettles has drifted against the south wall.

This room leads down to the ritual chambers beneath Candlemere Tower. The leaves and nettles have blown in to fill a shallow basin beneath an inscription in Aklo that translates literally to "we are those who stand at the threshold," or, more properly, "we are the Thresholders."

Treasure: The basin was once used for making offerings to Yog-Sothoth. Although this was most often blood, six large silver coins still sit in the bottom of the basin. The coins are worth only 1 sp each for their silver content, but to a collector of coins, they're rare examples from the Age of Destiny worth 30 gp each.

F2. RESTING CHAMBER

Several stone benches line the walls of this room. The east wall contains two openings leading to stairs: those to the north go up and those to the south lead downward. The stone blocks of the ceiling have been badly scorched in strange circular patterns.

This room was designed so cultists visiting the lower levels could rest and center their minds on blasphemous cosmic mysteries. It's also where the cultists and the Pharasmins first clashed, bringing powerful forces to bear. The scorching on the ceilings is ancient evidence of a *meteor swarm* spell unleashed in this room. A PC succeeding at a DC 26 Arcana, Nature, or relevant Lore check to Recall Knowledge recognizes the blast patterns as being indicative of a high-level spell, as well as having occurred millennia ago. A critical success is enough to recognize the pattern specifically as having been caused by *meteor swarm*. The bodies that once littered this room in the aftermath of the spell have long ago turned to dust.

F3. STATUE CHAMBER SEVERE 4

This long room has a high, vaulted ceiling twenty feet above the floor. Near the northern end of the west wall, a staircase leads up; near the southern end, another stair leads down. At the south end of the room, a low dais is carved with spiky writing around its base and bears a towering, abstract statue made of more than a dozen stone orbs. Several of the orbs have openings to show that they are hollow, with flames burning within them.

A PC who succeeds at a DC 29 Occultism or Religion check to Recall Knowledge identifies the statue as a representation of Yog-Sothoth. Thresholders who came through this chamber would meditate upon the Outer God before descending further into the ritual chambers. The writing around the base is in Aklo and reads, "Yog-Sothoth Who Knows the Gate; Yog-Sothoth Who Is the Gate. Past, Present, Future—All are One in Yog-Sothoth."

The wall behind the statue bears a hidden door made more difficult to find by millennia of dust. A PC who Searches this area discovers it with a successful DC 24 Perception check. The door doesn't have a handle but opens to a hard push. It leads to area **F4**.

Creatures: The statue animates to defend Candlemere from intrusion, grinding to life with eerie grace. When the Kellid Pharasmins stormed this area long ago, they deactivated the statue with a magical charm, preventing it from animating. That charm expired long ago, and the statue is now ready to attack again. When it moves, the spheres of its body grind and roll against each other without ever separating but without any obvious underlying support (almost as if it were an animated mass of spherical magnets clinging and rolling against each other). The flames in the hollow spheres flare up violently as it attacks (these are the source of the statue's "brazier" attacks). The statue fights until destroyed, but it's too large to leave this room.

GIANT ANIMATED STATUE CREATURE 7

Pathfinder Bestiary 21

Initiative Perception +13

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



CANDLEMERE ISLAND
ONE SQUARE = 5 FEET



CANDLEMERE BASEMENT
ONE SQUARE = 5 FEET

F4. HIDDEN ARMORY

The air in this room is particularly stale, and thick layers of dust lie in heaps on the floor. Stone shelves on the walls hold fragments and pieces of long-since crumbled supplies, but here and there something whole seems to remain intact.

This small chamber behind the secret door in the statue chamber is a vault the Thresholders could access in the event of an attack. Unfortunately for them, the Pharasmin assault was too swift for the cultists to reach this room.

Treasure: The Pharasmins didn't realize the room was here, so its contents have sat untouched for millennia. Most of the weapons, armor, and other mundane goods stored here have long ago decayed into uselessness, but a few treasures remain. One of the shelves contains a *wand of grim tendrils* (1st) and a garnet-adorned bronze canister worth 20 gp that contains a dose of *dust of appearance*.

F5. CHAMBER OF ARCHES SEVERE 4

A burning metal rod is stuck into the ceiling of this room, providing the space with fitful illumination. The north and south walls of this room each have three enormous arches surrounded by tiny runes. The central arch to the south, and each of the side arches to the north, lead to staircases; the other three arches surround only blank stone.

The runes are a series of tiny stick figures designed to give a perspective that the arches are very, very large. The cultists hoped to one day open magical gates in the empty arches that would lead to distant locations of occult significance to the Elder Mythos, such as distant worlds deep in the Dark Tapestry. However, they didn't acquire the knowledge or occult skill to erect the gates before they were pushed back by the Pharasmins.

The secret door in the east wall can be found with a successful DC 20 Perception check.

Creatures: The Thresholders kept three cultists on guard here. The Pharasmins quickly overwhelmed them, but the eldest cultist spat a curse of vengeance upon them. This curse caused the three Thresholders to rise again as shadows; they have haunted this room ever since. They are unwilling to repeat the failure they made in life and fight intruders tenaciously until destroyed (but do not pursue out of this chamber).

SHADOWS (3) CREATURE 4

Pathfinder Bestiary 289
Initiative Perception +10

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Treasure: The rod is an *everburning torch* driven into the stone at the center of the ceiling.

F6. CHAMBER OF THE SPIRAL SEAL SEVERE 4

The bottom few feet of this rectangular chamber are stained an inky black. Three strange, dark shapes, like frozen shadows, line the walls as though rising out of the blackness at floor level. The lowest portion of the room, near the middle of the south wall, shimmers with a layer of black, tar-like fluid.

In this room, the attacking Pharasmins finally realized that the Thresholders had significantly more forces—and occupied a significantly larger subterranean complex—than they initially believed. They made a difficult decision here and sent about a dozen of their most powerful warriors and psychopomp allies into a shaft leading down from here to the lower level, then plugged the shaft's entrance with a seal of magical stone. Upon this stone, they placed the spiral comet insignia of Pharasma, both to empower its magic and to warn away anyone that would tamper with it. Creating the Spiral Seal required such powerful magic that the Pharasmins involved in the ritual were killed by spiritual backlash—their shadows are the ones scorched onto the walls here. A successful DC 25 Arcana, Divine, Occultism, or Nature check reveals to a PC that these shadows are all that remains of an ancient, powerful backlash of magic.

Creatures: The chamber is not unguarded, for ages ago, a pair of awful, aberrant creatures slithered into it, drawn by the lingering eldritch energies suffusing the area. These monsters are gibbering mouthers, their flesh a dark sludge revealing foul green hues when its mass churns and splits. The gibbering mouthers lie spread out over the Spiral Seal, but they rise up in a shrieking extrusion of eyes and teeth as soon as anyone approaches within 10 feet or attempts to otherwise harm them. The gibbering mouthers fight to the death, but do not pursue the PCs beyond this chamber. You can give the PCs a clue to the nature of the Spiral Seal by having one of the gibbering mouthers use its Ground Manipulation in the room: the area of the seal itself is immune to this effect and remains completely solid.

GIBBERING MOUTHERS (2) CREATURE 5

Pathfinder Bestiary 176
Initiative Perception +15

The Spiral Seal: The Spiral Seal of Pharasma is carved into the stone below the gibbering mouthers. The Spiral Seal resists damage and repairs itself quickly. It can be opened via a rare ritual or brute force, but both of these methods require much more power than 4th-level PCs have access to. See the beginning of Chapter 9 for how the Spiral Seal can be breached and the lower levels of Candlemere Dungeon can be accessed; for now, this enigmatic rune should remain mysterious to the PCs.

Treasure: The bodies of the doomed Pharasmins who perished here were vaporized along with much of their gear, but a successful DC 20 Perception check reveals to a PC one small object that survived the blast and has remained under a layer of dust in the southwest corner of the room for centuries—a *ring of negative resistance* bearing the symbol of Pharasma. This ring functions as a *ring of energy resistance*, save that it protects against negative damage rather than a type of energy damage.



GIBBERING MOUTHER

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023



PART 8:

THE FORGOTTEN KEEP

Long ago, before the fall of the *Starstone*, when the Verduran Forest stretched from the World's Edge Mountains to the Lake of Mists and Veils, the elves built an outpost far to the north in what is now the northern River Kingdoms. When they fled Golarion at the onset of the Age of Darkness, these elves abandoned this outpost as they did so many others. Centuries later, after the elves returned to Golarion, their explorers found that while humanity had claimed much of Avistan, the Stolen Lands had become a wilderness untouched by humans. Moved by this, they left this ancient keep abandoned, and in the ensuing centuries even those who rediscovered the keep forgot about it. The Forgotten Keep is located in the Narlmarches at area **NM5**.

THE FORGOTTEN KEEP'S LEGACY

Elven architecture is built to last, and the outpost, though now in ruins, has survived the passage of millennia mostly intact. Over the years, it has been home to a host of creatures, both fair and foul. Most recently, it has become the residence of an evil fey creature: a baobhan sith. Her presence in the region has attracted other wicked fey to the area—all can feel the growing presence of the First World in the region and hope to be here when whatever they feel is about to happen finally does. She feels little responsibility to these other fey, who in turn think of her almost as a force of nature and, when they must speak of her, simply call her the Dancing Lady. The evil fey prey upon the infrequent travelers in the southern

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023

Narlmarches; enough hunters and trappers have gone missing near the ruined keep that most give it a wide berth these days.

G1. MAIN GATE — TRIVIAL 5

A ruined keep looms out of the forest. Four circular towers sprout from the cracked walls. Twisting vines and thick moss cover the walls in a coat of verdant green, blending the ruins almost seamlessly into the surrounding woods. The overgrown remains of a path lead to an open, arched gateway gaping in the keep's eastern wall, its doors long since rotted away.

The keep's exterior walls and those of the flanking towers are built of 5-foot-thick stone. Walls that haven't collapsed are 20 feet high unless otherwise noted; the PCs can Climb them with a successful DC 20 Athletics check. Studying the walls reveals ancient, worn carvings. A PC who succeeds at a DC 15 Architecture Lore or Elven Lore check or a DC 20 Society check to Recall Knowledge identifies the ruins as being of ancient elven construction. The keep's southern wall has been breached, creating a rubble-choked opening leading inside.

Hazard: The quickling living inside (as detailed in area **G4**) has trapped the citadel's gate.

FALLING PORTCULLIS — HAZARD 6

MECHANICAL | TRAP

Stealth DC 25 (trained)

Description A tripline under the arch causes the keep's portcullis to slam down, sealing the entrance and alerting the denizens of the keep to the intruder's presence.

Disable DC 25 Thievery (trained) to lock the portcullis

AC 24; **Fort** +17, **Ref** +11

Hardness 14; **HP** 56 (BT 28); **Immunities** critical hits, object immunities, precision damage

Falling Portcullis ↷ **Trigger** The trip wire is pulled or severed (typically by a person walking through the archway into area **G2**); **Effect** The portcullis comes crashing down, sealing the entrance and alerting the denizens of the keep to the intruder's presence. Any creature passing under the portcullis or standing below it must attempt a DC 27 Reflex save. Once it falls, the portcullis can be lifted with a DC 30 Athletics check to Force it Open, or via the winch in area **G2**.

Critical Success The creature dodges aside into an adjacent square (the player chooses which square they end up in).

Success As critical success, but the creature takes a glancing blow from the falling portcullis and takes 2d8 bludgeoning damage.

Failure As critical success, but the creature takes a solid blow from the falling portcullis and takes 4d8+18 bludgeoning damage.

Critical Failure The portcullis lands squarely on the creature, inflicting 6d8+18 piercing damage and immobilizing them. A Medium or smaller creature is also knocked prone.

G2. COURTYARD

A graceful tower rises out of the keep's central courtyard, now overgrown with bushes, undergrowth, and several sizable trees. Like the outer walls, the tower is draped with vines and creepers, and several small plants have taken up residence on ledges and in cracks along its sides.

The courtyard is uninhabited, though the fey in areas **G4** and **G6** keep a close eye on anything disturbing the area. The thick underbrush makes the entire courtyard difficult terrain. A winch built into the wall just north of the portcullis can be used to raise or lower the gate at area **G1**, but doing so requires a full round of straining activity and a successful DC 10 Athletics check to force the ancient wheel to comply; each successful round raises the portcullis by 2 feet, requiring five rounds to fully raise the gate and lock it in place.

G3. NORTHEAST TOWER — TRIVIAL 5

The northeast tower is open to the sky, its roof and interior levels having fallen away long ago.

Creatures: Hundreds of disease-ridden rats inhabit this ruined tower. The fey occasionally toss bodies and other rubbish inside for the rats to dispose of, but otherwise avoid entering the tower. The rats attack any warm-blooded creature entering the tower, forming into two swarms, as they spill out into the courtyard.

ELITE RAT SWARMS (2) — CREATURE 2

Pathfinder Bestiary 6, 276

Initiative Perception +7

G4. SOUTHEAST TOWER — MODERATE 5

A wooden door made from rough-cut timber planks—obviously of newer construction than the rest of the keep—blocks the entrance to this tower.

The 40-foot-tall southeast tower is also missing its roof, but interwoven vines above provide a ceiling of sorts, shading the interior and allowing only dim light during daytime. Inside, the rubble and undergrowth have been cleared away to create a cozy living space sized for a Small creature; it's decorated with crude wooden furniture and bloody scalps nailed to the walls.

paizo.com #18237234, Randall Welles <Randywelles@gmail.com>, Sep 27, 2023